

*Moving Forward:
Unity Through Humility*

**THE FORTY-NINTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*1999
Final Report*

Crowne Plaza Manhattan, New York, NY April 18–24, 1999

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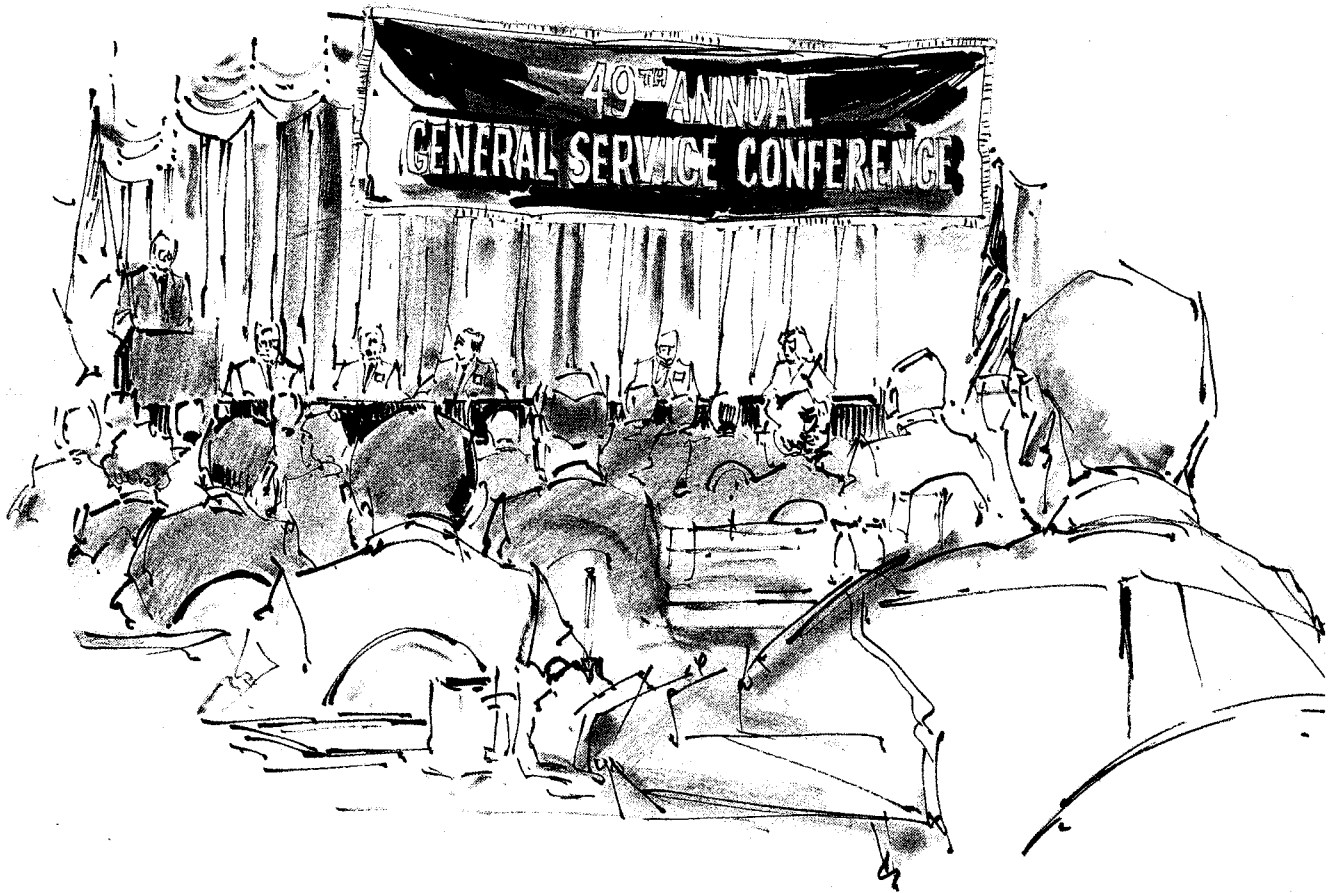
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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members’ full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



49TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility

"One strenuous session followed another, morning, afternoon, and evening. The delegates inspected A.A.'s finances and listened to reports from the Board of Trustees and from all of the services. There was warm but cordial debate on many questions of A.A. policy. The Trustees submitted several of their own serious problems for the opinion of the Conference. With real dispatch the delegates handled several tough puzzlers about which we at Headquarters were in doubt. Though their advice was sometimes contrary to our own views, we saw they were frequently right. They were proving as never before that A.A.'s Tradition Two was correct. Our group conscience could safely act as the sole authority and sure guide for Alcoholics Anonymous. As the delegates returned home, they carried this deep conviction with them." (A.A. *Comes of Age*, p. 218)

So wrote co-founder Bill W., describing A.A.'s first General Service Conference in 1951. Yet Bill's sense of the meeting could easily apply to the 49th Conference, the final Conference of the 20th Century, which met April 18-24, at New York City's Crowne Plaza hotel, with the theme of "Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility."

Chairing this year's Conference were Gary Glynn (nonalcoholic), chairman of the board; Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager; Elaine Johnson, PhD., Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Vic Booth, delegate chairperson. Conference secretary was Joanie Moncrief, G.S.O. staff member. Throughout, the Conference was ably assisted by staff and support personnel of the General Service and Grapevine offices.

Sunday evening, 132 Conference members (delegates from the 92 areas of the United States and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members) were joined for the Opening Dinner by past trustees, former staff members, other friends of A.A. and their guests. Following dinner, an open A.A. meeting, chaired by Dave Madison (Delaware) and led by Linda Roberts (Northwest Texas), included speakers Darla Branton (Mississippi), Marne Hill (Eastern Canada trustee), Jan Polek (A.A.W.S. director), Warren Stafford (G.S.O. staff), and Jim Tallman (Alberta/NWT).

Sunday afternoon two pre-Conference meetings focused on Remote Communities and Spanish-language Translations, two subjects of much interest to delegates and the Fellowship in general.

Throughout the busy week, Conference sessions began by 9:00 a.m. and continued until 9:00 p.m. (not at all unlike the schedule Bill describes of the first Conference), where Conference members heard Presentations (page 9), Area Service Highlights (page 49), took part in the Workshop (page 5) and two "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions. For those who cared to start their day with an A.A. meeting, the Serenity Group met each morning at 7:30.

The main focus of the Conference though, was on the deliberations of the 13 Conference committees, which followed after joint meetings with corresponding trustees' committees. The Conference committees reviewed material, discussed various issues, and came up with recommendations which were pre-

sented to the entire Conference, many resulting in Advisory Actions (page 7).

Since we are only one year away from the celebration of A.A.'s 65th Birthday, Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O.'s International Convention coordinator, on Wednesday gave a presentation followed by several G.S.O. staff members at microphones asking Valerie questions drawn from actual situations encountered at past Conventions.

The Delegates Only meeting on Tuesday evening chose Rick Barr, Central Southeast Ohio, as delegate chairperson for the 2000 General Service Conference and Clayton Vandivort, Eastern Missouri, to be the alternate chairperson.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected three new Class B (alcoholic) trustees. Tony Taschner of Berlin, Connecticut, succeeds MaryJane Roy as Northeast regional trustee and Beth Rabren of Brazoria, Texas, is the Southwest regional trustee, filling the vacancy left by the death of Raul Marin in 1998. The new trustee-at-large/Canada, Alex Palmer of Abbotsford, B.C., follows rotating trustee Michel Girard. Our new general service trustee is Greg Tobin of South Orange, New Jersey.

In her Keynote address Monday morning, MaryJane Roy said, "At the end of the week I will let go with both hands and experience 'Unity through Humility' by rotation; we each have our gifts to bring and then move on." Thus, at the Saturday morning Closing Brunch, the Conference theme was beautifully expressed in talks by the two rotating trustees—Michel Girard and MaryJane Roy.

While addressing the Third General Service Conference, Bill W. spoke about potential problems that could divide Alcoholics Anonymous. "I see God, speaking through the group conscience, in this room. I feel that our guidance will be true and the voice of Alcoholics Anonymous will remain clear, that its conscience is now so experienced and so well related to a Higher Power that it can apprehend the right thing to do at the right time." (*Final Report, Third General Service Conference*)

By Friday evening, the 49th Conference adjourned with an overwhelming sense among the members that Bill's thoughts were fulfilled, and that "the great service heart of Alcoholics Anonymous which beats in the center of this gathering [will] continue to beat for so long as God shall need us." (*ibid.*)

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

Welcome to the 49th General Service Conference. As I stand here sharing these thoughts with you, I am aware that my responsibility as delegate chairperson is one that has made me grow — if only a little. As each day passes I believe that this honor was presented to me to become more responsible, which is for me the outward and visible sign that I am growing.

And if we face the challenges of the week ahead, we are all going to have another opportunity to grow a little more, and that for me is a side benefit of being here.

Last year, when I arrived at the Conference, I think I was like many others — overwhelmed, over prepared and maybe over anxious. Being only human I wanted to avoid making a mistake. As the days passed I came to believe that the greatest ability that the Fellowship as a whole has is the ability to withstand mistakes. Our safety does not come from making perfect decisions, our safety comes from being a group conscience. If something gets done less than perfectly there will be another Conference, another committee, another person, who will change it if it needs to be changed.

When I realized that I was part of the process and that, with you, I could do what I could not do by myself, some of the questions that nagged me were: Am I capable? Am I so uncertain? Should I really be here? Then they started to answer themselves, and I did what the oldtimers told me to do — I started to take it one day at a time.

Finally, as I look back over my journey here and reflect on all that has happened to me and for me because I did not take a drink today, I feel very humble that God and you have given me this opportunity.

I want to thank the G.S.O. staff for all the help I have received. They have surely made my work a lot easier. Thank you all and God bless you.

Vic Booth, Western Ontario
delegate chairperson

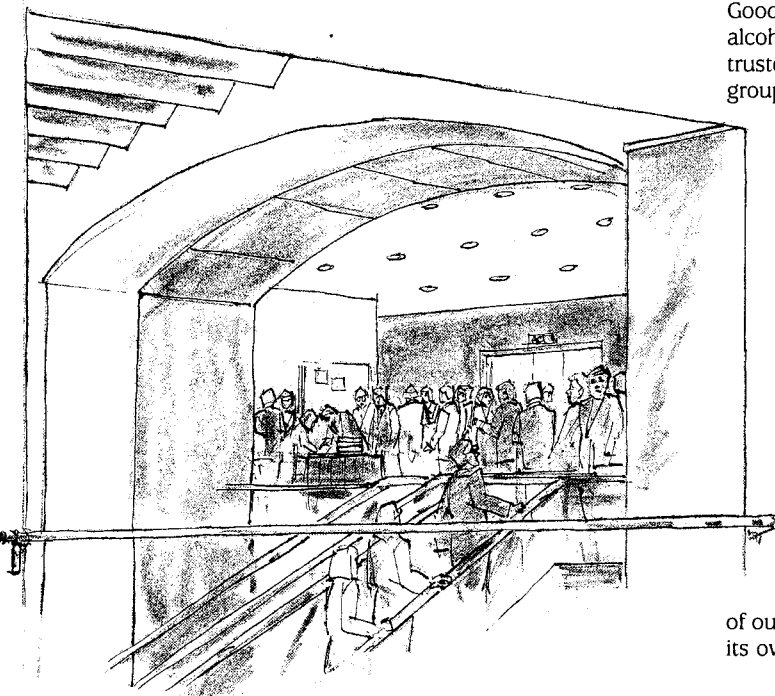
Keynote Address

Good morning friends, my name is MaryJane Roy and I am an alcoholic, serving for a few more hours as the Northeast Regional trustee. Greetings to you from the Ocean State and my home group, the Friday Night Big Book Group in Kingston, Rhode Island.

Many talks of this nature begin with dictionary definitions, but the words of this year's Conference theme are familiar. Moving and forward are surely clear and even Unity and Humility are generally understood. So, I looked up keynote. My dictionary said "a speech to present the issues of primary interest to an assembly — often to arouse unity and enthusiasm." I certainly hope so!

We understand Unity through Humility, but since the first sentence of Tradition One reads "The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has" (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 129), it surely merits our revisitation.

We didn't always have Unity. In the 1940s there were small scattered groups of alcoholics — sober but struggling — who communicated only with Dr. Bob and Bill. Very separate from the groups were the trustees of what was then the Alcoholic Foundation. There was talk about the possibility of a democratic gathering of representatives of our growing Fellowship coming together to have A.A. look after its own affairs.



In their last time together in 1950, when Dr. Bob was gravely ill, he said, "Bill, it *has* to be A.A.'s decision, not ours. Let's call that conference. It's fine with me." (*Pass It On*, p. 342)

So I think it is fitting to focus on Unity here in this room, during this event, our annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which came into being for the purpose of unifying our Society.

At this first experimental Conference, held in 1951, our co-founders essentially cut themselves out of the picture. For the good of A.A. they replaced themselves as the link between the groups and the board. I see this as a real demonstration of Unity through Humility. Twenty years later, in 1970 at our International Convention in Miami, Florida, I heard Bernard Smith, whom Bill called the architect of our general service structure, tell this story of why the Conference came into being. He said that this Conference had no power, no authority and constituted little more than a clambake. His telling of the story was moving and very memorable. I was just over two years sober and never dreamed that I would someday have this opportunity to be a part of it.

The theme of that Fifth Convention was Unity, and we adopted the Declaration of Unity on Saturday night after his talk. I want to read it now and invite you to join in if you would: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; To keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, And the lives of those to come."

So here we are today — 48 of these annual meetings have taken place. We have Unity. "But," as Bill said, "A.A. unity cannot automatically preserve itself. Like personal recovery, we shall always have to work to maintain it." (*A.A. Tradition, How It Developed*, p. 4)

Some examples of disunity come to mind. I know a man who says "while I am not always right, I am nearly always loud." A close friend of mine says "sometimes I would rather be right than get well." We all see dissension for its own sake; sometimes there is the notion that it is noble to be a maverick.

Please don't hear me say that there should be no opposition or scrutiny. Those are very valuable safeguards against our hasty impulses. But if I find myself many times at odds with our group conscience, I promise to call my sponsor. And really, it all does come down to what can I personally do; how can I subordinate my individual desires and ambitions for the common good?

The presentation topics and workshop categories focus on our cherished ideals, so I promise to receptively listen. I promise to speak up when I get that burning feeling that tells me that I have a piece of the puzzle. I promise to pray in the morning to be shown what is mine to do today, and ask for the grace to do it. I will remember the people who brought me to this day and alcoholics not yet here who deserve my best efforts. At the end of the week I will let go with both hands and experience Unity through Humility by rotation; we each have our gifts to bring and then move on.

In good cheer and good humor I wish us "a great clambake."

MaryJane Roy,
Northeast regional trustee

Workshop Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups of 11 to 13 for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme. Following are the questions and a summary of responses from these discussions.

1 Harmony in the A.A. Community

a) If your group, district or area experienced a lack of unity, what solutions did you find that brought about harmony? How do you encourage acceptance of decisions reached through group conscience?

The general sense of the meeting from all Workshops was that information and awareness of background on issues frequently results in unity and harmony. One area, where officers found themselves increasingly at odds, began to hold monthly meetings, and as the communication opened and information began to flow harmony began to emerge. One area used events like potluck dinners, dances etc. to get people working together and to support area services.

It was suggested that area officers be available to moderate group or district inventories; also, it is important to listen to the minority voice. Past delegates are often a great help and a source of information. Also, moving (assemblies) around the area to be more inclusive is helpful. Patience and prayer helped one group to deal with unity problems. Unity is achieved by utilizing the A.A. process. For example, giving everybody a chance to talk through a problem. Acceptance of decisions reached through group conscience is based on informed discussions and trust in our trusted servants and the group conscience process.

b) Share ways that your district and area committees cooperate with central or intergroup offices.

As districts grow, information needs to be shared; to have a liaison between area and intergroup is helpful. Some areas encourage groups to have their intergroup representative in attendance at area assembly meetings. Organize workshops on central/intergroup offices at assembly weekends. Right of participation and "bending over backwards" to be all-inclusive served one area quite well. They began to use the "Conference Process" in their deliberations; and the opportunity for minority opinions to be heard served to increase unity. One area has a system of "co-chairing" between districts and intergroups so that all committees have co-chairs from intergroup and district. Another area reported that after years of effort, the delegate was invited to intergroup meetings. One area, that had long been separated from intergroup, organized a 50th anniversary of A.A. and the result of the celebration and the work that went into it broke down years of separation.

Have a "Bridge the Gap" phone in intergroup office and include intergroup rep in assemblies. Inform and communicate.

c) If "... the aim of our services is to bring sobriety within the reach of all who want it,"¹ give examples of how groups in your area are carrying the A.A. message to under-represented populations.

One area has a member who goes to community centers to reach out





to the Korean and Vietnamese populations, verbally translating some basic pamphlets. Another area has done workshops with treatment center staffs, where members reach out to Native American clients in treatment and often accompany the client to A.A. meetings when they return to their communities. Make *all* in the community feel welcome; find ways to overcome mistrust. An area located adjacent to an Indian reservation brings meetings to the reservation. One area volunteers to cooperate with an inner-city outreach service by distributing complimentary A.A. literature. A.A. meetings are often brought into shelters and nursing homes. One area started Spanish-speaking meetings for immigrant farm workers and a Hispanic district was moved to re-unify with the area because the area offered the resources and services that had been unavailable to the Hispanic district when they were on their own. Another English-speaking area had a "Language Services" committee to assist Spanish-speaking groups.

2 Principle of Rotation

a) Discuss the relationship of rotation of service positions to Traditions Two and Nine.²

b) Do we, as trusted servants, encourage participation from all facets of A.A. in our community?

c) How does rotation reflect the spiritual principles of Tradition Twelve?³

Rotation is one of A.A.'s greatest strengths; it protects us from ourselves. Rotation is a principle necessary for growth in services. It is important for all of us to be responsible for choosing good trusted servants. When we rotate, we must resist the temptation to unduly influence successors. Past trusted servants might sponsor new trusted servants to encourage rotation. Delegates should not "lead," but "guide." At assemblies in one area, the past delegates meet together. All of us who serve long in service must "show by example" how the spirit of rotation is an important part of the group conscience. Concentrate on task/job and then move on. Ask for input. Do not govern or act as an authority. Use example of "Traditions play." One area recommended that there is not enough written on rotation in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

3 Spiritual Significance of Anonymity

a) Share why "We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have."⁴

b) If "The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice,"⁵ describe how you have let go of personal desires for the good of the group, district, area, or A.A. as a whole.

Once again, humility and anonymity protect us from ourselves. One way to practice humility is to do something significant for someone and not let anyone know. Remind members about anonymity at every A.A. meeting. Anonymity may be practiced as a Fellowship by not commenting on any outside issues (i.e. press, radio or film); we do not respond to attacks. As trusted servants we must have enough humility to refrain from offering our private opinions. We all need to examine the benefits of willingness to look at another point of view. Anonymity is ego-reducing — it helps us to be less selfish and to focus on the survival of A.A. as a whole. It also contributes to our growth as individuals, both in and out of A.A. Concentrate on inclusiveness and what is best for group. Put A.A. before Monday Night Football! Anonymity is the spirit of contributing and helping without demanding (or seeking) credit — it is the essence of A.A. service.

¹ *Alcoholics Anonymous Come of Age*, p. 120

² Tradition Two: "For our group purpose, there is but one ultimate authority — a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; the do not govern."

Tradition Nine: "A.A., as such, ought never be organized; but we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve."

³ Tradition Twelve: "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities."

⁴ *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 187

⁵ *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 132

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 1999 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

1 The following statement be added to the vacancy announcement letters for appointed committee member, nontrustee director, Class A trustee, regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada:

"In seeking applications for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

2 The theme for the 2000 General Service Conference be: "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles."

3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2000 General Service Conference:

a) Recovery:

- 1) Trust the God of Your Understanding
- 2) Clean House
- 3) Work With Others

b) Unity:

- 1) Our Common Welfare
- 2) The Informed Group Conscience and Substantial Unanimity
- 3) Practicing Genuine Humility Through Anonymity

c) Service:

- 1) I Am Responsible...
- 2) Our Primary Purpose
- 3) Spirit of Rotation

4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2000 General Service Conference:

Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles:

- a) Twelve Steps
- b) Twelve Traditions
- c) Twelve Concepts

ARCHIVES

It was recommended that:

5 The trustees' Archives Committee review the Archives Handbook and consider the need for any changes and/or an Archives Kit.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

6 In the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," the first six paragraphs on pages 18 & 19 under the heading "We Set Up A.A. Contacts" be replaced with the changes selected by the committee.

7 To get more A.A.s interested in participating in the Corrections Correspondence Service, the 1983 Conference Advisory Action that "A letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service be sent twice a year to delegates and correctional facilities [committee] chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write inmates on an individual basis" be reaffirmed.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

8 The annual limit contributed to the General Service Office from individual A.A. members be increased from \$1,000 to \$2,000 and that bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and be on a one-time only basis and not in perpetuity.

9 The General Service Conference supports the General Service Board policy which states: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

It was recommended that:

10 An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2000 International Convention.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

11 A progress report and/or a draft copy of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be brought to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind, that if a Fourth Edition Big Book is published, it will require Conference approval and the 1995 Advisory Action that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare,' and the Appendices remain as is."

12 The Publications Department of the General Service Office maintain the following specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project:

- Editorial "fine tuning," such as footnotes, punctuation, capitalization, spelling, updating, jacket materials, page numbers, etc. Thus, page numbers are likely to change for content after page 164.
- Coordinating the flow of work between the book designer, typesetters, proofreaders and the production people, who order the paper and schedule the printing with the book manufacturer.

- In the case of the proposed Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the G.S.O. editors would prepare or coordinate new material and changes such as:

New Material

Cover and jacket design
Jacket copy
Preface
Foreword to the Fourth Edition

Changes

Title Page
Contents page
Factual material that appears in footnotes
Introductions to personal stories

13 Based on precedent in regard to previous editions of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a "for-their-eyes-only" basis adhering to the principle of the "right of decision," and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication.

14 A draft copy of a pamphlet directed to the Black/African American alcoholic be developed and brought back to the 2000 Conference Literature Committee for review.

15 The pamphlet "Time to Start Living" be replaced with a new pamphlet to include fewer stories, stories more reflective of the current older population and stories focused more on the recovery experience of the older member, as well as having a new title and published in large print only.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

16 The 52nd General Service Conference be held April 21 - 27, 2002 since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

17 A subsection titled "A.A. Literature for Special Needs" be added to the "A.A. Fact File" in the section on A.A. Literature and agreed that the Publications Department develop the appropriate text since it pertains to catalog information.

18 The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 1998 Membership Survey.

19 The 1966 and 1974 Advisory Actions which stated that the film "Bill's Own Story" be for use by A.A. groups only, and that this film be released to Al-Anon groups under the same conditions, be reaffirmed.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

20 The review of *The A.A. Service Manual* undertaken by the Publications Department of the General Service Office as the result of a 1997 Conference Advisory Action be accepted, and that the revised manuscript distributed to all Conference members in April 1999 be approved as the 1999-2000 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

21 A soft-cover Treatment Facilities Kit, designated as service material, replace the current Workbook [3-ring binder] to be consistent with the other service committee kits. The committee recognized that much of the material in the Workbook was a duplication of Handbook materials.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

22 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 1999 (see pages 38-39 for approved slate).

23 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 39 for slate of directors approved).

24 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 39 for slate of directors approved).



Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report was given by Art Knight, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. The report was followed by questions and sharing. For more details please see the Finance section of this Report, and the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's report.

As a friend of Alcoholics Anonymous, I'm here today in gratitude, both for the wonderful gift A.A. has given to our family in the restored life of a precious loved one, and for the personal gift that association with this Fellowship has given me. As a nonalcoholic, I can truly attest to the power of this program for alcoholic and nonalcoholic alike. Thank you for the opportunity to be "in service," and "of service" (I hope), to this Fellowship.

As treasurer of the General Service Board, I have the pleasure of reporting on a subject near and dear to many an alcoholic's heart—money. Talking about money—finances—can be dull and difficult, and certainly not as inspiring as hearing the wonderful and important work this Fellowship does in North America, and indeed, around the globe. Yet Bill W. recognized, and wrote extensively about, the importance of financial soundness and stability to that primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Today, as we discuss A.A.'s finances, I hope to be able to relate the dull and sometimes difficult to understand numbers to that all-important job of reaching out and always being there.

In the back of this Report is the complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company. I want to formally acknowledge the outstanding service of Kevin Sunkel, our auditor, Don Meurer, G.S.O. controller, and Bob Slotterback, Grapevine controller. These three gentlemen, all nonalcoholics, are alive with the same love of this Fellowship that you have.

I have a business associate who's a fine businessman and a real marketing genius, but he hates numbers. Whenever we're in a meeting and financial matters come up, he always says: "Please, don't give me the 20/20 version, give me the CNN version." In other words, reduce the discussion to easy-to-understand sound bites and forget the details.

Well, if I followed my friend's advice, here's the A.A. Network News sound bite version of 1998's financial results:

1. Your Fellowship is in sound financial health and results for the year were essentially as expected.
2. The trends we have discussed over the past several years—both good and bad—continue.
3. The outlook for 1999 is very similar to 1998 and should continue to see the Fellowship in good financial health.

Now, those of you who are like my friend either can leave at this point, perhaps doze off or just sit back and think pleasant thoughts. However, for those of you that would like the more in-depth 20/20 version, let's take a look at the numbers.

Total revenues from all sources (the General Service Office and the Grapevine) and separately, the La Viña project, were \$9,979,000 compared to a budget of \$10,193,000. That is just \$214,000—or 2%—less than expected, and, generally speaking, reflects lesser sales from publishing activities across all the operations. Total operating expenses, fortunately, were also below projected budgets at each entity, and, therefore substantially offset the decline in revenues. As you see, total expenses were \$9,951,000 or just about \$140,000 less than the original budget.

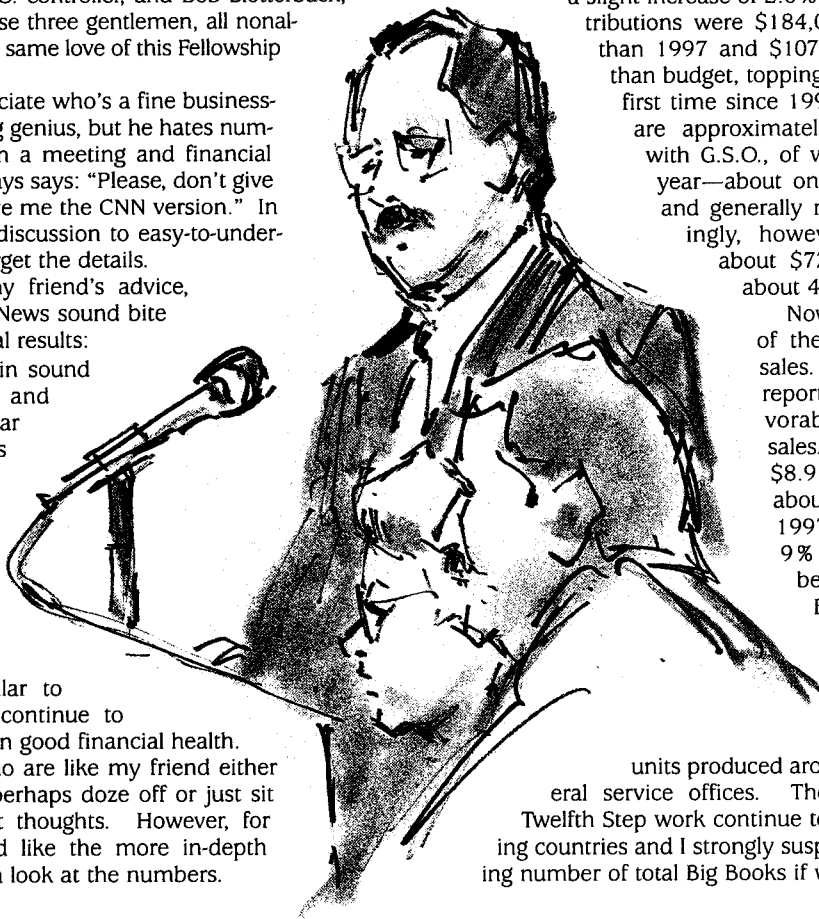
The net result was a modest profit at G.S.O. of about \$140,000, offset by a loss at the Grapevine of \$45,000 and a loss from the La Viña project of \$66,000. While the positive income at G.S.O. was somewhat less than originally expected (by about \$50,000), and the loss at La Viña slightly less (by about \$12,000), the loss at the Grapevine was \$35,000 greater than budget. The net result, however, was as close to breakeven as you could come with a very slight excess of revenue over expenses of about \$28,000. In my opinion, that's a satisfactory result and a credit to the responsiveness of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine in keeping expenses in line with revenues.

Now, let's take a closer look at G.S.O. and expand on my CNN sound bite about the trends continuing. As you know, generally speaking, G.S.O. gets its funding to support Fellowship services from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. When we put numbers to that equation, we see that last year, contributions provided in excess of \$4,000,000, and the net income from literature provided \$1,965,000 to defray the cost of services provided to the Fellowship by G.S.O. And that brings me to "good news" about one of the significant trends.

Based on the fact that contributions had appeared to stabilize and had actually improved in 1996, the budget projected a slight increase of 2.0% from '97 to '98. In fact, contributions were \$184,000, or almost 5.0%, higher than 1997 and \$107,000, or about 3.0% greater than budget, topping the \$4,000,000 mark for the first time since 1992—that's good news! There are approximately 56,400 groups registered with G.S.O., of which 44.6% contributed last year—about on par with the last four years and generally reflecting stability. Encouragingly, however, contributions averaged about \$72 per group, an increase of about 4% over last year.

Now, let's return to the other part of the income equation: literature sales. Here, unfortunately, I have to report a continuation of the unfavorable trend in literature unit sales. Literature revenue *dollars* at \$8.9 million were below budget by about 5%, and almost the same as 1997. Unit sales, however, were 9% lower than 1997. There has been a downward trend in Big Book unit sales over the last ten years. While this is clearly of concern, personally speaking, I wonder what would happen if we could add together all the

units produced around the world by various general service offices. The seeds of this Fellowship's Twelfth Step work continue to blossom in new and emerging countries and I strongly suspect we would find an increasing number of total Big Books if we could count them all.



When we deduct the cost associated with running the publishing operation, there is \$1,965,000 left to help defray the cost of services provided to the Fellowship by G.S.O. Said another way, contributions from groups, \$4,039,000, covers about 69% of our Service Expense of \$5,868,000. The profit from literature sales, \$1,965,000, provides about 31%. So, last year, G.S.O. essentially covered service costs and had approximately \$140,000 left over.

A couple of personal observations about these numbers: In the Second Warranty of the Twelfth Concept, Bill W. wrote: "In about half of the last twenty years, A.A. group contributions have failed to meet our world needs. But the Reserve Fund, constantly renewed by book sales, has been able to meet these deficits—and save money besides. What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent, no one can guess. Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p.65)

We could update the date, and say the same thing today. While literature unit sales continue to decline, income from literature continues to help A.A. meet the needs Bill so eloquently defined. For this year, based on last year's experience, G.S.O. has established an income budget that assumes a further 6% decline in literature unit sales, and a modest 1.5% increase in contributions. The projected income for this year, therefore, is \$8,854,500, an increase of about 3.5% over last year.

Now that we know where the money comes from, let's take a look at where it goes. Again, a detailed breakdown is in the audited statements, but I like to look at our expenses "by type" and "by service." Not surprisingly, as a service organization to the Fellowship, the bulk of G.S.O.'s spending (about \$5.9 million in 1998) is on services to the Fellowship. As I learn more about G.S.O., I am continually impressed by the enormous range of services that dedicated staff members and employees provide in a quiet and efficient way. Again I think of Bill's words from that Second Warranty: "What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or nonexistent...." The next biggest chunk of our spending by service relates to what I would characterize as "getting together to share." That ranges from this Conference to Regional Forums to traveling to assemblies at all levels of the Fellowship. Finally, publishing all the shared experience through the many newsletters and communications that flow from G.S.O. and the support services required to operate the office form the balance and smallest portion of expenses.

If we look at our expenses a different way, by type of expense, we can see that people costs—salaries and benefits—for the G.S.O. employees, both alcoholic and nonalcoholic, who perform all those services are, not surprisingly, our largest expense. Next comes direct service costs, such as communications pieces, free literature, and the associated expenses of writing, mailing, etc., as well as the "getting together costs" I referred to before. Running the office—paying for everything from rent to paperclips—is our third largest category, while all other expenses (including things like the cost of our audited financial report) are last.

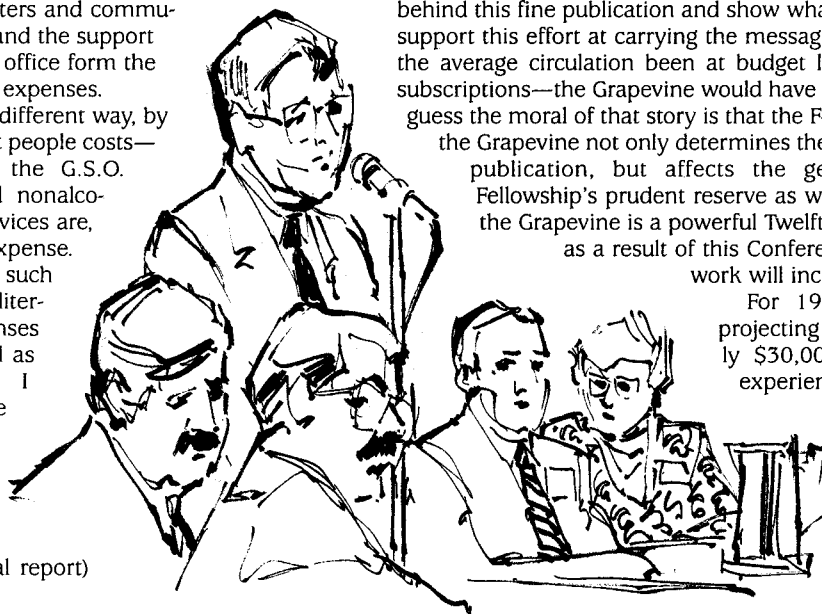
In total, G.S.O.'s expenses last year were \$8,423,000. On a group basis, spending to support services to groups averaged \$104, slightly less than the \$106 from the prior year. While the volume of communications and correspondence increases at the G.S.O., spending remains essentially flat. In my opinion, this reflects both some of the benefits of employing new technology and the "financial prudence" of everyone at the General Service Office. There's no question in my mind that the Fellowship gets very cost-effective service from this dedicated group of people.

This year, expenses are projected to increase just 3.0%, and reflect a modest increase in salaries and other people-related costs as the most significant component. Therefore, with income up about 3.5%, we hope to see a slight excess of income over expense for the year, projected at just \$174,000. In my book, I call that a tight break-even budget.

Turning to the Grapevine, we can view its financial health in a similar way. Like G.S.O., it receives its income from sales of its principal publication, the Grapevine magazine, as well as sales of other special items, like *The Language of the Heart*, other specialty literature, tapes and calendars. However, by its very charter, the Grapevine receives no contributions, and therefore, if it cannot break-even, it must look to the Reserve Fund to make up any deficit. If we put numbers to the question "Where Does the Money Come From?" we see that the Grapevine operates on income of about \$1.4 million dollars. That's after all the costs to produce the magazine and related items. Interestingly, since the editorial costs of producing the magazine are "fixed"—or the same, regardless of whether one or a million copies are sold, the impact of any change in circulation is dramatic and can mean the difference between being self-supporting or having to tap into the Reserve Fund.

For example, last year all costs for editorial, circulation and administrative expenses were about \$1.4 million dollars, so the Grapevine needed help from the Reserve Fund to cover its loss of \$45,000. However, last year, average circulation was just about 117,000, a decline from the prior year of about 3,000 subscriptions. Here's one of those trends again: the Grapevine (our principal publication to carry the message of recovery in print on a timely basis) has now experienced three consecutive years of average circulation decline, despite the enormous efforts by the board and staff to get the message out to those who need this publication. In my opinion, it's time for this Fellowship to get behind this fine publication and show what can really be done to support this effort at carrying the message. As an example, had the average circulation been at budget level—just 3,000 more subscriptions—the Grapevine would have been self-supporting. I guess the moral of that story is that the Fellowship's response to the Grapevine not only determines the financial health of the publication, but affects the general health of the Fellowship's prudent reserve as well. Like the Big Book, the Grapevine is a powerful Twelfth Step tool. Hopefully, as a result of this Conference, your Twelfth Step work will include the Grapevine.

For 1999, the Grapevine is projecting a loss of approximately \$30,000, less than the loss experienced this past year, but still not self-supporting. In my opinion, this budget relies totally on the Fellowship for fulfillment. The assumptions require a posi-





tive response to the publication and related-item sales to reach 1999 goals. It's not Ames' job, it's not the boards' job, it's the Fellowship's job to endorse the work being done at the Grapevine.

As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1998 average circulation of just 7,700. That's well short of the 8,400 recorded last year and even further behind the 9,500 subscriptions budgeted for the year. Despite this drop in circulation, the La Viña project recorded a loss of \$66,000 versus the \$78,000 originally budgeted. Lower magazine direct production costs and circulation and business expenses help to mitigate the revenue shortfall. Personally speaking, the Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality publication that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. Like the Grapevine itself, the editorial and preparation costs are the same—whether one or a million copies are produced—so circulation growth is critical to the magazine's success.

To date, the project has incurred losses of \$336,000, and those losses have been funded from the Reserve Fund. For 1999, La Viña is budgeted to show a loss of about \$70,000, based on an average circulation *decrease* to 7,500 subscriptions. Obviously, if circulation increases beyond the projected level, the loss will be reduced, and, conceivably could be eliminated. Later this week, Greg Tobin will be reviewing the various options the Grapevine Board is considering to seek your input on the future of this project.

And that brings me to the final CNN sound bite of my opening comments: the outlook for 1999 is much like 1998. To summarize what we have reviewed today—revenues increase a slight 3.6%, while operating expenses increase 3.1 percent. The projected net profit at G.S.O. is slightly better than this past year, but in my opinion it is very tight. The loss at the Grapevine declines, while the loss at La Viña increases. Both budgets, in my opinion, are optimistic and require full Fellowship support for attainment.

In total, the combined results are projected to be slightly better than last year and, again, essentially at a breakeven level.

All this brings me to my final point (now those of you who accepted my invitation to doze or just think pleasant thoughts might want to rejoin the group now)—that's the health of the Reserve Fund. Since I've already invoked the Second Warranty, let me quote its opening sentence, which is drawn from the Traditions: "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, should be its prudent financial principle." (*ibid*, p.63)

As you can see, following three years of planned operating losses to bring the Reserve Fund back to a "prudent" (under 10 month) state, we are clearly there. Last year, the fund was stable as losses at the Grapevine and La Viña were offset by the modest profit at G.S.O. The fund now stands at just nine months reserve and, given the expectations for 1999, should remain at about that level. Therefore, I can report to you today that your Fellowship is financially healthy. Let me reiterate Bill's admonition from the Second Warranty: "Financial prudence has paid off in lives saved."

Arthur L. Knight, Jr.

Class A trustee & treasurer, G.S.B.

OUR RESPONSIBILITY TO A.A. UNITY

Monday evening's presentation session was chaired by Jim Skees, Kentucky.

The Home Group

The Home Group is the basic unit of A.A., the vessel in which the message is carried and the very base upon which our society is constructed. It is at the Home Group where the development of conscience, so critical to A.A. unity and effectiveness, must begin. There is nowhere else where newcomers will hear of the princi-

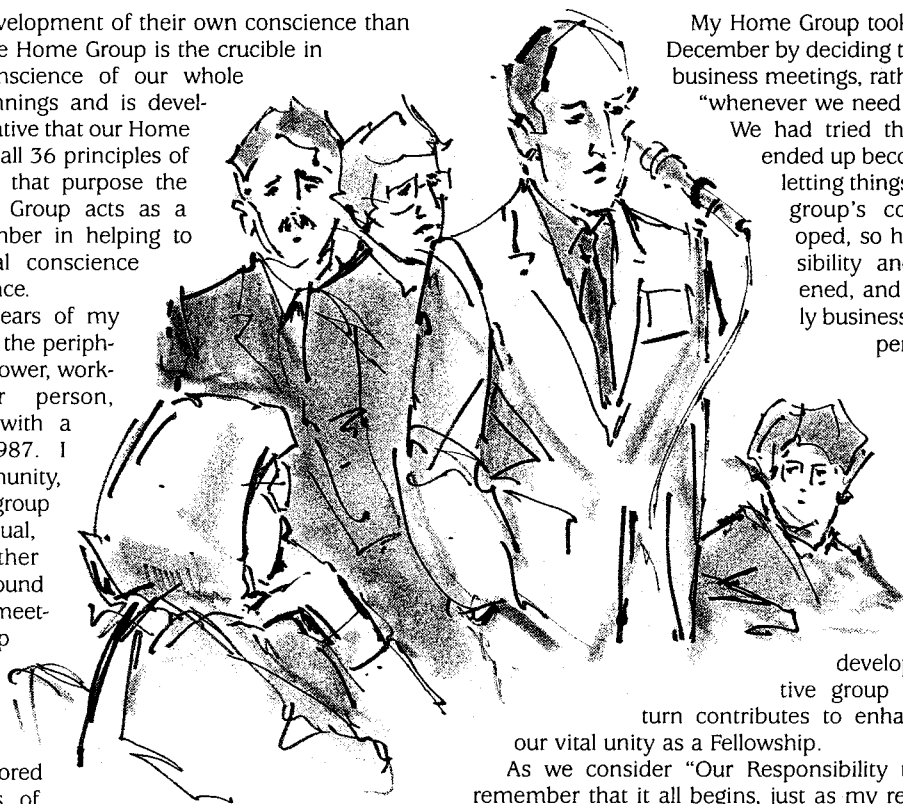
ples so crucial to the development of their own conscience than in the Home Group. The Home Group is the crucible in which the ultimate conscience of our whole Fellowship has its beginnings and is developed. And so it is imperative that our Home Group be a place where all 36 principles of A.A. are discussed. To that purpose the structure of the Home Group acts as a "sponsor" to each member in helping to develop their individual conscience and the group's conscience.

For the first three years of my being sober, I floated on the periphery of A.A. The Higher Power, working through another person, changed that for me with a phone call in January 1987. I live in a small rural community, which had no local A.A. group at that time. That individual, myself, and a few other loner members from around the community began meeting regularly as a group the following Tuesday night. My friend brought with him ten years of sobriety. He had been well sponsored into all Three Legacies of A.A. and he gently insisted that we immediately get active in the local district. He sponsored our group at once into general service. I attended my first area assembly two months later, with my new friend at my side. At our group, we talked about unity and service as well as recovery. Confusion was replaced with understanding of the principles of A.A. Our consciences were gradually being developed.

The Home Group needs to provide the structure within itself to develop the newcomer's conscience, as older members rotate, move away, or pass on. The structure of my Home Group has continued to evolve over the years. We began as a topic, or discussion, meeting. A few years down the road, the group conscience decided to change to an alternating Step/discussion format. We continued to be active in general service, and one day someone suggested we do a group inventory. From this process came a decision to start reading "The A.A. Tradition" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 563) and the Twelve Traditions from the Big Book before every meeting.

A few years passed and the group took another risk in the ongoing development of its structure and conscience. It decided to designate one meeting a month where a Tradition would be the suggested meeting topic, using the reading from the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" to begin the discussion.

There were concerns from some of us that there would be too much reading, that newcomers would not understand and would sit there in a state of bewilderment and boredom, maybe even bolting en masse for the nearest exit! But that never happened. Our newer members listened attentively, nodding as they related to and contributed to the ensuing discussion. Their eyes widened as they slowly came to view and understand a different dimension of the Fellowship. They were beginning to see through the lenses of our Twelve Traditions. Their consciences were developing within the structure of their Home Group. As their individual consciences began to develop, so too did that of our group conscience.



My Home Group took another risk this past December by deciding to hold regular monthly business meetings, rather than the haphazard "whenever we need one" type of meeting. We had tried this before, and always ended up becoming discouraged and letting things slide away. But as the group's conscience has developed, so has its sense of responsibility and commitment deepened, and it appears our monthly business meeting is taking on a permanent nature.

We now have another avenue within the Home Group structure to assist in the development of group conscience. Our conscience is carried forward to the district, area, and Conference. This contributes to the

development of their respective group conscience, which in

turn contributes to enhancing and preserving our vital unity as a Fellowship.

As we consider "Our Responsibility to A.A. Unity," let us remember that it all begins, just as my recovery begins, in that basic unit of A.A.—the Home Group. As the Fellowship of A.A. continues to move forward, it is only our precious unity that allows us to continue to provide a safe harbor for those hopelessly adrift on a sea of alcoholism, as well as providing refuge and recovery for those who have already found rescue. And it will be with the development of a genuine humility, through the practice of the Twelve Steps in our lives, and of the Twelve Traditions in our group affairs, that will ensure our priceless unity and effectiveness, for as long as He may need us.

Tom Kraemer, Saskatchewan

The A.A. Service Structure

When I received my loving invitation to give this presentation, the first thing that came to mind was my sponsor. She always used to tell me, "When you get asked to speak or do a service for A.A., smile and say yes first, you can always worry later." She also said that there was no job in A.A. that was too big, and if I didn't know how to do the task at hand I could always call her, and if she didn't know how we could always call her sponsor. It was explained to me that there was no shame in not knowing how to do something, that we were all in this together. And so I felt like all I had to do was look over my shoulder and there would be an army of people there when I needed them. And so now, for the record, in case my sponsor reads this, I would like to say thank you for this opportunity to share a few thoughts about the Service Structure of Alcoholics Anonymous.

What is the Conference Plan? "It is a method by which A.A.'s collective group conscience can speak forcefully and put its desires for worldwide services into effect. It is the structure that takes the place of government in A.A. It insures that the full voice of A.A. will be heard, whether it represents the great majority or a minority. The Conference plan was established as a guarantee that our movement-wide services would continue to function

under all conditions. The plan provides a practical successor to the founders of A.A.” (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S22) When I look at the diagram of the service structure of A.A. it looks just like a family tree. The Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous are in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p.49). “The chief inheritances of the first twenty years of Alcoholics Anonymous are the Legacies of Recovery, of Unity, and of Service. By the first we recover from alcoholism; by the second we stay together in unity; and by the third our society functions and serves its primary purpose of carrying the A.A. message to all who need it and want it.”

That means that we inherited all the information that is in each committee at this Conference. It is ours for the asking. I was told that if we have any information that is important to the people of A.A., whether it is in a home group, area assembly or at the Conference, it is our responsibility to share that information. You may be the only person in the room that has the answer to the question being asked. Sometimes this is not a comfortable spot to be in and it would be easier to remain silent, but our love of this Fellowship and sometimes a little nudge from a higher power urges us to do the right thing. Again in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p.139) it says, “A.A.’s Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is the basic service that our fellowship gives; it is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of recovered alcoholics in action. We *must* carry A.A.’s message; otherwise we ourselves may fall into decay and those who have not yet been given the truth may die.” And we all know that in the true spirit of unity, this means that we stand “All for One and One for All.” What can I say now to you, of all people. You have all been active in service, and I believe that true humility is staying in the meetings and doing the same positions over and over again and again, by being there and being ready at any time to pass on all the knowledge that we can whenever we can.

When I was in my first few months of sobriety I attended a service workshop and on that day the delegate made a challenge to all of us who were there. She said “Who will stand up for A.A.—will you?” I thought she was talking directly to me. At the end of the workshop a new member was asked to read “Why Do We Need a Conference?” I could not remember everything that was read that day but I did hear him read, “We do need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who stumbles in the darkness one short block from this room. We need it to insure the recovery of a child being born tonight, destined to alcoholism.” (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S43) Being a little selfish that day, and only 31 years old, I remember thinking that it might be a good idea if A.A. were here for me in 20 years also.

And now for the rest of the story. I would like to share a little of my own personal experience in A.A. As I was going along my way in A.A., at nineteen years in this Fellowship, I found myself at a business meeting of the Off the Wall Group, being elected to the position of opener and coffee maker once again! One night, as I was making the coffee, through the doors of our Fellowship walked a brand new girl. She was nineteen years old, and as we talked I was able to pass on our inheritance, all that experience, strength and hope that had been given to me from our family tree of A.A. history. And the message was still the same for her, as it had been for me on the day that I arrived at the doors of this Fellowship. I had come full circle in my journey from that service workshop years ago, when I was challenged to “Stand up for A.A.” And today, taking it one day at a time in this wonderful Fellowship where “...action is the magic word.” (*A.A. Comes of Age*, pp. 139-140). I have been sober now twice as long as I drank, and that is truly a miracle.

Elaine Owen, Maine

A.A. Worldwide

The great diversity of population in the United States and Canada—race, ethnic origin, religion and multiple languages and dialects—is a clear indication that the alcohol problem recognized by Dr. Bob and Bill in 1935 in Akron, Ohio, and New York City, was worldwide. The early publication of articles on alcoholism and A.A., printed in the *Cleveland Plain Dealer* newspaper and *Liberty* magazine, culminated in the Jack Alexander article on A.A. in 1941 in the *Saturday Evening Post*.

Dr. Carl Jung, a psychiatrist in Switzerland, Dr. William Silkworth’s work at Towns Hospital with alcoholics, and the early A.A. groups in the United States and Canada contributed to the sharing of information on alcoholism that helped A.A. find its way overseas and into other countries. The publication of the Big Book, in 1939, provided a specific formula and design for living for a person who wanted to stop drinking. The A.A. message was eagerly received in many parts of the world.

Bill Wilson was a visionary. He recognized that the written word, explaining the message of recovery as set out in the Big Book, might be the impetus for forming A.A. groups in foreign countries and, ultimately, service structures to support those groups. Throughout the world the message of recovery—from one alcoholic to another and through the Big Book—was received by those desperate people who were suffering from alcohol abuse with no answer or solution to their problem. The Big Book is now published in 36 languages, with several more translations pending.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, at the urging of Bill Wilson in 1967, launched an inquiry to countries where the largest A.A. populations existed, suggesting the possibility of a World Service Meeting to be held in New York in 1969. The letter was sent to representatives in the United Kingdom, Australia, New Zealand, France, Belgium, Germany, Finland, Costa Rica, Honduras, Guatemala, El Salvador, Panama and Nicaragua, Mexico, Norway, South Africa and Holland.

Bill W. pointed out that the A.A. message would best be served by protecting our literature through copyrights. The Current (U.S./Canada) Conference Charter permits our Conference to authorize a general service board or other service entity to publish our copyrighted literature for use in their country. A.A. World Services holds these copyrights in trust for A.A. worldwide. The General Service Board recognized that A.A. must have top leadership to create those vital services that could not be provided locally on a haphazard basis. If we failed to do this, A.A. would have surely fallen into an anarchy and the message of recovery would have been lost to the suffering alcoholic.

Eventually the World Service Meeting would include four standing committees: Agenda, Policy/Admissions/Finance, Literature/Publishing, and Working With Others. World Service Meetings are held every two years, alternating between New York City and another country. Each country may send two delegates who serve for two-year terms on a rotation basis—as do our delegates to the General Service Conference, U.S./Canada.

All World Service Meeting delegates are to have a working knowledge of either Spanish or English. On occasion, other languages are spoken when translators are available. This past October, at the 15th World Service Meeting in Auckland, New Zealand, interpreters were available in Spanish, Polish, and Japanese. French translations were provided by Michel G., trustee-at-large/Canada.

“In Newfoundland we have tall buildings, just like New York. But we lay them on their side and use them for shopping malls,” said delegate Boyd Snook.

Several years ago it was recognized that regional or meetings would be helpful to countries that could not attend World Service Meetings because of administration and travel expenses. Established Interim and Zonal meetings are: Meeting of the Americas (consisting of countries in North and South America); the Asia-Oceania Meeting (with delegates from Asia and the Pacific rim) and the European Service Meeting. Reports of the zonal meetings are an important part of the World Service Meeting.

The theme of the 15th World Service Meeting in Auckland, New Zealand, "Service—Basic to Personal Recovery and A.A. Unity," provided a format for a varied program of presentations, workshops and sharing sessions. It was truly a spiritual experience enjoyed by 39 delegates representing 21 countries. The 16th World Service Meeting will be held in New York City, October 22-26 in the year 2000, where the theme will be "A.A., Our Future is Our Responsibility."

The vision of Bill Wilson and the General Service Board in 1969 for A.A. worldwide has become a reality. There is A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 44 countries that have General Service Offices, composed of an estimated 646,938 members. The opportunity to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic is unlimited. It is estimated in the Pacific rim region that there are 100 million potential members of Alcoholics Anonymous with tremendous growth of A.A. occurring in Eastern Europe, Mexico and Central and South America. The universal Language of the Heart provides sobriety and a new way of life for all people of the world, through the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S.

MOVING FORWARD: A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

The following presentation, followed by a discussion session, occurred Wednesday just before lunch.

15th World Service Meeting

The 15th World Service Meeting was held in New Zealand, October 4th to 8th, 1998. This was my second World Service Meeting and, again, I was overwhelmed by the need and the will demonstrated by each World Service delegate to carry the message of A.A. around the world. This brings our topic into action, Moving Forward: A.A. Around the World.

The highlight of the 15th World Service Meeting was the sharing by the French-speaking Europe delegate of the Twelfth Step work that is being done on the African continent. Jean Yves shared the background that led to A.A. members traveling to Cameroon to transmit the message to suffering alcoholics. He recalled that in 1986, an alcoholic by the name of Donatien in Cameroon, who was institutionalized many times for alcoholism, was sent to a mission to

recover from a coma. One day, feeling better, he went to the mission library and picked up a book in which there was a piece of paper with the address of the G.S.O. in France. He started writing and a member named Annie replied. Every time this man would get drunk, he would write again and always would receive a reply from Annie. Annie was at one time a WSM delegate and also had helped start the G.S.O. in France and the European Francophone Committee.

She became the sponsor of our friend Jean Yves and this is how he found out about Donatien. When Annie passed away, Jean Yves continued the communications until one day he received a letter in which Donatien said he had been sober for two months. Jean Yves suggested that he form an A.A. group in the prison where he works as a guard and sent him A.A. literature. Jean Yves added that, if Donatien was able to stay sober, he would visit him, which he did in 1997 after getting the support of his board and conference. After his first visit, there were two A.A. groups in Cameroon. Jean Yves and his alternate, Jean Francois, returned in 1998 without any expectations, just hoping that Donatien and his friends would still be sober. Much to their surprise, not only were they sober, but there were now ten groups in Cameroon. During their visit, they helped in starting an intergroup and other A.A. groups. There are now 14 A.A. groups in Cameroon, two English-speaking and 12 French-speaking.

Jean Yves requested help from other countries, particularly our U.S./Canada Conference, regarding pleas for help that have been received from Togo, Congo, Benin, Central Republic of Africa, Senegal, Gabon and others. The A.A. miracle has happened on the African continent with the help of government authorities, religious missions (Mariste), the police and prison authorities.

The plea for help has been heard and I am happy to report that our board has agreed to help in carrying the message to the suffering alcoholics in Africa. We will hear more about the ways of carrying the message into Africa in the near future. When I thought about the various ways we might take the message to the African continent, it became obvious that this would be a challenge. It certainly would not be like a regular Twelfth Step call in the U.S. or Canada. However, at the same time I was going

through this thought process, I received a letter from a delegate using a quote from our Big Book in the chapter "Working With Others" which states: "Your job now is to be at the place where you may be of maximum helpfulness to others, so never hesitate to go anywhere if you can be helpful. You should not hesitate to visit the most sordid spot on earth on such an errand. Keep on the firing line of life with these motives and God will keep you unharmed." (p. 102)

This brings us back to our Conference theme: Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility. In closing, I want to express my gratitude for having had the privilege of serving our Fellowship as World Service delegate U.S./Canada at the last two World Service Meetings,

and as trustee-at-large/Canada. Thank you for your support.

*Michel Girard,
trustee-at-large/
Canada*



2000 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Wednesday afternoon the International Convention Coordinator spoke on Conventions, past and present. The talk was followed by a question and answer period and a five-minute film of Minneapolis, Minnesota, the host city. Peter Roach, Class A trustee, moderated the program.

“Pass It On—Into the 21st Century”

From June 29 to July 2, 2000, we will meet in celebration of A.A.'s 65th Birthday, at our International A.A. Convention in Minneapolis, Minnesota. This very special event will be packed-full with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons, mini-marathons and, of course, the Big Meetings and other events at the Metrodome Stadium. Thursday evening starts off with a Block Party on the Main Street of Minneapolis. There will be three or four dances, with your choice of rock, salsa or fifties music.

At midnight on Thursday, two major marathon meetings get underway, one in English and one in Spanish. These meetings will run continuously until Sunday morning. All day Friday and Saturday, there will be A.A. meetings, in various languages, going on at the Convention Center as well as at the Hilton, Regal and Hyatt hotels.

Friday night is always very special. We will meet at the Metrodome Stadium and will mark the Opening Ceremonies with a Parade of Flags of those countries in attendance—probably over 80 flags—followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. Saturday night there is an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting with speakers to be selected from the hat. Sunday morning the Closing Meeting will be held at the Stadium. Complimentary shuttle buses will be available to and from Metrodome Stadium events, the Convention Center and any other Convention sites.

Beginning with the first one in Cleveland in 1950, A.A.'s International Conventions have often been milestones in the growth of our Fellowship; high points in the celebration of sobriety; and moving spiritual experiences for those who attended. Held every five years to celebrate the anniversary of our founding, our International Conventions have grown to be some of the largest events of their kind in the world. Our co-founder, Bill W., saw these big conclaves as ceremonial occasions where Alcoholics Anonymous could express its collective conscience. So in 1950, when three thousand A.A.s converged on Cleveland, A.A. marked its 15th Anniversary by endorsing the Twelve Traditions to assure the survival of our groups.

Just as today, the remainder of that weekend was taken up with the speakers and panels; discussions over coffee; reunions with old friends, introductions to new ones and numerous social events. Undoubtedly, one of the most memorable events that weekend was Dr. Bob's talk. Dr. Bob was a sick man, mortally sick. Like the true Vermonter he was, he fought his illness and left his Akron home to come to the first Convention. Those in the audience that day long remembered the waves of love that seemed to lift the frail, elderly man to the podium. Mastering his failing strength, he shared the platform with Bill on Sunday morning and left us his last message. When the meeting was over, Dr. Bob left that hall never to face an A.A. audience again.

Bill, conscious of his own mortality, worked for the next several years to develop the mechanisms to insure A.A.'s existence without his personal leadership. Once again, gearing his actions towards an International Convention, his efforts culminated in the summer of 1955 in St. Louis, Missouri. Five thousand A.A.s gathered at the Keil Auditorium to celebrate A.A.'s 20th Anniversary and to transact, what was for Bill, the most impor-

tant business in our history. On the final day of the Convention, all of the members of the General Service Conference, which had now been in existence on a trial basis for five years, were gathered on stage. Bill, after one of his most stirring addresses, formally turned over responsibility for A.A.'s Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service to the Conference. He felt his major work for A.A. was virtually done and that the future of Alcoholics Anonymous was safe.

In 1965 in Toronto, Bill used the Declaration of Responsibility as the Keynote of his opening talk: “I am Responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible.”

A dramatic moment occurred when later in the Convention all those attending rededicated themselves to these principles by reciting the declaration in unison. At one point in his talk, while challenging complacency, Bill asked his listeners, “What happened to the 600,000 people who have approached A.A. and left?” In conclusion, re-emphasizing the responsibility theme, he estimated that the program and Fellowship had “reached less than ten per cent” of those needing help.

The theme of the 35th Anniversary gathering in Miami was the Declaration of Unity: “This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; To keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, And the lives of those to come.”

Like previous Conventions these powerful themes and dedications were matched for most in attendance by beautiful surroundings and great facilities. Sharing and fellowship were important for those in attendance that weekend, but the overriding issue at the 1970 Convention was Bill W. People had caught glimpses of him being taken back and forth from his hotel to the hospital. His emphysema was so bad he had to cancel all appearances. By the Sunday morning meeting, it was doubtful he'd appear at the last event of the Convention. Then, suddenly, just as the meeting was beginning, Dr. Jack Norris went to the mike and said, “Our prayers have been answered.” Curtains at the rear of the stage parted and Bill Wilson, in a wheelchair, was pushed forward. Rushed over from the hospital in an ambulance, he was hooked up to oxygen. Responding to a standing ovation by the 14,000 in attendance, he grabbed the podium and pulled himself erect and once again addressed his beloved fellow A.A.s.

Bill's mighty assurance about the health and growth of A.A. was justified. Though saddened by his death, seven months later, the Fellowship continued to grow with amazing speed. As we meet in Minneapolis in 2000 we will look back with gratitude and look forward with hope as we follow those who came before us and “Pass It On — Into the 21st Century.”

Valerie O'Neill, 2000 International Convention coordinator

LA VIÑA: A PROGRESS REPORT

Moderator for this presentation/discussion period was Greg Tobin, Grapevine director.

Circulation Issues

La Viña, which is still just a “beginner” in its start-up phase with only 18 bimonthly issues in print, has been a terrific success as a magazine. We can be proud of how it looks, what it says, how its readers have responded to the message it carries. It has been a success in terms of reach, with a distribution of about 7,500 copies of each issue. The management and staff of the Grapevine have pulled together to make each issue happen. The Grapevine Corporate Board has examined and reexamined the circulation numbers and costs. The trustees' Finance Committee



has demanded careful scrutiny of the budget. So, like all beginners in A.A., La Viña has received a lot of help and encouragement and sustenance from the Fellowship.

After almost three years of publication and a number of interim reevaluations of the original business plan and revised financial projections, the La Viña business operation has been pared down to its bare essentials. The magazine itself is a high-quality product, and after some initial fulfillment problems (over the first year and a half), we have developed a positive on-time delivery system. La Viña and Grapevine are now maintained on the same computer system, which is helpful to both subscribers and management in providing service and reducing cost.

We do not foresee any dramatic increase in circulation that would drastically alter the picture as we approach the close of the five-year experimental period. With production values remaining flat, we do not see any dramatic reduction in what it costs to publish La Viña.

Let's consider some significant information which puts La Viña in a clearer context. In magazine publishing, we talk about the "universe," that is, the number of people who represent the estimated maximum readers for any publication. For example, if we consider the one million A.A. members estimated to reside in the U.S. and Canada and then we look at the current subscriber base of between 115-120,000, we can say that the Grapevine is delivered to about one in ten members. La Viña, however, is delivered to at least *one out of every five* members of the Spanish-speaking A.A. community in the U.S. and Canada, which is estimated at 30,000 people. That is an incredibly strong readership without even taking into account the "pass along" readership for the publication.

We've done many things to make La Viña work. For example, we had a special gift offer—give a gift subscription and receive a complimentary copy of the Spanish Edition of *The Language of the Heart*. And starting with the July/August 1998 issue, we've included a postage-paid subscription order card with the issue. (We also use these cards for distribution at A.A. service functions.) So far, we've received about 275 orders from these cards alone.

Starting in March 1998, we tried to contact all 45 Hispanic intergroups and D.C.M.s. Then, earlier this year, we did a special

mailing to intergroups with a letter from the editor and an offer of 10 complimentary copies of every issue. We have about 260 registered R.L.V.s who have been receiving complimentary copies of each issue since May 1998.

Specific areas in the service structure have been busy as well. Area 30 purchased 101 two-copy La Viña subscriptions this year for inpatient detox facilities, rehabs and outpatient programs. Twenty areas have also contributed a total of 55 subscriptions in response to our GvR network half-price offer for treatment and correctional facilities. Now that La Viña and Grapevine are on the same fulfillment system, we are able to use the Spanish version of our Grapevine renewal series, the notices we begin to send a few months before a subscription expires.

In addition to the Spanish-speaking Fellowship at large, La Viña also reaches the professional community and a significant population within prisons. If allowed to develop, La Viña may prove to be an even more powerful Twelfth Step tool in these areas.

Recently, we surveyed a combination of former La Viña subscribers and Hispanic D.C.M.s, Intergroups and RLVs. Many of them told us that they had first seen La Viña either at an A.A. meeting or a service meeting or assembly. The intergroups asked especially for more emphasis on development of gift subscriptions and other special offers as a way to increase the subscriber base. And we know that 225 individuals responded positively to last season's special gift offer. In fact, if every member of the General Service Conference were to give a gift subscription of La Viña to a friend or an A.A. group, there would be a significant increase in our circulation. That would certainly have a big impact on the "bottom line" and would further demonstrate the level of Fellowship-wide support.

Yes, there have been moments over the past few years when we—that is, everyone involved with the health and well-being of our Spanish-language magazine—have seen the specter of failure rising to cast a shadow on the survival of La Viña: failure defined as circulation lower than we originally expected or dollar losses higher than we are comfortable with. And we work every day to increase the circulation numbers and decrease costs and expenses. Yet despite times of doubt and questioning, there is no way we can call the magazine a failure, because we—A.A. members

throughout the Fellowship and the Conference—have done our very best to fulfill the mission entrusted to us.

La Viña carries the A.A. message to places the Grapevine and other literature has not and could not. We will continue to use every creative effort at our disposal to maintain and increase La Viña circulation. With prayer and hard work and the participation of the Spanish-speaking A.A. community, with fiscal vigilance and high editorial standards and the participation of the A.A. Fellowship, La Viña can flourish and survive.

*Mary Pat Hester,
Grapevine Circulation director*

Editorial Issues

I have been privileged for over three years to serve as the editor of La Viña since its inception in 1996. It has been an amazing experience to see the magazine itself develop into an authentic reflection of the Latino A.A. experience in the U.S. and all over the world—and to hear directly from the members of the Fellowship for whom La Viña has been a spiritual and practical gift. We receive at least 20 letters a week from readers, many of which are submissions of articles. It is clear that the people who are reading the magazine are responding positively to it.

Although we have not had the resources to devote very much effort in terms of trying to reach readers in Latin America, there is great interest in the magazine there, and it is an area of potential future expansion. Approximately 10% of our total subscription base comes from Latin America, and we receive more correspondence and requests for subscription information from there. Although there are six or seven of their own national journals, La Viña is increasingly popular, which gives us a wider international projection and sources for articles as well as subscriptions. People in Latin countries look up to what we do here in the U.S. because this is where A.A. was born.

One of the things our magazine is doing is publishing for the first time in a systematic manner how A.A. began in Latin America and in the different states in the U.S. where there is a large Hispanic population. There are interesting articles about the first Hispanic meetings in Texas and California. It is very important to our Spanish-speaking community to learn how we came about in this country; who were our pioneers, the people who were important in Hispanic communities in terms of bringing the message of recovery to people who needed it, who don't speak English.

For me personally, the most interesting and moving part of the job is receiving letters from Latinos in jail, many of whom are immigrants who are here in this country without any family connections and who don't speak the language. They may have been arrested for smuggling drugs or a similar crime. Then, in some correctional facility they found La Viña, read it, shared it, and started attending meetings—right there in jail—and have become members of A.A.—and when they get out they will have a shot. Isn't this what we're all about? Also, we hear from Loners who live in many different parts of the world, in small countries with hardly any meetings. La Viña is an effective tool in keeping them sober.

Similarly, there is incredible interest in the country of Cuba for our magazine. There, people are so desperately poor, it is difficult to imagine. There, A.A. is growing rapidly. And even though they have no resources to buy the magazine, they have expressed a need for the message; we send out about 25 copies of every issue at the request of A.A. members. Some few local people have bought subscriptions for groups in Cuba. Several people in the U.S. have sent in checks and have donated subscriptions to the G.S.O. and to groups in Cuba.

I have seen firsthand how much La Viña has taxed the Grapevine staff and diverted resources from the English-language magazine. Not that anyone in the office begrudges the time and energy poured into La Viña. Quite the opposite. Staff and management donate time and energy to this effort, saving thousands of dollars of expense. I work on a part-time basis, but if the magazine continues to publish, if it eventually grows in circulation, we can better afford to spend more money on circulation, production, and editorial staff. It is important to note that, at present, there is a wonderful spirit of cooperation and commitment.

Even though it is small, currently with four members, plus Ames and myself, the members of the newly-formed La Viña Editorial Advisory Board are very committed to their mission, and they contribute useful ideas, such as a column titled "Women in A.A.," and a lot of enthusiasm for the process of publishing this magazine for Latino A.A.s. There is much work ahead, and we will reach out to new members of the Editorial Board for new ideas, and new ways to make the magazine more interesting and relevant to the community. The Editorial Board provides guidance to this young "wild child" still finding its way.

Not just rhetorically, we ask: If not La Viña, then what? Others in the culture at large ask, "Why don't they just learn English?" The answer, within A.A., is that some of our Latino members are illiterate in their native Spanish tongue; many in the Southwest U.S. are Mexican immigrants of peasant background who barely know how to read and write—their children eventually do. With constant emigration into the U.S., a large segment of alcoholics will not speak, cannot speak, and cannot learn English as adults.

We can also ask, how much money is spent to translate A.A. literature worldwide? And if we do this worldwide, why not do it here within our borders for people in the U.S. who contribute to society and to the A.A. community, with whom we have direct interaction through this General Service Conference.

How many lives has La Viña saved? How do we measure? On a personal note: since the first issue of the magazine came out in July 1996 I have sent a few copies to my own family members and other active alcoholics I know. My best friend from childhood was in a hospital dying from alcoholism when I first sent him a copy, and now he is two years sober. My own sister was homeless three years ago when I started sending her La Viña and A.A. literature; she has been in the program for a year and a half. My mother asks for copies and takes them to people with alcohol problems: "Oh, they're going to A.A. now . . ." she reports.

La Viña provides us an opportunity to enrich people's lives with literature in their own language; it gives them a chance at sobriety and changes their lives. For this alone, for me, the magazine is valuable, has no price tag. This is something we can do for A.A. history. We are present at its birth, and we can make sure it continues into the future and saves lives and changes lives among the neediest of the needy, most humble members of our society, people who for the most part have no one to champion their causes.

Finally, it is appropriate to consider our Responsibility Declaration in the context of our discussion of La Viña. "When anyone anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. to be there. And for that . . . I am responsible." These people, these alcoholics of the Latino community, are reaching out to us, and we cannot turn our backs on them. We are responsible.

*Jaime Manrique,
GV Editor of Spanish Resources*

A waitress at the Starlight diner mistakenly thought it was Roger Lambert's (SW Texas) birthday and sat on his lap and sang to him. Someone took a picture and threatened to e-mail it to his wife.

MANY FACES—ONE FELLOWSHIP

Thursday evening's presentation/discussion session was moderated by Jackie Johnston, general service trustee.

Accepting Our Differences

"We are average Americans. All sections of this country and many of its occupations are represented, as well as many political, economic, social, and religious backgrounds. We are people who normally would not mix." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 17) How true this statement is! This alcoholic finds it rather amazing that, notwithstanding our many and varied differences, we "problem people" not only get along - but actually thrive as part of a spiritual Fellowship! Our Big Book goes on to say that, "...there exists among us a fellowship, a friendliness, and an understanding which is indescribably wonderful.... We have a way out...upon which we can join in brotherly and harmonious action." (*ibid*, p. 17)

"Oh come on," you may be thinking, "that sounds like a politically correct statement to me. Are you to have us believe that A.A.s have never struggled with accepting each others' differences? Get real, how about sharing with us some of our early Fellowship's dilemma with this perplexing issue?" Sounds like a great idea to me. Let's examine how our pioneers handled the "many faces" that were entering our Fellowship during our formative years.

Believe it or not, our very own Dr. Bob had originally expressed uneasiness about admitting women to A.A. when they first appeared at our doorstep. Another interesting tidbit of the time is that our African American brothers and sisters were only permitted to come to meetings as "observers." Bill W. was very frustrated with this fact and in a 1943 letter wrote: "I feel very deeply about this race business. Save this one question, I suppose A.A. is the most democratic society in the world." Bill went on to say, "All men [and women] should have an equal opportunity to recover from alcoholism—this is the shining idea." (*Pass It On*, p. 316)

As we read in Tradition Three, "A newcomer appeared at one of these groups.... He soon proved that his was a desperate case.... 'But,' he asked, '...will you let me join your group? Since I am the victim of another addiction.'" Spirited (controversial) discussion ensued, "We deal...with alcoholics only," the elders said. Then another of the group spoke, "'What we are really afraid of is our reputation...While the newcomer's fate hung delicately in the balance...one of the members spoke in a very different voice, 'As we've been talking, five short words have been running through my mind... 'What would the Master do?' Not another word was said.'" (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Tradition*, pp. 141-142)

So on the anvils of group experience Tradition Three was born. The long form of this Tradition states, "Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. S19)

Are we today, slamming the door in the faces of alcoholics who need our help just because they may have an addiction that is even worse stigmatized than alcoholism? Oh sure, we're not actually telling these lads they're not welcome; maybe we're just subtly perpetuating this atrocity by ignoring them and thereby not accepting their differences. Our A.A. literature suggests that if alcohol is a problem to them—that is enough for us! We keep our A.A. doors wide open. They are a member as long as they say they are!

As I share these thoughts with you I am reminded of a farewell talk given by George Dorsey at the 48th General Service Conference. He mentioned that there are three essential spiritual axioms that he follows. They are: "to stay *enthusiastic* as we carry out our mission of helping drunks; to always maintain *humility* and realize that our Higher Power deserves the credit, and finally that the first two points are moot if we fail to possess *compassion* for the sick and suffering alcoholic as he (she) enters our Fellowship!"

I would be remiss as I close, if I didn't share a personal experience along these lines. My God decided to drop me off at the doorsteps of A.A. at the tender age of twenty-two. I wound up drunk—again—in a Midwestern town, 750 miles from home



after being fired by a traveling sales company. I entered a club run by A.A.s after exhausting all other avenues. I was taken in by an A.A. angel named Don C. and stayed off the booze for over three months! Imagine my dismay when upon trying to enter this establishment, to attend a meeting, I was told that the club's business meeting had voted that, due to my erratic behavior, I was no longer allowed on their premises! While today I realize that A.A. wasn't kicking me out, I certainly did not realize that then! "Wow," I thought, "even A.A. can't handle me. . . ." It was at this low point in my life that my loving and all forgiving God had me cradled ever so snugly in His everlasting arms! He showed me, through Don C., that there were other A.A. groups that were willing to put up with my nonsense.

So I say to you, as we leave this year's Conference and return to our home groups, let's all keep in mind that as we *move forward* to the future and newcomers descend upon our groups with their *many faces* and varying *differences* may we all possess a degree of *love and tolerance*. Let us be ever so mindful that "To many a desperate drunk A.A. is the court of last appeal. How can we slam the door on anybody who stands outside?" Sure they may be different, but "Who of us dares to say, 'No, you can't come in,' thereby setting himself up as judge, jury, and perhaps executioner of his brother alcoholic?" (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, pp. 102-103)

May God continue to richly bless us all as we continue to be at the place where we can be of maximum helpfulness—as we do our best to accept the '*different*' alcoholics as they enter the dynamic, life-giving, saving Fellowship we know as Alcoholics Anonymous.

Robbie Walker, Southern New Jersey

I Am Responsible

My individual responsibility as an A.A. member can be defined in several ways. The concept that "Alcoholism is an illness" removes any moral responsibility from alcoholics. But I know this is far from true! On the contrary, this fact is used to clamp the heaviest moral obligation, the obligation to use A.A. and the Twelve Steps to get well and sober.

I have also heard: "Sobriety is my sole responsibility," but as long as I believe that, I will make little progress with my real-life problems and responsibilities. Then I stand a fair chance of getting drunk again. I am not living just to be sober, I am living to learn, to serve, to love and be responsible for my daily acts. To take full responsibility for the consequences of our past acts, and at the same time, to take responsibility for the well-being of others. That is the spirit of Step Nine.

Cesar Borri, Puerto Rico

Principles Before Personalities

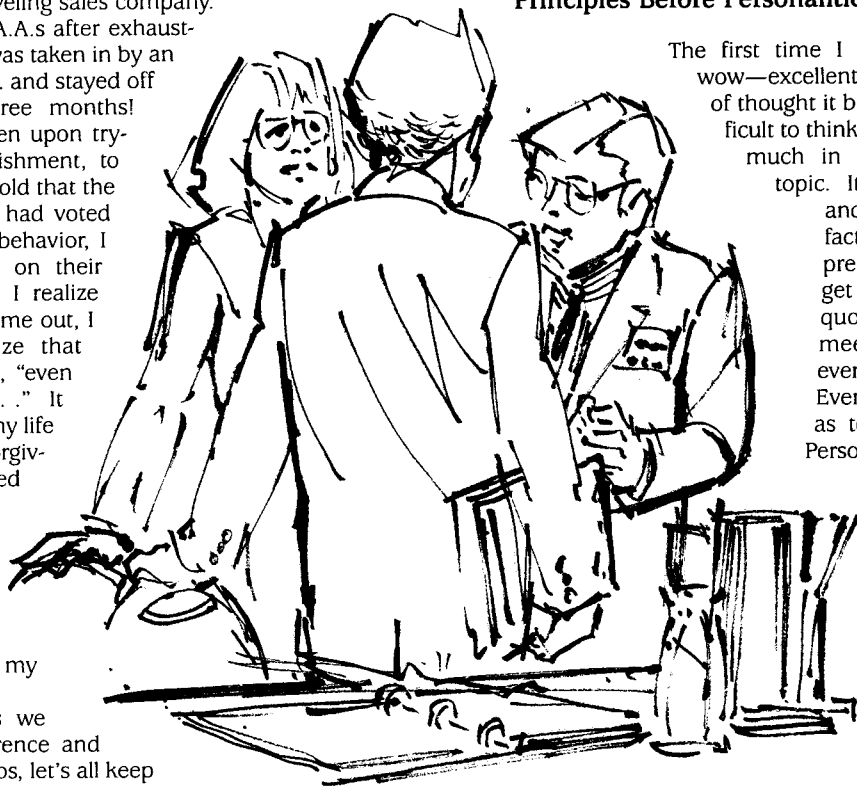
The first time I saw the topic I thought, wow—excellent topic! After giving it a lot of thought it became more and more difficult to think of what to say. There is so much in our literature about this topic. It is in our Steps, Traditions and Concepts. As a matter of fact, it is one of the basic premises we hear when we get to A.A. You can hear it quoted at groups, district meetings, assemblies and even here at the Conference. Everyone has a different idea as to what "Principles Before Personalities" means. So today you will get my version, and hopefully some of you will agree with me. Define principle—according to Webster, a principle is a fundamental truth or doctrine on which others are based. Rules of conduct or ethical behavior. And personality is a distinct

character; individuality. Going with the definitions of the words, the phrase means fundamental truths come before individual. In everyday terms it means put principles before personalities.

What principles are we talking about? I believe they are in our Twelve Traditions. Tradition One's basic principle is unity. Tradition Two's basic principle is God as our ultimate authority. Tradition Three says that we include anyone who has a desire to stop drinking. Tradition Four addresses autonomy, except when A.A. as a whole is threatened. Tradition Five speaks of singleness of purpose. Tradition Six's basic principle is sticking to our primary purpose. Tradition Seven says we are self-supporting. Tradition Eight's basic principle is "Freely you have received, freely give." In Tradition Nine the basic principle is be responsible in service. Tradition Ten addresses the principle that there is no controversy at the public level. Tradition Eleven talks about attraction rather than promotion. And lastly, in Tradition Twelve the principle is humility expressed through anonymity.

From all of the readings, it appears that Dr. Bob was a man with down-to-earth qualities. He studied the Bible morning and night. He never judged anyone and he put principles before personalities. From Dr. Bob's last talk in 1950 at the International Convention, in Cleveland: "And one more thing: None of us would be here today if somebody hadn't taken time to explain things to us, to give us a little pat on the back, to take us to a meeting or two, to do numerous little kind and thoughtful acts in our behalf. So let us never get such a degree of smug complacency that we're not willing to extend, or attempt to extend to our less fortunate brothers that help which has been so beneficial to us." (*Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, p. 338)

Bill W. wrote a lot about how we must hold the principles higher than our own wants. In his correspondence with Reuben A. Holden, the secretary of Yale University, Bill explained the Twelfth Tradition: "Because we have already had much practical experi-



ence with this vital principle, it is today the view of every thoughtful A.A. member that if, over the years ahead, we practice this anonymity *absolutely*, it will guarantee our effectiveness and unity by heavily restraining those to whom public honors and distinctions are but the natural stepping stones to dominance and personal power." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 207) In "Pass It On" (p. 307) it says, "It was much better, then, to rely on principles and ideas, which were constant, stable, and dependable, than on the unstable and quixotic ups and downs of personal relationships."

What does all of this mean today? I guess we have to ask ourselves the question, "Do I place principles before personalities?" On a personal level—in my group, in my district, in my area—and, yes, when we are working with the General Service Office and attending the General Service Conference? Am I being a responsible person today?

We all practice principles before personalities at a personal level by being a loving spouse, a responsible child to our parents, a responsible parent, never criticizing or belittling anyone. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

At the group level we all practice principles before personalities. We all welcome the newcomer, no matter how they look or how they act. We go with the group's decision, even if it differs from our own. We all do our share of service work—be it making the coffee, emptying ashtrays, stacking chairs, taking our turn at speaking at treatment centers or correctional facilities, attending open meetings, helping with cleaning up the meeting rooms. We all can say we never judge anyone that walks into the room for the first time. We sponsor people when they ask us, not judging on their looks or personalities. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

At our district level we all practice principles before personalities by attending every district meeting, doing exactly what we said we were going to do, being responsible to the district in our thoughts and actions. We all read *The A.A. Service Manual* and know what our responsibilities entail. We never take sides in any arguments that happen. We study both sides of the issue and figure out what the underlying principles of the issues are. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

At our area level we all practice principles before personalities by attending all of the area functions. By not letting our own personal issues come into play. By studying *The A.A. Service Manual* so we know how our areas are supposed to function. By letting our trusted servants be trusted servants. By volunteering to sit on committees and learn about them. By not letting our personal aims rise above what is good for the area. By accepting the outcome of a vote, even though you didn't like how all of the others voted. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

When calling the General Service Office we all practice principles before personalities by having patience when we are put on hold; by knowing that everyone at the office is busy and we are not the only ones with a problem; and by refusing to jump to conclusions if our questions aren't answered immediately. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

Even here at the Conference we practice principles before personalities. We vote with our conscience, not how we think someone else will vote. We are prepared on all of the issues so we can vote intelligently. We don't rationalize issues to make them come out the way we want them to. We know *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*. Most of all we look at what is best for A.A. as a Fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength and hope throughout the United States and Canada. We let go of our self-centeredness and ego.

By placing principles before personalities we can be united with God as our ultimate authority. We can accept any alcoholic

into our meetings; we are autonomous in our singleness of purpose, by sticking to our primary purpose and being fully self-supporting and giving freely of ourselves. We can be responsible in service, never getting into any public controversy. We can be attractive without promoting. "We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 187)

Bill sums it up very eloquently in *The Language of the Heart*: "Our new book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, states that 'anonymity is the greatest protection our Society can ever have.' It says also that 'the spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice...' At the beginning we sacrificed alcohol. We had to, or it would have killed us. But we couldn't get rid of alcohol unless we made other sacrifices. Big-shotism and phony thinking had to go. We had to toss self-justification, self-pity, and anger right out the window. We had to quit the crazy contest for personal prestige and big bank balances. We had to take personal responsibility for our sorry state and quit blaming others for it." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 210)

Susan Ardolf, Northern Minnesota

OUR FUTURE TOGETHER

The final presentations of the Conference were on Friday morning, and were moderated by Roger Lambert, Southwest Texas.

Sponsorship

On the day I received my invitation to make a presentation on this topic, I was having "one of those days." I was tired, I was behind in my work and fear and self-doubt were taking up residency in my head. Needless to say, calling my sponsor was not foremost in my mind. However, I took the letter as a friendly reminder from a Loving God and picked up the phone (I should mention here that most of my insights are not the moment of clarity type. Primarily they are of the DUH! Variety). In so many words, Tom said, "Well, John, not every day can be a great day. Some days are really good and some are really bad, but it balances out on the good side. I can absolutely promise you that it will get better." And with that, he cheerily said, "Hang in there, John. I've got to get back to work," and he hung up.

After I had forgiven Tom for failing to understand the seriousness and uniqueness of my problems, I began to see that he was right. I approached my work with renewed energy, and I ended the day in high spirits. Such a simple conversation, but it did so much. Another example of the power of sponsorship in Alcoholics Anonymous!

The theme of this year's Conference is "Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility." Humility engenders unity by focusing us on a common goal. Our basic text describes this goal very succinctly. "Our real purpose is to fit ourselves to be of maximum service to God and the people about us." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 77). In my opinion, one of the miracles of A.A. is the transformation of people's lives that enables them to be of service. Through sponsorship we are given the privilege of participating in people's lives as they make the shift from self-centeredness to God-centeredness.

Like many people, I came into Alcoholics Anonymous humiliated but not humble. Everything that had happened in my life convinced me that I would die if I drank again, but I had a large reservoir of self-will in every other area of my life. I read the story of Jim (*ibid*, pp. 35-37), but thought I was different. I was told to get a sponsor, so I did.

However, I picked my first sponsor because I wanted to be who he was, not because I wanted what he had. It took me a while to understand the difference. I wanted results, but I didn't want to take any actions. My sponsor gently and lovingly helped me to see that I couldn't recover on that basis. I remember many long conversations where I'd ask him "How do you do it?" He'd reply "It's all there in 'the book.' You just have to do it." My response was, "Yes, but how do you do it?" Finally, the pain in my life became too great to bear, and I knew I would either drink or work the program. I called my sponsor, and I began taking those first teetering steps towards teachability and humility. The most important thing my sponsor ever told me was that he could share his experience, strength and hope, but for answers I'd have to go to the "book." He started me on the path towards God-reliance instead of people-reliance.

When the time came that I was asked to sponsor someone, my ego returned full force. I thought I had been given a young life to shape, and I made some horrible mistakes. I told a young man I was sponsoring that A.A. opposed the use of drugs, and that he should stop taking his medication. He jumped out of a second story window. Fortunately he survived, and moved on to a different sponsor.

In time I came to see that I don't have all the answers and I don't need to have them. Today, in sponsoring, I try to follow the suggestions in Chapter 7 "Working With Others" of the Big Book (p. 95), "Never talk down to an alcoholic from any moral or spiritual hilltop; simply lay out the kit of spiritual tools for his inspection. Show him how they worked with you. Offer him friendship and fellowship." Sponsoring and being sponsored has enriched my program. More and more, I am able to see how alike we are. Our circumstances change slightly, but our results—both drinking and working the program—are the same. We learn over time that we don't have to know everything, that we can abandon ourselves to our Higher Power in complete confidence. We learn to look outside of ourselves for solutions.

As sponsors and sponsees, we are all in this together. We need each other, and we are each other's teachers. We learn acceptance, tolerance, and love; we learn to listen and to discern. We learn that we are responsible for carrying the message, but not for how another person hears it. We learn to accept people as they are, not as we would wish them to be. We learn that our role is not to be mirrors, reflecting the program to others. Rather, our job is to be windows, so people can see the program through us. That's a big difference. It puts God at the center instead of us. And finally, we learn the essence of unity—"Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

For many people, including myself, Alcoholics Anonymous was the first place we truly experienced unconditional love, and nowhere was that more evident than in our sponsors. It has been said that ours are the only arms God has. May we always wrap them lovingly around each other as we trudge the road of happy destiny!

John Carroll,

No. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan

A.A. Literature

How important is our literature? Alcoholics Anonymous, our very name, was taken from our first piece of literature, our basic text, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, first published in 1939. Until then, we were just a nameless bunch of drunks.

The extensive body of literature that we have developed over the past 60 years delineates much of who we are, both to our-

selves and others. When a new group registers with G.S.O., what do we send? Literature. When other countries ask for help in getting A.A. started, what do we send? Literature. When alcoholism and media professionals inquire about us, what do we send? Literature. Perhaps most importantly, what do newcomers get at their first A.A. meeting, whether it's held in a church, prison, hospital or treatment center, in the U.S./Canada or abroad? A.A. Literature.

Aside from the in-person, one alcoholic talking to another method of carrying the message, Literature 'R' Us. In the Big Book, Twelve and Twelve, our many pamphlets, audio tapes, video tapes, service pieces and booklets our message is put into a form that anyone can access and, from it, know how to recover from alcoholism or to help someone else recover. Every single piece of literature has been painstakingly developed, most of it through the Conference process, usually over a considerable period of time, to make sure our A.A. message is accurately portrayed and always in response to a specific need. That's Unity.

Since we publish our own literature we can create it, change it, rewrite it or discard it altogether as our needs change, just as we are working right now with the upcoming Fourth Edition of the Big Book. The willingness to change, to be teachable—that's Humility.

Today, unit sales of our literature are down, both at G.S.O. and Grapevine. We can say, it was bound to happen, that sales would peak eventually. After all, we had a very long run of increasing sales through the years. We're adapting, adjusting pricing, budgeting for the decreases, downsizing so we can still pay our bills and meet our responsibilities to the groups and to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Let's be real. There's a limit to how far we can downsize before lower sales impact our ability to perform our vital services. Then we'd have to raise prices because we do rely on profits from literature sales to fund our Prudent Reserve and part of Group Services. But prices can only get so high before people just stop buying.

What's causing the downturn in sales? We wish we knew. There are still lots of alcoholics out there. Are we failing to meet the needs of today's alcoholic community? We speculate that part of it could be the significant decrease in treatment centers. Maybe newcomers today don't read as much. Maybe newcomers are finding their way into other recovery programs. Maybe A.A. members are buying a lot of related recovery materials, available in book stores, instead of our own literature. Maybe "A.A. Web sites" that post our literature online for anyone to download have an impact. Maybe other publishers, publishing and distributing our literature, are having an impact. We're just not sure if it's any single one of these trends or all of them together that are changing the A.A. world we live in. Acceptance of these changes is Humility.

How do we move forward from here? Bill W. knew that for us to survive as a Society, we would have to embrace change, be flexible, stay open minded. He worried that we would become rigid, inflexible and therefore exclusionary to newcomers. He cultivated the idea that we can change anything if it becomes apparent that change is needed. In our Conference Charter, there's provision to change even the Steps and Traditions.

So what about our literature? Yes, we can vigorously protect our copyrights to protect the integrity of our message. Individually we can make the decision to support legitimate area and district Web sites, and buy literature only from G.S.O. and the Grapevine. We can sponsor newcomers so that they learn from our Traditions that the group comes first, that each of us, with humility, must give up some of our personal ambitions and desires for the sake of group unity.

On the other hand, the life of the individual does come close-

ly after the group. We need to be flexible and open-minded regarding possible changes in our literature. My sponsor told me that I had to be willing to let go of *all* my old ideas, not just my bad old ideas. And we know that the first groups admonished even Bill not to let the good stand in the way of the very best. As A.A. changes, reflecting the changes of the world around us, we need to be ready to let our literature reflect those changes.

For instance, in the course of my research on the Fourth Edition subcommittee I came across a book by someone else that had translated all the sexist language out of the Big Book and made it gender neutral. I don't know how well it sells, but in my opinion the spiritual program of action, with its universal truths, still comes through loud and clear. We already have hard-bound, soft-bound, pocket-size, abridged, large-print, Braille, audio taped, American Sign Language Big Books and Big Books in 36 other languages with more to come. What's so objectionable about a modern English translation that's more gender neutral, still contains the basic, essential A.A. message and could open the door wider for today's newcomer? What are we afraid of? We can still buy the original version if that's our preference. And because it would go through the Conference process, how could it be anything but moving forward with humility to unity?

As Herbert Spencer is quoted in the appendix "Spiritual Experience" in the Big Book, "There is a principle which is a bar against all information, which is proof against all arguments and which cannot fail to keep a man in everlasting ignorance—that is the principle of contempt prior to investigation." (p. 570)

Let's move forward in unity with the humility to continue investigating ways to carry our life-saving message through our literature.

David Every, Grapevine director

Tradition Seven

Tradition Seven: "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions."

I want to share back with you what you have taught me. You, the members of the Fellowship, have befriended me and taught me, with unselfish hearts. If what I say today is not right, it is not the fault of any of my A.A. friends.

The importance of unity and the way we can safeguard our unity is explained in the 1997 *Final Conference Report* on page 6 as follows: "Safeguarding unity comes about as each member grows in understanding that the good of the group and the good of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole comes first; that what we may personally feel, may not be a good thing for A.A. as a whole, and that we need to keep an open and loving mind and trust the process. We need to repeatedly surrender our personal ambitions and wishes for the greater good."

Later in the report, on page 15, in the presentation "Unity—We are Responsible," the presenter identifies money as a major threat to unity and concludes that each one of us is responsible for the unity of the Fellowship. Thus her words brought together our subject: Tradition Seven and our Conference theme.

How can we get to unity through humility. Humility is a derivative of a Latin word which meant to humiliate to shame, and that is not what A.A. is about. We know shame and humiliation are harmful. So what is humility and can it be healthy? Well, to paraphrase a Supreme Court Justice, "I know humility when I see it." I like humility; I am just not sure how well I practice it. I admire it so much more in others than I find it in myself. I define humility as acting with the conviction that the common good is more important than individual self-interest or convenience.

An example that comes to mind was the widow in the Bible

who gave her mite. Others could scorn the smallness of her gift but she did not let pride keep her from doing that which she could do. How can I follow her example?

Living Sober (p. 15) explains that "In A.A., no one is 'above' or 'below' anyone else. There are no classes or strata or hierarchies among the members . . . A.A. is . . . a Fellowship of equals." With a statement like that, humility should be a given. It seems so self-evident that A.A. strives to respect all who come to the Fellowship. Yet those words of equality without the practice of humility will not prevent classification or stratification. To live in humility we will have to give up our personal determination to prove others wrong.

The "I am right and you are wrong" attitude is an unspoken attempt to create a "one up" class. Such personality attitude is just as dangerous to unity as any formal structure or hierarchy. This kind of ego does not help the A.A. members to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Bill W. identified money as a threat to unity several times. He knew when it comes to money, most of our understanding is about status and power. When anyone, A.A. member or not, starts arguing about money we probably have something at work other than just money. That is why Tradition Seven makes so much sense. If A.A. is to be self-supporting and not focused on money, then we remove huge temptations to waste energy and time on seeking money or fighting over it once it is in the treasury. A control trip on a money issue is not fiscal responsibility, nor is the constant revisiting of the issue the kind of humility needed to attain unity. I believe the desire to control is the root of most money "evil" rather than the money itself. The tying together of the Conference theme with the Seventh Tradition has helped me think about some of the discussions I have heard since I came to the board. Letting go of my answer and accepting that someone else's answer can work is not easy, but it is the only way to unity. Once the question has had attention and reconsideration, if requested, refusal to accept the group conscience and move on becomes an act of ego.

Acceptance of the group's decision and being humble enough to make it work is humility that can lead to unity. Only through humility can we rise to unity. Without humility enough to love each other enough to move on from past disagreements, we risk the whole future. With unity, A.A. will move forward. By moving forward there will be a future for A.A. and for the still-suffering alcoholic.

Linda Chezem, Class A trustee



Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Greg Muth became general manager of the General Service Office on January 1, 1999, following George Dorsey's retirement. Greg served as the Panel 37 delegate from Hawaii and as Pacific regional trustee from 1990-1994; he has extensive business experience and has spent many years in A.A. service. As reported last year, I appointed a search committee to review candidates for general manager as called for by the board's procedures. The committee was chaired by Elaine Johnson, and consisted of Dean Rinehart, vice-chairman, Art Knight, Garry McAuley, Richard Roughton, and MaryJane Roy. In February 1998, Elaine Johnson sent a letter announcing the vacancy to past and current trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, delegates, and staff. This letter spelled out the qualifications for the job. After narrowing the field of applicants to four, the search committee hired a professional management consultant to interview each of these applicants, check employment histories and references on behalf of the committee, and comment on the management strengths of each. After reviewing the consultant's reports and interviewing the four applicants, the search committee forwarded two names to the full General Service Board. The board interviewed both applicants and selected Greg. The search committee was blessed with many strong applicants for the job, and I want to thank all of those A.A. servants who sent their resumes to the search committee. I also want to thank Elaine Johnson and the other members of the search committee for serving on this time-consuming project.

I also want to thank George Dorsey for his seven years' service as general manager. George leaves the office in excellent financial and operational condition. He has represented G.S.O. ably throughout the U.S. and Canada and the rest of the world. George's work in carrying our service experience to other countries has made a real difference, particularly in those countries that are new to A.A. Most of all, I have especially valued George's unerringly good judgment on matters both spiritual and practical.

In October, we welcomed a new addition to the G.S.O. staff, Bill Archer, a past delegate from Southwest Quebec. Bill is currently serving on the Treatment Facilities and Loners desk.

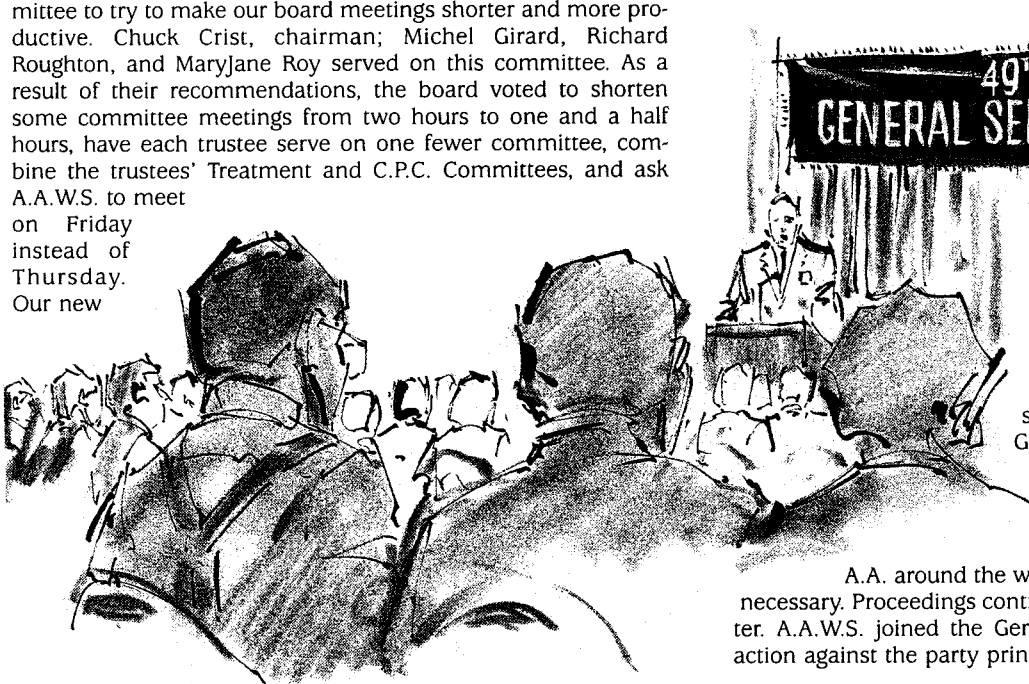
As I reported at last year's Conference, I appointed a committee to try to make our board meetings shorter and more productive. Chuck Crist, chairman; Michel Girard, Richard Roughton, and MaryJane Roy served on this committee. As a result of their recommendations, the board voted to shorten some committee meetings from two hours to one and a half hours, have each trustee serve on one fewer committee, combine the trustees' Treatment and C.P.C. Committees, and ask A.A.W.S. to meet on Friday instead of Thursday. Our new

schedule is working well, and while there will always be the occasional need for a longer board weekend — for example when we interviewed general manager applicants — we believe we are accomplishing as much work as we were before.

Chuck Crist, general service trustee and Grapevine director, resigned from the General Service Board on November 1, 1998, one and a half years before his normal rotation. Chuck has been a hardworking trustee. After Raul Marin became ill and was unable to serve as Grapevine chairman, Chuck offered to take on this tough job for a second year, while continuing to serve the board in other areas, like the committee mentioned in the previous paragraph. His service will be missed. The Grapevine Board recommended Greg Tobin to the trustees' Nominating Committee to fill the vacancy. The General Service Board approved this recommendation and forwarded it to the Conference for disapproval, if any. Greg would serve a full term and rotate in 2003.

Since the last Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Winnipeg, Manitoba; Sacramento, California; St. John's, Newfoundland and Daytona Beach, Florida. There was also a Special Forum in Montana that took place at two sites: Helena and Miles City. The Montana Forum was a great success, in part because Carl Budd, current and past delegates, and local A.A.s helped to get the word out about the Forum. The success of recent Special Forums has led the board to reexamine the way we structure all Regional Forums. Regional Forums began in 1975, and they still draw large numbers of service-minded A.A.s with the majority attending their first Forum.

The proposed Fourth Edition of the Big Book continues to be a topic of interest at Forums. The subcommittee on the Fourth Edition has worked long and hard and had a very productive year. It has met seven times since the last General Service Conference for a total of 15 meetings since the subcommittee's inception in May 1997. I would like to thank the members of this subcommittee for the commitment and time they have given this project. The members are Richard Roughton, chairman; David Every, Jacqueline Johnston, Garry McAuley, Vinnie McCarthy and Doug Richardson. The trustees' Literature Committee has made some important recommendations to the



Conference Literature Committee regarding the Conference process for this project, so there will be further discussion about this later in the week.

Last year I reported on a situation in Europe with regard to protecting A.A.'s copyrights and shared that the trustees of the General Service Board had voted unanimously to endorse the resolution of the A.A.W.S. Board to preserve and protect the copyrights held in trust for all of

A.A. around the world, including taking legal action if necessary. Proceedings continue in the Germany copyright matter. A.A.W.S. joined the German General Service Office in an action against the party printing A.A.W.S.-copyrighted literature



in Germany. The German G.S.O. is acting to protect German-language books which are being published by an individual in violation of copyright. Infringing literature is being published by the same individual in English, Finnish, Russian, Swedish, and other languages, and our action concerns these publications.

We have tried to make it clear that the board has no choice but to protect our copyrights. Unchallenged infringements of our copyrighted literature would impede the growth of A.A. around the world. The board has both a moral and a legal responsibility to protect the integrity of the A.A. message as found in our literature. If we do not defend our Fellowship's copyrights, anyone, anywhere could make whatever changes he or she wanted to our books and pass them off as the real thing to unsuspecting newcomers. We also have an obligation to G.S.O.s around the world to help them protect their financial ability to continue to carry the message. The board is not using legal means to enforce A.A. principles or to punish those who disagree with its position on copyrights. This we have no right or desire to do, as our Traditions and Concepts make clear. All we are trying to do is protect what we must protect. The simplest solution to the problem of copyright infringements is for the infringers to stop.

As mentioned last year, at the request of the Publication Francaises Board, A.A.W.S. terminated the license it previously granted to Publications Francaises. To insure that literature and services would continue without interruption to French-speaking A.A.s in Quebec, the publishing license was extended to February 1. The end of January marked the formation of an affiliate corporation in Canada to be known as Services Mondiaux des Alcooliques Anonymes Inc. ("S.M.A.A."), which is controlled entirely by A.A.W.S. What this means is that A.A.W.S. has acquired Publications Francaises and has directly assumed responsibility for providing French-language literature to A.A.s in Canada and the U.S., just as it provides English and Spanish literature in the U.S. and Canada.

Our G.S.O. worked with the New Zealand General Service Board to plan the 15th World Service Meeting which took place October 4-8, 1998 in Auckland. Our two trustees-at-large, Michel Girard and Dean Rinehart, attended as the World Service Meeting delegates from Canada and the U.S. along with delegates from 21 other countries. Clearly each country's service structure is autonomous, and while we like to think we are just one participant among peers, we usually find that as the oldest and largest service structure our experience is especially sought and valued by others. Our World Service Meeting delegates, other trustees, and G.S.O. staff who visit other countries try to share our experience, not instruct. As is so often the case in A.A., we often find ourselves receiving more from others' sharing than they do from ours.

G.S.O. continues to be active outside of the U.S. and Canada. In June, Michel Girard and Vinnie McCarthy, G.S.O.'s Publications director, visited France and Belgium to discuss French-literature matters and update them about the transition in Montreal. George Dorsey and Richard Bush attended the 10th Anniversary Celebration of A.A. in Lithuania in June and Richard visited the G.S.O. of Poland. At our August 1998 board weekend, we welcomed Jesus Ocampo Bourelly, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee and chairman of the Central Mexicana General Service Board and Class B (alcoholic) trustees Jose Luis Cortes and Ramon Muñoz, as well as Jose Luis Larios, editor of Plenitud magazine. Danny Mooney, Spanish Services coordinator, Elaine Johnson, Class A trustee, and Jaime Manrique, Spanish editor at the Grapevine, participated in a Cooperation With the Professional Community Conference in Mexico at the invitation of their General Service Board. Ray Stiver, Grapevine director and a member of the trustees' International Committee, and Joanie Moncrief represented the board at the 50th Anniversary Celebration of A.A. in the Netherlands in September. George Dorsey attended the First General Service Conference in

Romania in November while Richard Bush was celebrating Latvia's Tenth Anniversary.

During the January Board weekend, we welcomed as guests Dr. Isabelle Sokolov, Class A trustee and chairman of the General Service Board of France, and Kathalina Anthamatten, general manager of the General Service Office of France. In February, Danny Mooney participated in a regional assembly in Mexico and Richard Bush attended the 10th Anniversary Celebration of A.A. in Ukraine. Richard went to Sweden in March for their General Service Conference. Susan Ulseth helped Iceland celebrate their 45th Anniversary in April and Richard Bush went to Australia for their first International A.A. Convention and the Asia/Oceania Service Meeting.

Michel Girard, in his Presentation on the World Service Meeting, relates a wonderful story about an alcoholic from Cameroon who found the A.A. message through the G.S.O. in Paris by mail and got sober. His correspondence led to visits by French A.A.s and strong growth of A.A. in Cameroon. There are now 16 A.A. groups with about 600 members in Cameroon.

The Paris (French) General Service Office has received requests for assistance from eight other African nations, including Congo, Togo, Gabon, Senegal and the Central African Republic. The Paris G.S.O. has asked for assistance in carrying the message to French-speaking Africa, and we said yes. We have agreed to help in any way we can, including sending literature or French-speaking trustees or staff. Africa has historically been a challenging place for A.A. to gain a foothold, and we are most grateful that the Paris G.S.O. might give us a chance to help carry the message in this part of the world. We are especially grateful that our G.S.O. has the resources, measured both in people and money, to participate in Fifth Tradition work like this.

G.S.O. continues to be in good financial condition. The only worrisome trend is the long-term, steady decline in sales of A.A. literature. While we have the capability of raising literature prices, the decline in sales reminds us that we must always be careful with the Fellowship's money, paying close attention to costs and making sure that those projects we undertake truly help the still-suffering alcoholic. With this in mind, I am particularly grateful for the 4.7% increase in contributions last year.

Gary Glynn, chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a New York not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors. A.A.W.S. has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.) which provides group services, including printing, distribution of Conference-approved and other service literature. The board met eight times since the last Conference to hear G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on compliance with Conference and board recommendations; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other

materials; discuss publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors; currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and one regional trustee; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the services director, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, information services manager, human resources director, the archivist, the board secretary, and a Grapevine staff member. The board has welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which addresses the needs of all service assignments; Finance, which concerns salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; Publishing, which addresses reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole. During the past year, the following significant items are noted:

Services: During 1998, 2,184 new groups were registered, compared to 2,452 in 1997. Staff member Eva Sanchez reported on the 1998 Membership Survey. Through October, 378 active groups had reported back to G.S.O., with a total of 6,827 surveys received by that time. G.S.O. archivist Judit Santon reported on the Third Archives Workshop, in Akron, Ohio, September 25-27, with 150 participants. A presentation was made by G.S.O. Information Services manager Lillianna Murphy regarding the current status of the Year 2000 Project "Y2K". The project has been kept in-house and implementation is on schedule.

The board approved financial assistance of \$8,200 to cover the cost of reprinting the Big Book and Twelve and Twelve in Benisaya-Cebuano, a language spoken on the island of Mindanao in the Philippines. During 1998, the International Literature Fund received \$29,844 in contributions from 11 countries. As of December 31, 1998, the Fund total was \$28,134.

During 1998, G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site was accessed 401,573 times, compared to 214,603 visits in 1997. These represented "hits" in English, French and Spanish. The Services Committee suggested that G.S.O. add "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" and the *About A.A.* newsletter for professionals to the Web site, starting with *About A.A.*'s Winter 1998/99 issue on

anonymity, as well as successive issues. The committee also discussed the issue of anonymity on

the Internet and suggested that

the trustees' P.I. Committee bring this up as a discussion item. A.A.W.S.

directors and G.S.O. staff participated in

the following Regional Forums

since the last Conference: Western Canada

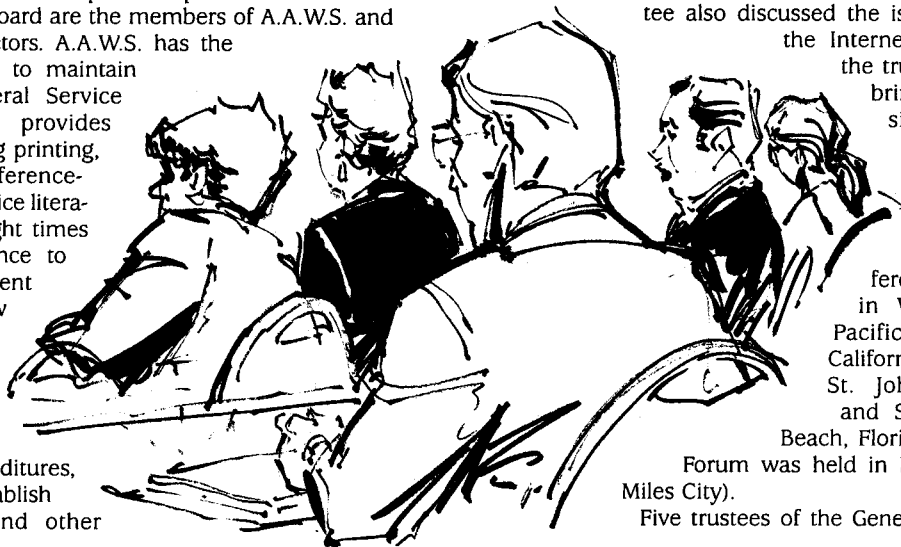
in Winnipeg, Manitoba; Pacific in Sacramento,

California; Eastern Canada in St. John's, Newfoundland;

and Southeast in Daytona Beach, Florida. A two-city Special

Forum was held in Montana (Helena and Miles City).

Five trustees of the General Service Board and





G.S.O.'s International Convention coordinator Valerie O'Neill attended Al-Anon's Third International Convention in Salt Lake City, Utah, July 2-5. There were 4,555 registrants, including 825 A.A. members.

The 13th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar was held in San Mateo, California, October 9-11, with 138 participants.

International: International visitors to G.S.O. during the past year included Jean Green, vice-chairperson of the South African General Service Board, during the month of May. Dr. Isabelle Sokolov, Class A trustee and chairperson of the French Board of Trustees; and Kathalina Anthamatten, G.S.O. general manager in France, were welcomed to the office and were guests at the January 1999 A.A.W.S. Board meeting.

During the past year, through the combined efforts of G.S.O.'s Spanish Services and International assignments, the office sent a complimentary order of Spanish-language literature in response to the request for assistance from the Honduras General Service Office in the aftermath of Hurricane Mitch.

In September, staff member Joanie Moncrief attended the 50th Anniversary of A.A. in the Netherlands. In March 1999, staff member Richard Bush, who serves on the International desk, attended Sweden's General Service Conference in Stockholm, March 19-21, 1999. General manager George Dorsey attended the First General Service Conference in Timisoara, Romania and joined Richard Bush at the Tenth Anniversary Celebration of A.A. in Jurmala, Latvia, in November. Richard also visited the Polish General Service Office in Warsaw, on his way to join George Dorsey at the Tenth Anniversary Congress of A.A. in Vilnius, Lithuania, in June. Richard Bush and Class A trustee George E. Vaillant, M.D., traveled to Ukraine in February 1999, for a weekend meeting with professionals as well as attending the Ukraine's 10th A.A. Anniversary celebration. Members from Russia, Belarus, Lithuania, as well as U.S./Canada, were present to share their gratitude for their new way of life with each other.

The 15th World Service Meeting was held in Auckland, New Zealand, October 4-8. Twenty-two countries were represented by 39 delegates. Dean Rinehart and Michel Girard, trustees-at-large U.S. and Canada, respectively, represented our General Service Board.

The board authorized G.S.O. to post an announcement of the 2000 International Convention in Minneapolis, Minnesota, on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

Finance: The board received, approved and forwarded to the General Service Board, a mid-year budget adjustment of \$47,400. This adjustment included the following items, resulting

from 1998 General Service Conference recommendations: \$12,400 - Public Service Announcements; \$17,500 - Corrections Video; and \$17,500 - G.S.O. Video.

A brief summary of the financial results for 1998 follows: Gross sales of \$9,207,000 for the year were approximately \$368,000 less than budgeted, and \$14,300 (0.15%) less than in 1997. Total expenses for the year of \$8,422,800 were approximately \$102,000 under budget. For the year 1998, the statements reflected net income of \$139,600, compared with budgeted income of \$190,500. Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended the G.S.O.'s 1999 budget to the trustees' Finance Committee, projecting net sales of \$8,553,900, contributions of \$4,100,000, operating expenses of \$8,680,450, and a net income of \$174,100 for 1999.

Publishing: Since the 1998 Conference we published the following items: "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" video; "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure" video and accompanying service brochure; and new Public Service Announcements in English, Spanish and French. We completed the following foreign literature items: Marshallese "A.A. at a Glance" and "How It Works"; Greek Big Book, "Is A.A. for You?" and "A Newcomer Asks"; Turkish *As Bill Sees It*; Croatian Big Book; and Romanian *Living Sober*. Slovenian "Questions & Answers on Sponsorship" was still in progress at mid-March 1999. In addition, we have completed the licensing agreements for the Lithuanian *As Bill Sees It*, which will be the Lithuanian General Service Board's first publication venture. Also, Great Britain's General Service Board covered half of the \$20,000 cost of completing the manuscript of the Greek Big Book.

Our 1999 budget includes the Big Book in Romanian; the Twelve and Twelve in Croatian, Greek and Slovenian; and a number of reprints in Czech, Hungarian, Lithuanian and Russian. Although the Russian General Service Board is licensed to reprint our translation of the Big Book, economic conditions in Russia may prevent them from publishing a large supply this year. We recently sent 300 books from existing inventory to help tide them over for a few months.

Literature-Other — During 1998, the board granted permission/did not object to 117 requests to reprint from A.A. literature; 28 requests were denied.

A letter was sent to Special Needs chairpersons suggesting that the newly-introduced Special Needs Catalog get wider circulation. The committees were asked to contact agencies in their area about the new catalog and get back to G.S.O., which would then send a mailing to each agency.

G.S.O. processed 27,842 paid literature orders in 1998, roughly the same as in 1997; and 21,000 "no charge" orders, also about the same as 1997. Our turnaround time, from the day an order is received at G.S.O. until it leaves the Kansas City warehouse, is two days, on average.

Copyright Infringement — The board was advised that A.A.W.S. has joined the German General Service Board as a complainant in a legal action in Germany against the party printing A.A.W.S.-copyrighted literature in Germany. We expect the situation to be resolved in 1999. A.A.W.S. received a positive response from The Anonymous Press (formerly I.W.S., Inc.) to our December 1998 letter requesting that they immediately comply with our prior agreements and stop selling their publication of the Big Book outside the United States.

Formation of Affiliate Corporation in Canada and Acquisition of Publications Françaises — After careful consideration of several options and, after exploring the possibility of operating a Canadian corporation as a subsidiary of A.A.W.S., the members of the board approved the formation of a new Canadian corporation to be known as "Services Mondiaux Alcooliques Anonymes, inc." ("S.M.A.A., inc."), effective January 29, 1999. The members subsequently elected directors of S.M.A.A., who then authorized purchase of the assets, liabilities and operations of Publications Françaises by S.M.A.A., effective February 1, 1999.

New Format Requests Approved — The Publishing Committee of A.A.W.S. reviewed incoming requests and recommended the following new format for existing A.A. literature, which was approved: Audio cassettes of Pioneer Stories and *Living Sober*.

Fourth Edition of Big Book — Approximately 1,222 new stories were received for review by the subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book.

New literature catalogs, in English and Spanish, were prepared for Fall/Winter 1998-99. An announcement regarding new Spanish literature prices was sent to all intergroups and Spanish groups at the beginning of February.

Other Board Actions: In May 1998 the board welcomed newly-elected nontrustee directors, Ronald J. Gauthier and Jan Polek. Jacqueline Johnston was also welcomed as a newly-elected general service trustee. Jack L. Ostrem replaced rotating regional trustee director MaryJane Roy. In addition, the board elected a slate of officers to terms expiring at the end of the April 1999 Conference. The board requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee approve Jim Clough to replace Garry McAuley as a regional trustee director, following the 1999 Conference. New G.S.O. general manager Greg Muth was elected a director and A.A.W.S. president, effective January 1, 1999, replacing George Dorsey, who resigned effective January 1 and was scheduled to retire February 1, 1999.

At year-end 1998, G.S.O. had 82 full-time positions, compared to 83 employees in 1997. The board welcomed new G.S.O. staff member Bill Archer, of Montreal, on October 1, 1998, replacing Valerie O'Neill who was scheduled to take up full-time responsibilities on the 2000 International Convention assignment, effective January 1, 1999.

The board approved a budget of \$475,000 to cover the cost of the construction project to consolidate and reconfigure G.S.O.'s operations on the 11th floor. The project was completed on time and on budget. Committees have been formed to review office policies and procedures. The "I/T" (Information/Technology) Committee is looking at ways to fully unitize current systems and enlarge G.S.O.'s networking capabilities.

By the end of December 1998, G.S.O. had welcomed 1,330 visitors for the year.

Richard Roughton, chairperson

Trustees' committee: The G.S.O. Archives has a priceless collection of recordings dating from the late 1940s to the mid-1990s. These include talks by Bill Wilson, not heard by the Fellowship in many years; recordings from early timers who played a significant role in A.A. early history; Father Ed Dowling; recordings of the First International Convention in Cleveland; and early General Service Conferences.

However, these early magnetic recordings are rapidly deteriorating and the committee has initiated a project to explore the audio preservation needs of G.S.O.'s archival material. It was felt that, considering the size of the collection, this would be an ongoing project for years to come. It was agreed to invite an audio preservation specialist to evaluate the physical condition of the audio material. The recommendations based on the physical condition of the records, and a second set of recommendations based on the content evaluation of the individual records will be used to create an audio preservation schedule. It was also agreed to purchase an archival quality reel-to-reel player, which could accommodate the various technical needs and the extremely fragile condition of the individual tapes.

Three proposals were discussed regarding the revision of the video "Markings On the Journey" — a minimum, a medium, and a maximum plan. After considering the financial aspects of these versions, it was decided to proceed with the medium plan. The completed project is currently being reviewed by the trustees' Archives Committee.

The value of the current clipping service was discussed and it was agreed that it would be most helpful if Archives receives the clippings after they have been circulated and then selects and preserves only those with permanent value.

The 2000 International Convention in Minneapolis was discussed, and the Committee unanimously approved plans to create a designated area for the G.S.O. Archives. The Committee felt that it should be centrally located and volunteered to help staff the booth for the duration of the Convention.

Tom Maguire, chairperson

Archivist's report: In 1998 we received an increasing number of requests for local group histories, while many areas and groups were providing updates of their histories for our permanent files. A sizable collection, approximately 120 boxes of original group records, was forwarded from Files Department to Archives. These had been scanned by Files for easy access, and now the original documents need to be captured and preserved for permanent storage.

We have started the preliminary exploration of our audio preservation needs. Throughout the years we have accumulated approximately 1,800 reel-to-reel tapes and 1,500 cassette recordings; these records are rapidly deteriorating. Considerable research had been done to explore the currently available magnetic preservation techniques. Audio preservation should become one of our primary concerns, since quite a few area archivists have also contacted us commenting on their disintegrating audio records. During the course of 1999 we will continue to explore our options for audio preservation.

We assisted a growing number of researchers in 1998, both from within and outside the Fellowship. Since it is in our collec-

A trustee related how past delegates, attending an area assembly, were sitting together in the back — 60 feet from the podium. When asked why, an oldtimer related that it was "far enough away not to interfere, but close enough so they could be seen glaring."

tive interest to maintain a safe and secure environment for our primary documentation, a small remodeling was done in the Archives as part of the G.S.O. reconstruction works. A new window had been installed between our former work area and the research room in order to provide better control over these areas. Many of our researchers have already commented positively on our new and improved appearance.

Judit Santon, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: We met three times since the 1998 General Service Conference. During that period we reviewed 1998 Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 49th General Service Conference, "Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility." We reviewed the summary of Evaluation Questionnaires submitted by Conference members, and agreed to encourage first-year delegates to include personal experiences and concerns in their Area Service Highlights to be presented during the 49th Conference. The committee also agreed that the descriptions in their Composition, Scope and Procedure were no longer accurate, and a subcommittee was appointed to draft a revision; the subcommittee's proposed revisions were later approved. We also reviewed topics submitted for Conference consideration and forwarded subjects to the appropriate trustees or Conference committee. We also discussed the committee's tentative 1999 budget and sent it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee, and reviewed the preliminary Agenda for the 49th Conference, as well as Workshop questions.

In January, the committee approved the updated main Conference Agenda, including presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the 1998 Conference. We considered Conference agenda topics submitted since the last meeting, and forwarded subjects to the appropriate trustees or Conference Committee. To fulfill voting requirements, we randomly drew the names of three trustees and one delegate to participate in the election of the Northeast regional trustee to be held during the 49th Conference.

MaryJane Roy, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference secretary is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the secretary corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The Conference secretary is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 92 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area committees for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referral to a Conference committee. The Conference secretary is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.

- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Joanie Moncrief

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: In 1998, a subcommittee was appointed to discuss the many aspects and options related to the enhancement of board weekends. The General Service Board reviewed the Board Weekends Sub-Committee report and on April 21, 1998 approved the recommendation that the trustees' Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee (C.P.C.) and the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee (T.F.) be combined. The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities held its first meeting on August 2, 1998. This combined committee considers separate C.P.C. and T.F. agendas and is served by two secretaries (The C.P.C. coordinator and the T.F. coordinator). Since the 1998 General Service Conference, the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee has met three times.

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The work of the Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board. Following is an overview of our work during the past year:

- A subcommittee was formed to consider revisions on C.P.C. Exhibit panels for the purpose of creating a more generic and current display. The subcommittee reviewed the History and Actions of the trustees' C.P.C. committee regarding the professional exhibits and the background material on the development and selection of the current C.P.C. panels. It was agreed that the following ideas should be expressed in the C.P.C. Exhibit panels: that they be targeted to the professional; that the concept of one alcoholic sharing with another be represented; that the worldwide, or global expansion of the Fellowship be expressed.

These suggestions were forwarded to the Publications Department, which later supplied the subcommittee with drafts of 17 different concepts incorporating the above ideas. The subcommittee met three times to consider the various drafts. A draft was selected to replace the "Our Beginnings" panel, which is currently included on the C.P.C. Exhibit. The committee agreed to forward this draft to the Conference committee for review.

- The committee, having considered suggestions for changes to the C.P.C. Workbook and the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," will include in the front pocket a one-page sheet listing the contents of the C.P.C. Kit. However, the committee will not add a section to the existing pamphlet for the health care professional from combined text on page 4 and page 13 of pamphlet "The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs" at this time.
- We discussed a request to change the designation of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and agreed to forward the request to the 1999 Conference Committee on C.P.C. for their consideration.
- We reviewed a request to revise the text under the title "Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other Than Alcohol" added to six C.P.C. pamphlets by the 1997 General Service Conference to include wording found in Tradition Three, "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drink-

ing," because the text as presently written may be misleading, and agreed to forward this request to the 1999 Conference Committee on C.P.C.

The committee reviewed and approved the updated list of C.P.C. exhibits scheduled for national meetings of professional associations. Twenty-five exhibits were coordinated for 1998. Information for professionals on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site was accessed over 35,000 times and C.P.C. committees acted as local resources for many of the more than 1,000 professionals who, via the e-mail Response Form, requested additional information and an A.A. contact.

Treatment Facilities — The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities is to "... further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S123) Consequently, the way in which the A.A. message is finally heard by alcoholics in treatment facilities is a matter of concern, attention and development by the committee. Following is an overview of our work during the past year:

The committee discussed the suggestion that a Treatment Facilities tabletop display be developed for use by local Treatment Facilities Committees. It was the sense of the meeting that such a display could be a valuable tool for local Treatment Facilities. *The committee secretary communicated with all Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging the Gap committee chairpersons encouraging local A.A. committees to develop their own displays to reflect their local activities and requirements.*

In June 1998, a questionnaire regarding carrying the message into noncorrectional youth facilities was sent to all area delegates as well as all Treatment Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap committee chairpersons. We received 36 responses from 24 delegate areas. The Committee reviewed the responses to this questionnaire and produced a condensed summary. This condensed summary along with an unedited summary of responses was forwarded to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for consideration.

We reviewed an alternative concise statement of resources for inclusion in future printings of the Treatment Facilities Handbook and Treatment Facilities Workbook. This revised text was forwarded to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for review.

At the request of the 1998 Conference, the committee produced a condensed summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire regarding carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The committee agreed to forward this summary of responses to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee.

Local Treatment Facilities committees are now carrying meetings into noncorrectional institutional environments, e.g., shelters, nursing homes, hospices, half-way houses and not just limiting their scope to "treatment facilities." The trustees' Committee continues to provide support for this special Twelfth Step service.

Dean Rinehart, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — The purpose of the C.P.C. assignment is to provide information about A.A. and establish good communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work. These professionals include physicians, nurs-

es, attorneys, correctional personnel, the clergy, social workers, counselors, employers, educators, and those working in the field of alcoholism. The staff member on this assignment maintains communication with C.P.C. committee chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons are sent a welcome letter and receive the C.P.C. Kit containing the C.P.C. Workbook, Guidelines, History and Actions, A.A. pamphlets and Literature Catalog, *Box 4-5-9*, and a current issue of *About A.A.* Upon request we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience and providing C.P.C. material. Currently there are over 400 area, district and central office/intergroup C.P.C. committees. We receive minutes from several of these committees and encourage all to share their experience for possible inclusion in *Box 4-5-9*.

In the past year the C.P.C. staff member has responded to nearly two thousand inquiries; 1,076 of these requests for information about A.A. followed visits to our A.A. Web Site. We often provide a link to the local C.P.C. committees which demonstrate how valuable C.P.C. service is on all fronts. By now, most of these professionals can share that not only does A.A. respond in a friendly manner and provide literature about A.A., but many are in contact with A.A. members providing local information about A.A. in their community. C.P.C. committees can also share that they have accumulated much experience through cooperating with these professionals in ways that preserve the spirit of A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

Twenty-five exhibits were coordinated for national professional meetings for 1998 and staffed by local C.P.C. committees. Twenty invitations were referred to area C.P.C. committees for local professional events. In addition, we furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees. Exhibits continued to be an effective tool in carrying the message to professionals and often result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as requests to receive issues of our publication *About A.A.* Currently more than 21,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Meetings with students from Cornell University Medical Center continue to be set up throughout the year at G.S.O. The students are provided with literature about A.A., see the video "Hope: Alcoholic Anonymous," and have a brief introduction to the A.A. program, concluding with a tour of G.S.O. Following each visit the students thank us for the opportunity to know A.A. as a resource in their future professions.

Adrienne Brown

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to provide information and service material in order to assist the work of local A.A. members who wish to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics in treatment. We now have about 92 area Treatment Facilities chairpersons, 245 district Treatment Facilities chairpersons, and 116 "Other" Treatment Facilities chairpersons. We attempt to maintain an up-to-date list of the chairs of these committees and provide them all with information and literature. In order to carry the message "inside," the A.A. member often meets with administrators and personnel in many different types of treatment settings. He or she must become familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and be willing to comply with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!" The local A.A. member also offers to provide information about A.A. groups in the client's hometown and encourages active involvement with A.A. upon leaving the facility. This is called "bridging the gap" or A.A. Temporary Contact. If a treatment center wants A.A. and Temporary Contact information, a member of A.A. should clearly present the primary purpose of A.A. The video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" is often shown to treatment cen-

ter staff and clients and continues to be a useful tool. Helping someone just out of treatment get settled into a regular home group is the essence of Twelfth Step work.

The Treatment Facilities Workbook is a comprehensive guide about carrying the message "inside." It contains shared experience, suggestions, general information, guidelines and literature. Treatment Facilities chairpersons receive *Box 4-5-9, About A.A.* and a list of the 92 area chairs in the U.S. and Canada in order to share current treatment facilities experience. For referral purposes, all chairs receive copies of the U.S./Canada Directory of intergroups, central offices and answering services.

Inquiries arrive at the Treatment Facilities desk via letter, telephone, fax and e-mail. They come from three main sources: (1) newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities, (2) local A.A.s who have become or are interested in becoming active on treatment facilities committees, and (3) treatment facilities administrators or personnel requesting information about A.A. and assistance in setting up meetings. Valuable information and treatment facilities sharing is provided to G.S.O. through minutes and reports sent in by treatment facilities committees.

In addition, another major staff activity entails serving as secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities. Responsibilities in this area include responding to mail from committee members, helping to prepare agendas for committee meetings, preparing background material and preparing minutes at the conclusion of meetings. The staff member also gathers material for occasional treatment facilities articles in *Box 4-5-9*.

Bill Archer

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics confined in correctional institutions. Since the 1998 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities has met three times to implement Advisory Actions of the 1998 General Service Conference and to develop ways to more effectively carry A.A.'s message to the alcoholic inmate.

The video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls," approved by the 1998 Conference, is now available in English, French and Spanish. "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" has been shown at Regional and Special Forums, area assemblies and workshops, and other A.A. events and the response has been very positive. The committee plans to discuss the need for a companion service piece at its July 1999 meeting. In addition, the committee discussed the video's potential for positively impacting wardens and other correctional professionals.

At the recommendation of the 1998 Conference, an addition relative to carrying the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities has been added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook. In the Oct./Nov. 1998 *Box 4-5-9*, the committee asked A.A.s carrying the message into youth detention centers to share their challenges and successes. A later article is planned to share any useful ideas and information received.

At the suggestion of the Conference C.F. Committee we developed a one-page informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals and agreed to forward it to the 1999 Conference Committee on C.F. for review. We also reviewed our 1999 preliminary budget and, with a minor revision, agreed to forward it to the trustees' Finance and Budget Committee.

The committee determined that an A.A. member's request to have the G.S.O. coordinate pre-release contact linkages for the U.S.

and Canada would be beyond the scope of services provided by G.S.O. and suggested that the effort to provide pre-release contact linkages through local C.F. committees continue to be supported.

Based upon a subcommittee's report regarding revisions of *A.A. In Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic," and "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell," and after lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the Publications Department make recommendations with regard to using a smaller format for "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell." The committee discussed the following changes to "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell": new or updated graphics; larger type; new format size the same as the large-print edition of "Time to Start Living." It was also recommended that the following additions and revisions to "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell" be forwarded to the 1999 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for consideration: three new stories; revised text for section "We Set Up A.A. Contacts."

The committee reviewed background information on Bridging the Gap (BTG) and agreed to forward it to the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions with the suggestion that a Conference Committee on BTG not be created at this time.

Linda Chezem, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in correctional institutions. Approximately 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support in this effort from experienced A.A.s with whom they can share their strength, hope and experience. We have an attractive service piece "Corrections Correspondence — a Special Kind of A.A. Service," which we include in new group packages and can be ordered for group literature stands. The number of inmate requests for correspondence contacts are submitted at a 4:1 ratio when compared with the number of outside A.A.s submitting their names to the CCS. Yet, whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of the service piece there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside.

As the Correctional Facilities assignment continues its effort to facilitate the Fellowship's Twelfth Step work regarding the alcoholic inmate, a key objective remains developing ways to capture the interest of more A.A.s throughout the United States and Canada in the Corrections Correspondence Service. There is an on-going need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service.

Finally, during the first nine months in which the new video, "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" has been available, the assignment has received many positive responses to it.

Warren Stafford

Tom Kraemer (Saskatchewan) thought he would be the only person there when he went down to the lobby late at night to sign the various A.A. books left outside the meeting room. He was surprised to find three other delegates having a "book signing" session.

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 1998 and reported that the G.S.O. expected income from operations was \$237,900 (\$190,510 after mid-year Conference adjustments). This followed substantial, but planned, losses in both 1995, 1996 and 1997 that helped to lower the Reserve Fund balance. Today I can report that actual results for 1998 were very close to budget and that we have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund balance, which now stands at just nine months.

As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. I am encouraged that contributions in 1998 were higher than both those received in 1997 and the amount we had hoped to receive for 1998. Contributions were \$184,000, or 4.8%, higher than 1997 and \$107,000 (2.7%) higher than our budget as well. In any case, during 1998, \$4,039,000 in contributions were received from 25,175 groups. That, for comparison, represents 44.6% of the 56,440 groups registered with G.S.O., and is just about even with the 44.5% that contributed in 1997.

Net sales of literature were \$8,912,200. This was \$422,000 less than budgeted, but \$14,000, or .16%, greater than the previous year. Keep in mind that some literature prices were adjusted upward in May 1997, following two years of lower prices and increased discounts. In fact, the number of actual books and booklets sold declined about 9% below the 1997 level, which was itself about 4% below 1996 levels. In total printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted and less than the prior year, so gross profit from literature sales increased. Gross profit of \$4,520,000 was \$260,000 less than budgeted but \$276,000 more than realized in 1997.

As a result, total G.S.O. revenue was \$8,562,400. Total revenue was \$153,000, or 1.75%, less than originally budgeted, but \$459,400, or 5.7%, greater than 1997.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 1998 were \$8,422,800. This is \$102,000 less than budget, and essentially "flat" to the previous year. Therefore, compared to the budget, the modest reduction in revenues was significantly offset by the reduced expenses, resulting in an operating profit of \$140,000 for the year, compared to a (adjusted) budgeted loss of \$190,500.

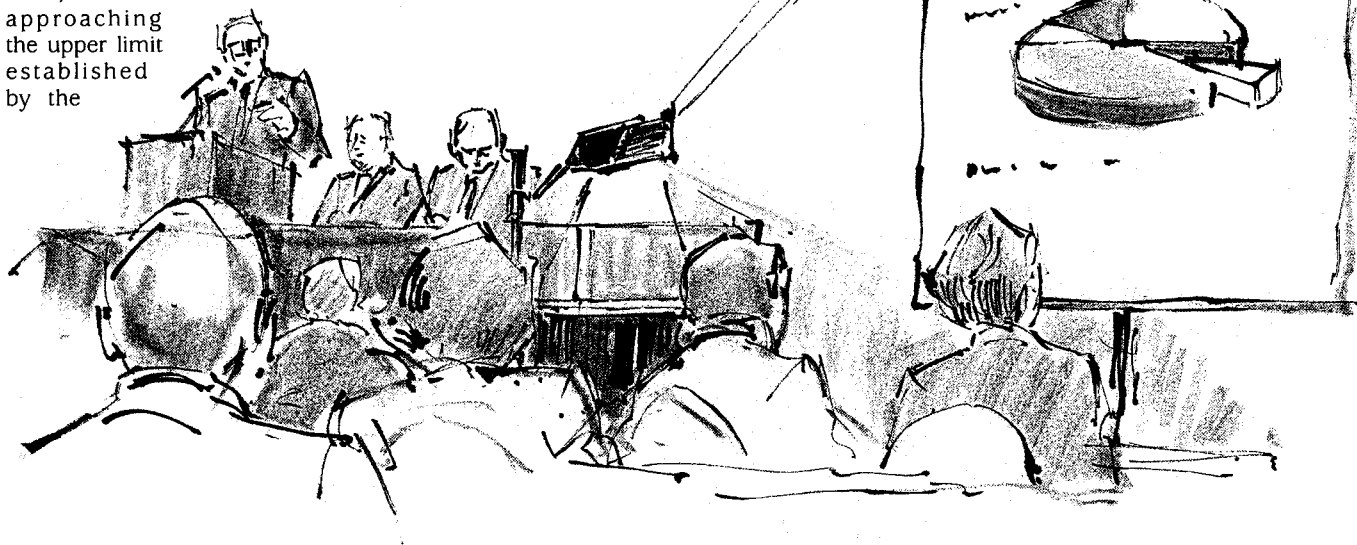
In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the

General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We have accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. It now stands at 9 months, which is a little lower than it should be in normal times. At \$7,440,900, the Reserve Fund amounts to \$131 per listed A.A. group. As I described in this report last year, price adjustments were required in May of 1997 for us to continue our current level of services. Since 1990, our unit sales of books have declined at an average rate of about 4.5% per year. We are now selling almost one-third fewer books (actually 30.5% fewer, even with additional formats and titles) than we were selling in 1990. Despite excellent cost control - our operating and shipping expenses were actually slightly lower in 1998 than they were in 1991 when we last raised prices - we simply had to raise prices if we are to continue to provide the Fellowship with the current level of services.

We cannot ignore the reality of the continuing decline in unit literature sales; therefore, the 1999 G.S.O. budget assumes a further 6% decline of books & booklets. More optimistically, this year's budget includes a 1.5% increase in contributions. Additionally, the budget envisions a minimal, \$258,000 (3%), increase in operating expenses.

Based on these primary assumptions — a 6% decrease in literature unit sales; a 1.5% increase in contributions; a 3% increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 1999 is for a modest excess of revenue over expense of \$174,000. As I mentioned last year, following three consecutive years of losses, the Reserve Fund is at the point where it is prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we are!

In 1998, we spent \$5,867,700 on services to the Fellowship, slightly (\$75,000) less than the \$5,944,000 spent in 1997 and \$5,925,000 in 1996. Contributions provided 69% of this and 31% came from net literature sales. This year, no funds were needed from the Reserve Fund. Services



spending amounted to \$104 per listed A.A. group, slightly less than 1996, while contributions were \$72 per group. The 1998 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services), 39.5%; C.P.C., 4.5%; Public Information, 4.1%; Treatment Facilities, 2.%; Correctional Facilities, 3.7%; Loners Internationalists and Overseas Services, 8.6%; the General Service Conference, 12.%; Regional Forums, 4.8%; Archives, 6.5%; trustees' and directors' activities, 8.3%; Spanish Services, 3.9%; and 1.9% for expenses of the World Service Meeting not covered by country contributions to that event.

At the Grapevine, magazine income rose \$40,000 over last year because of the price increase that took effect on new subscriptions beginning April 1, 1996. Circulation was somewhat lower. Average circulation during 1998 was 117,300 compared with 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,050,000, which was \$70,000 higher than last year but \$28,000 less than budget. This \$70,000 was a result of direct productions costs being approximately even with budgeted, and approximately \$30,000 less than the prior year. While revenue of Other Items was slightly higher than budgeted, and \$49,000 greater than 1997, gross profit on Other Items was approximately even with 1997. Total income, including interest income, was \$1,409,500, \$75,000 greater than last year but \$64,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,454,700. This was \$38,000 higher than last year and \$29,000 less than budget. The Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a loss of \$145,200, \$35,000 greater than budgeted, and \$35,000 less than 1997.

The Grapevine's 1999 budget, excluding La Viña, calls for a \$18,000 increase in magazine subscription income to \$1,721,400, compared with 1998, and a decrease of \$27,000 in magazine gross profit. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$92,000, interest income should remain approximately the same and costs and expenses are projected to increase by \$49,000. The net effect is a budgeted decline in net loss, from \$45,200 in 1998 to \$29,700 in 1999.

As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 1998 average circulation of close to 7,700, (down from 8,400 in 1997). Personally speaking, La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Hopefully, it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see continued growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past three and one-half years. During 1998, subscription income was \$57,600 and direct costs of publishing were \$50,700, resulting in a \$6,900 gross profit. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$73,000. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project was \$66,200 for the year.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost effective basis. For 1999, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to increase to \$69,600 and circulation is projected essentially the same, 7,500 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr., chairperson

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1999¹

	Groups	Members
United States	51,183	1,166,927
Canada	5,257	101,786
Correctional facilities ²	2,466	63,002
Internationalists		124
Lone members		347
Total	58,906	1,332,126
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	39,804	656,938
Grand Total	98,710	1,989,124

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in approximately 150 countries, including 44 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use the previous year's figures.

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The board has held three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference. In August 1998 the session was unstructured and all were encouraged to share whatever was on their minds. The October topic was "General Service and the Ninth Tradition" emphasizing that A.A. as such ought never be organized. This past January, "How We Work with Each Other from Within" was the topic of the Sharing Session.

In August, a brief history of the General Sharing Session was presented, noting that it began in 1955 and was then known as the Policy Committee and was considered the most important committee of the board. In 1977, the Policy Committee evolved into the General Service Sharing Session with guest speakers often invited. The General Sharing Session as we now know it began in 1981.

During the unstructured sharing session, concerns covered a variety of topics including how remote communities are defined, the lack of group participation in supporting general services, the role of International Conventions, carrying the message to African-American communities in particular and to Africa in general and diversity in the Fellowship. Remote communities committees were originally committed to carrying the message to Native populations in both the U.S. and Canada. Concern was expressed that these efforts may be diluted as remote communities committees are becoming involved with activities to meet special needs locally. It was noted that many means of carrying the message are needed. It is a matter of organizing our efforts and maintaining our focus to be effective in carrying the message to populations difficult to reach.

The need for carrying the message to the black American community was mentioned and it was suggested that, regarding

A.A. worldwide, there has been no significant effort to carry the message to the black community in Africa. Should the board, Conference and general service structure be more proactive? Special Forums in inner cities and a recovery pamphlet for African Americans were suggested as examples of special efforts that could be made in this country. The importance and value of diversity in A.A. were considered and the efforts of the trustees' Nominating Committee to encourage the Fellowship to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve when vacancies occur were noted.

Regarding the lack of groups participating in supporting general services, it was recalled that in 1997 only 23 areas could report that more than 50% of their groups are supporting G.S.O. It is up to each of us to encourage greater participation emphasizing that participation is more important than the dollar amount contributed.

In regard to International Conventions, several agreed that an in-depth, well-informed discussion of International Conventions would be worthwhile. Others mentioned many benefits of International Conventions, stating they are a unifying effort and the one event sponsored by the General Service Board that gets the attention of the entire Fellowship. A great deal of public information is also a benefit of those events, as examples to the world of how A.A. can function together. The large attendance indicates the Fellowship wants them. If the board stops sponsoring International Conventions, someone else will do it and the result may be a watered-down version of Alcoholic Anonymous. International Conventions are a celebration and the fun and joy experienced at these events should not be denied to future members.

In October, presentations by John Koster, A.A.W.S. director, and Dean Rinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S., sparked a thought-provoking discussion on "General Service and the Ninth Tradition." John pointed out that the distinction between the declared lack of organization within A.A., and how the *movement* operates in practice, and is *perceived* in practice both by many A.A. members and by the general public, may not be so clear and stressed the importance of maintaining the difference between the unorganized part of A.A. and the organized part. Dean described A.A. as the most unorganized, organized Fellowship that ever existed, adding that we have been able to weather discord because of our firm commitment to unity. The ensuing discussion indicated that, although it is easy to take Tradition Nine for granted, there is a tendency towards organization within the Fellowship as shown by calls to G.S.O. questioning whether the International Conference of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA) or central offices/intergroups are part of the A.A. Fellowship. There is also growing pressure on G.S.O. to enforce certain rules with regard to registering groups. The view was expressed that the trend towards conformity may be dangerous for A.A. The service structure needs organization in order to help others find Alcoholic Anonymous, or find a group conscience. Concern was expressed, however, that the structure of A.A. may be becoming too large — with perhaps too much emphasis on the trusted servants' positions at the expense of the A.A. member . . . the danger of creating a special class within A.A. It was agreed that the magic of A.A. still exists and through faith, things happen . . . such as the recent growth of A.A. in other countries.

Presentations from Tom Maguire, general service trustee, and Jan Polek, A.A.W.S. director, prompted a very meaningful and thoughtful discussion about "How We Work with Each Other From Within" at the January General Sharing Session. Through sharing his own experiences on the board, Tom talked about how he learned to take to heart Bill W.'s suggestion "that a leader in A.A. service is a man or woman who can personally put plans

and policies into such dedicated and effective action, that the rest of us want to back him up and help him with his job." Tom recalled Bill's words that we must never lose sight of the fact that progress is nearly always characterized by a series of "improving compromises," adding that Bill also said, "Now and then, it is necessary to stick flat-footed to one's convictions." He also shared his awareness that because of his position as a trusted servant on the board, he must remember to be careful about what he says at round-ups, assemblies, conferences, etc. because if he speaks carelessly in an unkind way about board activities, the audience might never have an opportunity to hear the other side. Jan emphasized our need to listen to each other and relate to what is being said, keeping the focus on the "message" rather than the "messenger." Waiting in silence, which requires humility and discipline, to seek answers is important. Stating that "humility" is the one truly essential quality for working well together, Jan noted that Robert Greenleaf defines the best kind of trusted servant: "No man or woman is complete; no one is to be entrusted with all. Completeness is to be found only in the complementary talents of several who relate as equals." Although we usually turn away from discussions of power, Warranty One speaks of "spiritual power which flows from the activities and attitudes of truly humble, unselfish and dedicated A.A. servants." Our strength lies in our need for each other. Comments following the presentations reflected that although words are very important, actions say even more. When we differ, we should remember that everyone wants what he or she believes is best for A.A. We all serve as equals who carry the message with different levels of experience.

In decision-making, it is impossible to have all the information on a subject so we need to resist the temptation to reach conclusions as if we have all the information. Being nonjudgmental, showing respect for each other and having self-respect are important. We must exercise the responsibility to speak up when silence might imply concurrence with something we do not agree with. We need to think less about our rights and more about our responsibilities. We need to overcome arrogance and learn to speak lovingly. It is important to choose words to draw each other out because most of us are so fearful. Recalling that Bill equated leadership to sponsorship, a person's life may depend on how well we choose our words.

Linda Chezem, chairperson

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal service meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

The 15th World Service Meeting was held October 4-8, 1998 in Auckland, New Zealand. The biennial meeting for delegates from countries with organized service structures brought together 39 delegates from 22 countries. U.S./Canada was represented by Michel Girard, trustee-at-large/Canada, as a second-term delegate and Dean Rhinehart, trustee-at-large/U.S., as a first-term delegate. Michel served as chairperson of the Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee and Dean served on the Literature/Publishing Committee, which he will serve at the next WSM as chairperson. George Dorsey was co-chairperson of the event and served along with Bill Cundall, chairperson of the New

Zealand General Service Conference. Richard Bush was the World Service Meeting co-ordinator. Other G.S.O. staff members and employees who attended to support the work of the meeting were John Kirwin, Ivy Rivera, Valerie O'Neill, Eva Sanchez, Adrienne Brown and Danny Mooney.

The 1999 Literature Assistance budget of \$109,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign-language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense, probably about 15 percent, will be drawn from the International Literature Fund. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution in those countries which have an established General Service office, board, conference or structure. If no such structure exists, we translate and publish subject to scheduling by publications and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 1998, in addition to a number of reprints, we completed "44 Questions" and "This Is A.A." in Greek; the Croatian Big Book and a Romanian *Living Sober*. A joint effort with Great Britain, which is a sponsor to Greece at the European Service Meeting, produced a Greek Big Book in February. Major projects currently planned for 1999 include a Croatian Twelve and Twelve and a Romanian Big Book.

The General Service Board and the General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, to anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits or regional assemblies or events. Requests for help in developing service structures and to develop offices and publications came in various ways from several countries. One such request was made at the 15th WSM regarding French-speaking countries in Africa by the World Service delegate of French-speaking Europe. We had board and staff members visit countries including El Salvador, New Zealand, Mexico, Dominican Republic, Belgium, France, Lithuania, Poland, Germany, Latvia and Romania in 1998. The three service zones will have meetings in 1999. The European Service Meeting will be held in October in Frankfurt; the Meeting of the Americas will be held this fall in San Salvador, El Salvador; and the Asia/Oceania Meeting will be held in March in Sydney, Australia. The board and office are represented as delegates or observers and participants in these meetings.

Countries for which there are current plans for visits in

1999 include Australia, El Salvador, Germany, Mexico, Ukraine, Peru, Iceland, Senegal, Sweden and South Africa with other invitations pending. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Michel Girard, chairperson

Staff report: The International Desk receives requests for help from alcoholics in the depths of misery that we all understand, letters from new groups asking for literature and the reassurance of identification and shared experience, from professionals seeking information on how A.A. works, and from members staffing a new office that is struggling to stay afloat. Each request is answered with a letter, often accompanied by A.A. literature. Where there is a nearby office, we share the location and telephone number. The emphasis is on our faith that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department, and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new General Service or Information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of checking each translation against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 40 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.

Responsibilities in regard to translations include close cooperation with the Spanish Services staff member who may first receive up-to-date details on A.A. in a country where Spanish is the primary language, and communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. Our board sends one or two representatives to the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting, the European Service Meeting and the Meeting of the Americas (formerly the Ibero-American Meeting). We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in the new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Richard Bush



INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention — The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. Ultimately the committee acts and makes recommendations in order to effect the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions.

The objectives of the 2000 International Convention with its theme "Pass It On - Into the 21st Century" are: to provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.; to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world; to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee reviewed its procedures and time frame regarding inviting the proposed local Host Committee chair, Chuck Rice, to attend one of its upcoming meetings. Subsequently, an invitation was extended to Chuck to attend the October 1998 committee meeting. Following that meeting the committee recommended that Chuck serve as the local Host Committee chairperson for the 2000 International Convention. We reviewed the preliminary listing of Host Committee responsibilities from the 1995 Convention and reviewed a summary of 2000 Host Committee responsibilities based on 15 proposed subcommittees.

Five trustees attended Al-Anon's Third International Convention in Salt Lake City, July 2-5. This was a unique opportunity for trustees to meet and share with large numbers of Al-Anon members. G.S.O. coordinated open A.A. meetings, an alkathon and a hospitality suite. There were A.A. meetings in several languages and speakers came from all parts of U.S./Canada as well as several other countries. These meetings were well attended and A.A. volunteers welcomed visitors and encouraged wide local and international attendance at our meetings.

The General Service Board approved the committee's recommendation that a desk-top format of Daily Reflections be produced as the 2000 International Convention souvenir item.

The committee approved the final budget for the 2000 International Convention at a special meeting on April 20th. This budget was also reviewed at a special meeting of the trustees' Finance Committee on April 20th.

The committee discussed setting a registration fee, which is based on a realistic budget that takes into account the possibilities of gain or loss, and the committee's responsibility in this matter. It was recommended that the preregistration fee be \$85.00 (U.S.) per attendee and that the on-site registration fee be \$95.00 (U.S.) per attendee.

The final budget and registration fee(s) will be approved by the General Service Board at their April 24, 1999 meeting.

The committee acknowledged that there is ongoing discussion of the General Service Board's policy regarding accepting and negotiating discounts and subsidies for International Conventions.

The committee reviewed and approved program titles for the 2000 International Convention, with the understanding that some titles may be added or deleted, depending on final needs.

A.A. Regional Forums — Four regions have held Forums since the last General Service Conference: Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast. All were lively and well-attended with substantive sharing on important A.A. topics. A Special

Forum was held in Montana at two sites: Helena and Miles City. It was an outstanding success with nearly 60 percent of all attendees being at their first Forum.

The following Forums and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2000 General Service Conference:

1999		
June 11-13	Northeast	Altoona, Pennsylvania
August 21-22	Special	San Juan, Puerto Rico
September 10-12	West Central	Sheridan, Wyoming
September 24-26	East Central	Ann Arbor, Michigan
October 8-9	Special	Window Rock, Arizona
December 3-5	Southwest	Lubbock, Texas

The trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums took an inventory on Regional and Special Forums, where we are and where do we go from here, at a Special Dinner Meeting over the January Board Weekend.

Peter Roach, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions — This assignment entails coordinating the myriad processes involved in producing our A.A. anniversary International Conventions. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a celebration of A.A. sharing and thanksgiving.

Plans proceed apace for the 2000 International Convention, which will be held in the wonderful city of Minneapolis, Minnesota, June 29-July 2, 2000. The Convention theme, chosen from the many suggestions sent in by the Fellowship, is "Pass It On—Into the 21st Century." The 2000 International Convention will kick off Thursday night with a "block party" and dances in downtown Minneapolis and at the Convention Center. There will be stadium Big Meetings, Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons, all of which include about 750 speakers. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night Big Meeting at the Hubert A. Humphrey Metrodome Stadium. The Convention Center will be the major daytime focus of activity on Friday and Saturday. Minneapolis A.A.s will serve as members of the local Host Committee. Excitement abounds as this joyful 65th Anniversary event draws nearer.

Valerie O'Neill

Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of

the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing a comprehensive report of the Forum to all who attend. A new addition to the final report has been the use of a few photos (no faces except of Class As), to help break up the copy.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs. One Special Forum was held in 1998 — August 15-16 in Helena and Miles City, Montana. This Forum was very productive in generating enthusiasm for service work and was well attended at both sites.

The staff member on Regional Forums also serves as secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees. Under the present structure the staff member on Forums is also responsible for Service Material.

Susan Ulseth

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: Following is a summary of the projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 1998 Conference.

Project Completed — Sections from the pamphlet "The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs"—the lead-in and 9 points on pages 5 and 6 in the section entitled "A report from a group of physicians in A.A." and page 13 entitled "However, some alcoholics require medication . . ." — were added as an appendix to the booklet *Living Sober*, which is now in distribution. The video *Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure* is in distribution.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee — The following recommendations and suggestions to the Conference Literature Committee:

- Recommended that G.S.O.'s Publications Department maintain specific editorial responsibilities regarding the Fourth Edition Big Book Project.

- Recommended that based on precedent in regard to previous editions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a "for-their-eyes-only" basis adhering to the principle of the "right of decision," and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication.

- A request for an A.A. history book.

- Recommended the development of a pamphlet directed to the Black/African American alcoholic.

- Referred a proposal to replace or update the pamphlet, "Time to Start Living."

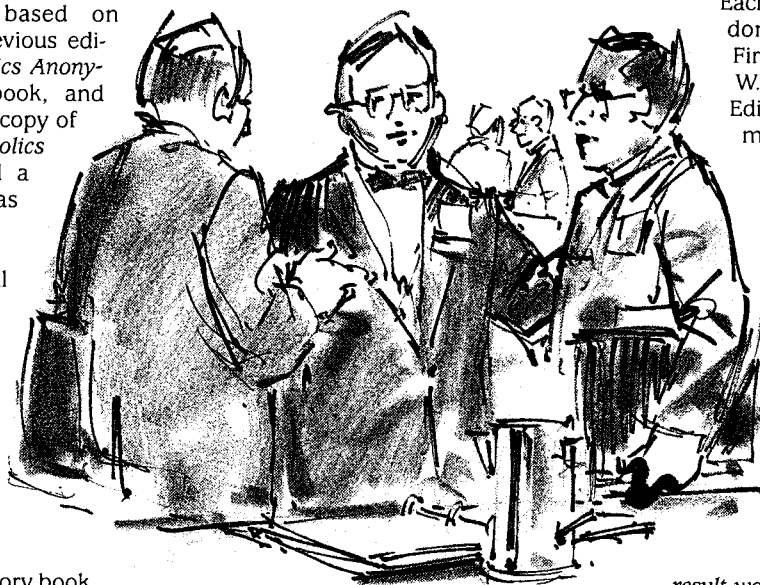
Ongoing Project — Progress report on a possible Fourth Edition Big Book: The subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book has met six times since the 1998 Conference for a total of 14 meetings since its inception in May 1997. By the December 1998 meeting, the subcommittee had completed its thorough review of the 1,222 new stories submitted by members of the Fellowship for possible inclusion in a Fourth Edition. The review of the stories included many stages that began in December 1997. There has been both a quantitative and qualitative assessment of each of these stories by all members of the subcommittee. As a result of the review process, there now remain 95 stories that are under further consideration for possible inclusion in a Fourth Edition. These 95 stories each meet the two major criteria the subcommittee has applied to its review of each submitted story: a) each story must, as Bill Wilson recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution, and b) each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today. As it agreed to the further consideration of the remaining 95, the subcommittee noted with gratitude the great outpouring of sharing represented by the 1,222 submissions. The fact that this many members have submitted their stories represents the very best possible participation by the Fellowship in the development of the Fourth Edition.

At the January 1999 meeting, the subcommittee's group conscience was that the proposed Fourth Edition ought to include some of the stories now found in the Third Edition and some new stories. Beginning at its March 18, 1999 meeting it will continue its systematic review of all Third Edition Stories so that it might determine which of those stories it will recommend for inclusion in the Fourth Edition. The subcommittee further agreed that all stories, both Third Edition stories and new stories, will be evaluated through use of the same criteria noted above. The goal is to propose a Fourth Edition that reflects the broadest possible sharing to reach newcomers.

Recommendations that are now going to the Conference Literature Committee grew out of a concern as to exactly how this project will go forward through the Conference process.

Each publication of the Big Book was done somewhat differently. The First and Second Editions had Bill W.'s direct supervision. The Third Edition relied strongly on the committee process.

This latter model of trusting the committee process and the group conscience decisions of the Conference Literature Committee and the trustees' Literature Committee led to the recommendation related to the confidential nature of a draft copy Fourth Edition, recognizing that it is a work-in-progress. The recommendation suggests that the Conference consider relying on the group conscience of the two committees to provide the Fellowship with appropriate new stories. The result would limit distribution of any draft,



prior to publication, to the Conference Literature Committee and the trustees' Literature Committee only. It is hoped that when the subcommittee's draft copy is ready, the Conference Literature Committee and the trustees' Literature Committee members will continue working closely together to communicate their thoughts and provide their input to each other.

The subcommittee agreed it was vitally important to recognize the critical role of the Publications Department in the development of this project. To assure that the Publications Department plays the same role with the Fourth Edition that it played with the previous editions the trustees' Literature Committee has made a recommendation to the Conference Literature Committee outlining the specific editorial responsibilities that will rest with the Publications Department.

All six subcommittee members have expressed their gratitude for the opportunity to serve the Fellowship in the development of this awesome project — it has been a highlight of their service experience.

The development of a book of stories dropped from the First, Second and Third Editions has not as yet begun as decisions related to the Fourth Edition *Alcoholics Anonymous* have not been made.

Additional trustees' Literature Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the preliminary material submitted for the development of a group oriented "Traditions Checklist," and felt that the Grapevine's Traditions Checklist was sufficient.
- Declined the request to add a paragraph from "The A.A. Group" pamphlet on page 22 which begins, "The primary purpose of any A.A. group is to carry the A.A. message to *alcoholics*," to the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and to the Big Book because they felt it was in the appropriate piece of literature.
- Forwarded the proposal for the development of a pamphlet for use by local Special Needs Committees to consolidate shared A.A. experience with carrying our message to people with disabilities and to encourage awareness of A.A. among professionals serving that population, to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee for their consideration and input.
- Forwarded to the Publications Department for review the proposal that a section be inserted in the next reprint of the French version of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and in the French version of *The A.A. Service Manual* to describe "La Vigne Representative" and requested Publications bring back a recommendation to the July 1999 committee meeting.
- Discussed a proposal to remove the word "ideally" in paragraph two, page 18 in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and in paragraph one, page S50 in *The A.A. Service Manual* and agreed the word "ideally" was appropriately used and took no action.
- Considered incorporating the second to last paragraph in Concept IX into the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and agreed that this transfer was not appropriate, because, in this instance, language written for one piece of literature and taken out of context did not convert satisfactorily to another piece of literature and they declined to take any action on this matter.

The trustees' Literature Committee has had a full agenda throughout the year. The members of this committee and its various subcommittees have worked diligently and with focused consideration on each item submitted for their attention. Some committee members will be rotating on, and the stewardship of this important committee will have new minds and new spirits to help guide it. Others will remain to bring continuity and a depth of experience to share with these new members. All of the efforts of this committee are to serve the Fellowship and assist

in keeping the doors of A.A. wide open for all who might seek out our message of hope.

Gary McAuley, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. Additionally, the literature coordinator serves as secretary to the Subcommittee on the Fourth Edition Big Book.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the literature desk serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish. Work is ongoing all year for ideas for *Box 4-5-9* articles, and the calendar of events is kept up to date daily. The staff member works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. through *Box 4-5-9*. Your ideas and suggestions are always welcome.

Doug Richardson

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS

Staff report: As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 350 Loners in 80 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s, known as Internationalists, number about 125 with an additional 46 Port Contacts. Nine Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 210 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Homers are a fast-growing segment of the LIM community. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober by reading A.A. literature and by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and e-mail.

A complimentary literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Each also receives a Loners, Homers, and Internationalists directory. On alternate months, complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting-By-Mail* (a bimonthly meeting in print which shares excerpts of letters received at G.S.O. from LIM members) are sent to keep the Lone member linked to the Fellowship. In addition, there are over 680 Loner Sponsors. They are neither "sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Their role is to share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence.

Loner Jim H. from Thies, Senegal writes: "How needlessly isolated I felt my first year here in Africa. I felt as though I were all alone with my state of being an alcoholic with nowhere to turn. How wrong I was! I've got meetings in print, fellow alcoholics to write to, and letters from others. I was isolating myself through

sloth and pride. What a relief to see the error of my ways! The first year I was in a pit of self-pity and hurt; all alone and no one cared to help me. What I didn't know was that I only had to reach out for help (through one letter to *LIM*) and the whole world was there to give me a helping hand. This second year of service is going considerably better now that I have discovered the activity of writing through the Loners program. Thank you so much for keeping this part of the program an option for those of us who need it."

Since January 1998, we have received sharing from Arctic Bay to Arizona and from the following countries: Australia, Bolivia, China, Ethiopia, England, Finland, France, Germany, Ghana, Italy, Israel, Japan, Lithuania, Nigeria, Nepal, Pago Pago, Papua New Guinea, Philippines, Poland, Romania, Saudi Arabia, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Scotland, South Africa, Spain, Tanzania and Thailand.

Homer Philip G. from Miami, Florida, writes to *LIM* members: "Whenever you feel especially harried and just a little bit crazy, remember, you are my hands and feet. You are bringing the world home to me!"

Much gratitude goes to Loner Sponsors who share regularly. From Scotland, Loner Sponsor Jim M. reminds us: "I would like to take this opportunity to thank Loners for the last two months. I asked to be put on your list as a Loner Sponsor and, to date, I have written to over 17 people. I cannot explain the feedback I have had in this short time — it has been tremendous. I can't put into words my emotions and feelings when complete strangers want to share with me. A few days ago, I wrote to a Loner in Kathmandu! These were places I'd only read about. God keeps on revealing to me things beyond my wildest dreams; where but in A.A. could you share your experience, strength and hope with a person 6,000 miles away. Since starting to write to people all over the world, especially Homers, it makes me feel humble and very lucky. It is also a privilege to hear from people in other countries about how they maintain their sobriety on a daily basis. The strength which I am receiving from all of those people only tells me one thing — A.A. works."

It is a privilege to work on the *LIM* assignment and to coordinate support and service to so many A.A. members who show, on a daily basis, courage and commitment to their recovery and to Alcoholics Anonymous under very challenging circumstances.

Bill Archer

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedures, and did not make any changes. The 1999 calendar of events was accepted, and the Advisory Actions of the Conference Committee on Trustees were reviewed. The committee recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee that \$6,600 be budgeted for interviewing four "friends of A.A." to fill the position to be vacated by Peter Roach in 2000.

We discussed inviting "friends of A.A." to serve as appointed committee members of trustees' committees. The discussion led to much broader sharing on the role of appointed committee members, including the future needs of trustees' committees that have appointed committee members (Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information, Treatment Facilities, and Literature). Also considered was the realization that it was of utmost importance to seek

more detailed information directly from the committees on which appointed committee members serve before addressing the original topic regarding "friends of A.A." serving as appointed committee members. A questionnaire pertaining to the role of appointed committee members was developed and sent to the trustees' committees concerned, and the results were returned to the Nominating Committee for further discussion. The staff secretary researched Conference Advisory Actions pertaining to appointed committee members and submitted a written report on the history of appointed committee members to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

The committee reviewed the completed questionnaires regarding: appointed committee members and "friends of A.A." that were returned by the trustees' C.P.C., C.F., P.I., T.F., and Literature Committees. After a lengthy discussion on the role of appointed committee members on trustees' committees, it was felt that trustees' committees always need the most qualified people in order to accomplish the work of their committees. The Nominating Committee did not reach a conclusion and recommended that the role of appointed committee members, consultants, and the option to consider "friends of A.A." to serve as appointed committee members be a topic of discussion by the General Service Board.

The Nominating Committee received a letter dated November 16, 1998 from an appointed committee member, on behalf of other appointed committee members, asking for answers to the following questions: What are the role and responsibilities of appointed committee members? Can they attend the entire board weekend? Can they attend the meetings of other trustees' committees during the board weekend?

The General Service Board plans to discuss this topic in a special session during the April 1999 General Service Conference and will respond to the inquiry at that time.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Board:* Jim Clough, Pacific regional trustee, replacing Garry McAuley. *A.A. Grapevine Board:* Marne Hill, Eastern Canada regional trustee, replacing Carl Budd. We also reviewed the resume of Gregory Tobin and recommended that he serve a full term as general service trustee on the Grapevine Corporate Board, following the 1999 General Service Conference.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 1999 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1999 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Linda L. Chezem	Robert O. Miller, D.D.
Gary A. Glynn	Peter Roach
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	George E. Vaillant, M.D.
Arthur L. Knight, Jr.	

Class B

Carl Budd	Alex Palmer
Jim Clough	Beth Rabren
Marne Hill	Dean Rinehart
Jacqueline Johnston	Richard Roughton
Garry McAuley	Betty Stevens
Tom Maguire	Tony Taschner
Jack L. Ostrem	Gregory Tobin

The average delegate age is 51.1, with the oldest being 71 and the youngest 32; average length of sobriety is 15.2 years, longest 35 years and shortest 8; average length of service 13.3, with longest 34 and shortest 7 years.

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board to be presented to the 1999 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Gary A. Glynn
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	Peter Roach
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur L. Knight, Jr.
<i>Secretary</i>	Garry McAuley
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Lois Fisher*

*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, September 1999.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1999 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Jim Clough	Greg Muth
Lois Fisher*	Jack L. Ostrem
Ronald J. Gauthier	Jan Polek
Jacqueline Johnston	Richard Roughton
John C. Koster	

*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation, September 1999.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1999 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

David V. Every	Betty Stevens
Marne Hill	Ray Stiver
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	Ames Sweet
Tom Maguire	Gregory Tobin

The committee recommended approval of Burke C. Dykes to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Public Information, and David Sahatdjan to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee.

The committee discussed an alternative diversity statement to the one that was not favored by the 1998 Conference Committee on Trustees. The chairperson appointed a subcommittee to draft a new statement to bring to the October, 1998 meeting. The members were unanimous in desiring to add a diversity statement that would be inclusive, not exclusive, to the vacancy announcement letters to the Fellowship. In January, the committee recommended the following statement and forwarded it to the 1999 Conference Committee on Trustees for their review: "In seeking applicants for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

Subsequent to the Nominating Committee's discussion concerning the rotation of Class A trustees on the Grapevine Corporate Board, the chairperson reported on a discussion that she had with that board. The Grapevine Board did not recommend a set term for Class A trustees but suggested that the Nominating Committee develop a mechanism that would allow for maximum participation of Class A trustees on the Grapevine Board and that would conform to the General Service Conference schedule. The committee also requested that attention be given to maintaining continuity of service to prevent rapid turnover of Class A trustees on the Grapevine Board.

The committee recommended that a Class A trustee serve for

three successive annual terms on the Grapevine Corporate Board, with the provision that this may be extended by one additional year of service. A Class A trustee director term on the Grapevine Board would not commence before the beginning of the trustee's second year of service as a Class A trustee. This recommendation would take effect following the April 2000 General Service Conference.

Class A trustee rotation was discussed and it was noted that five of seven Class A trustees would be rotating between the years 2000 and 2001. It was the sense of the committee that the General Service Conference, through the Conference Committee on Trustees, be notified in advance of the possibility that one or more Class A trustee terms might be extended in order to stagger Class A trustee rotation dates. Pages S110 to 111 of the 1997-1998 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, under Bylaws of the General Service Board, state: "... the chairman of the General Service Board, subject to the approval of the Board, may extend the term of a Class A member trustee by one additional three-year term; ..."

The subject of Class A trustee rotation will be placed on the agenda of the joint meeting of the trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees in April 1999.

A motion was passed that the May 1999 vacancy announcement letter for Class A trustee, replacing Peter Roach, should include the traditional areas of expertise currently represented on the General Service Board: Corrections, Medicine, Clergy, Finance/Business Administration, and Social Work. The letter will indicate that a number of Class A trustees will be rotating off the board over the next few years; therefore, there will be vacancies in several areas of expertise.

The committee received a memo from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference noting they had randomly selected three additional trustee voters and one additional delegate voter to participate in the Northeast regional trustee election during the 49th General Service Conference.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D., chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the A.A. Membership Survey; carrying A.A.'s message through electronic media as well as public media.

The committee met three times since the last Conference. Much of the work of this committee was done through a subcommittee and the Public Information staff coordinator in the office. Following is a list of work over the past year:

- Following Conference approval, the four new T.V. public service announcements were made available as three separate inventory items: "Male and Information," "Female and Information" and "Young People and Information." The P.S.A.s are in 20- and 30-second spots and are available in English and Spanish. The committee encouraged local committees to stagger introduction of the new P.S.A.s over a period of time.
- Following Conference approval, TV-25 and TV-34 were removed from inventory and the following P.S.A.s were extracted from these two inventory items and incorporated into a new P.S.A. inventory item (TV-28): "B.G.'s Advice" 30-seconds, "B.G.'s Advice" 30-seconds with subtitles and "High/Low Bottom" 20- and 10-seconds.

• Following approval and implementation of the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey, the committee reviewed progress reports on the collection of survey questionnaires from groups selected by stratified random selection to participate in the Survey.

The committee also:

• Reviewed the data resulting from the 1998 Membership Survey with comparison to previous data collected in 1996, and approved a letter of appreciation to be sent to the G.S.R.s or group contacts of all the groups who participated in the 1998 Survey.

• Reviewed and approved the annual media Anonymity Letter to be mailed to media professionals (English, Spanish and French media outlets) in early February 1999.

• Reviewed P.I. expenses for 1997 and 1998, and the proposed 1999 budget of \$14,800 was forwarded to the trustees' Finance Budgetary Committee.

• Reviewed all current television and radio Public Service Announcements and the distribution summary of P.S.A.s. The Committee requested that a questionnaire developed by staff be mailed to local P.I. committees to gather shared experience on whether the P.S.A.s are being aired and to gather local experience in distributing the P.S.A.s to local broadcasting stations.

The following items were referred for consideration to the 1999 Conference P.I. Committee:

• Review of report on the A.A. Fact File.

• Approval of the draft of the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet.

• Discussion of anonymity at the public level of the Internet.

• Request from a producer for permission to use footage from the film "Bill's Own Story" in a television biography program about Bill Wilson, which would include Dr. Bob Smith.

Jack Ostrem, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, schools and G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site on the Internet. It is a crucial part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. to be a resource and central collector of sharing for Public Information Committees throughout the U.S. and Canada. Throughout the year the staff member and a staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come in from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do, and providing accurate and consistent information to the media, researchers, students and the general public about Alcoholics Anonymous.

Four times a year, the staff member communicates with over 500 P.I. committee chairpeople at the area, district, intergroup/central office and group level. All new Public Information chairpeople are sent a "welcome" letter and receive the P.I. Workbook, A.A. Guidelines on Public Information, P.I. Discount Package Order Form, Box 4-5-9, as well as current P.I. information. The one-way A.A. Membership Survey display and pamphlet is also made available to local P.I. committees.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of local health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature and participate in these events. Whenever possible, we try to connect the community resource with local P.I. committees, so that there can be a local group conscience decision about how A.A.

can best participate in these local events. The Public Information staff person made available to local P.I. committees the service piece "Suggestions for Working with Your Local Television and Radio Stations to Help Carry the Message," to encourage and help committees set up P.S.A. contacts at local TV and radio stations, in addition to the P.S.A. scripts. In July/August a letter containing information on the new television Public Service Announcements was sent to all areas and P.I. committees. A compilation copy of all the TV P.S.A.s formatted on VHS tape for VCR was made available to those interested in distributing radio and TV P.S.A.s as an aid to help committees become familiar with the content of our P.S.A.s.

When the Public Information desk receives information regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio or film, this information is forwarded to area delegates, if the area is identified, who respond to each anonymity break on a case-by-case basis. In the past twelve months, approximately 32 articles were forwarded to area delegates. Anonymity breaks on the Internet are handled in the same manner. In January, all new Conference delegates were sent a letter explaining our procedures for forwarding anonymity break information to local delegates.

The annual Anonymity Letter to Media, including a return postcard for those professionals who wish additional information about A.A., was mailed in early February to media outlets in the U.S. and Canada (English, Spanish and French) as follows: daily newspapers and wire services, 1,751; weekly newspapers, 4,285; AM/FM radio stations, 1,035; TV stations, networks, cable and wire service, 751; all black publications, 239; all Hispanic publications, 181; the total mailing was 8,242.

We responded to requests from newspaper, magazine, TV and radio professionals for information about Alcoholics Anonymous or information on subjects related to alcoholism and referred inquiries not directly related to A.A. to the appropriate source. We also reviewed movie, television and radio scripts to see that references to A.A. were accurate and in keeping with our Traditions. We declined to comment on any controversial issue in keeping with our Tenth Tradition of not entering into public controversy. Alcoholics Anonymous is unique in that Public Information succeeds when we do not get media attention. Just as the strongest Twelfth Step with the alcoholic is often the quiet power of our own sobriety, in dealing with the media, we try to present A.A. in a courteous and dignified manner. As our Eleventh Tradition reminds us: "Our public relations policy is based on attraction, rather than promotion . . ."

Extensive preparation and planning went into the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey. The staff member coordinated several mailings to delegates who, in turn, distributed Survey questionnaires to the groups who had been selected on a random scientific basis. The delegates were responsible for returning completed Survey questionnaires to the staff member in either English, French or Spanish. This information, when approved, from the participating groups becomes the basis for the 1998 A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet.

Eva Sanchez

SERVICE MATERIAL

Staff report: To assist groups, G.S.O. provides service material to the Fellowship, based on an indicated need, to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A four-page list describes the service items in detail. Examples of service material include: Regional Forum Reports; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs.

Current ongoing projects involving Service Material:

- Involved with coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Service Material/Regional Forums works closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup offices' records and lists.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.
- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. Kits.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the Fourteenth Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Sarasota, Florida, October 15-17, 1999.
- Liaison with special needs committees working to make A.A. more accessible to all alcoholics. (In 1998, the staff member corresponded with chairpersons of special needs committees three times.)

Susan Ulseth

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated. In our general service structure there are more than 40,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members. They meet in 1,500 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and interfaces with the rest of the staff assignments and assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All these groups that register with the G.S.O. in New York receive the Group Handbook, and every G.S.R. its corresponding kit in Spanish. D.C.M.s also receive their service kit in Spanish, and each group receives a copy of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added to the areas in our service structure, and continue to grow in other parts of our Conference. Many service pieces are available in Spanish, among them the General Service Board's Quarterly Report, with highlights of its activities, as well as the A.A.W.S. monthly report. The Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish is immediately available upon completion of our Conference, and a list of preliminary and final Conference Agenda items is distributed in Spanish to all delegates and alternate delegates.

The staff member on this assignment works closely with the two in-house translators, assisting, developing, updating and revising literature, pamphlets, and so on. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. All correspondence in Spanish from U.S.A./Canada comes to the Spanish Services desk and the Spanish Services coordinator also helps answer correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments, especially by the International desk. The Spanish Services staff member may attend regional meetings, such as the Meeting of the Americas, World Service Meetings, Regional Forums, and many other activities in the Spanish-speaking world of A.A.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups and members are provided through eleven staff assignments. In addition to assuming the responsibility for a functional assignment, staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, as well as with A.A.s in other countries. Staff members rotate assignments every two years; assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. The staff is divided into two units to ensure that assignments are adequately covered during absences. Unit A consists of Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, Literature and the coordinator of the International Conventions. Unit B includes coordinators of Staff, Conference, Regional Forums/Service Material, International and Spanish Services.

In 1998, G.S.O. staff received a total of 20,529 pieces of mail, and the staff coordinator sees that letters are answered when staff members are involved with large projects, A.A. events away from the office and in times of sickness and vacation. Weekly staff meetings, chaired by the staff coordinator, focus on problems that require direction from the group conscience, and more and better ways of providing service to A.A. groups and members. The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, etc. making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. She also serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments.

In 1998, approval was obtained from immigration officials to hire Bill Archer, a Canadian citizen, as a new staff member. He was interviewed for a staff position in 1997 and a decision was made then to hire Bill, pending approval from immigration authorities, to fill the vacancy created when a staff member begins work on the 2000 International Convention full-time. A minimum of six years sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Professional background, communication skills and A.A. service experience are among the criteria used in the selection process. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff.

Staff participated in a total of 100 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums in the U.S., Canada and other countries in 1998. These events provide an opportunity to communicate about G.S.O. services, to meet A.A.s throughout the world and to receive information that can be shared with other groups. In the past year, 1,330 visitors from around the world came to G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, learning about the services to the Fellowship. Often visiting members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings and also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the summary of the board's activities. The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference, and serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc. None of the activities would be possible without the assistance of a very capable support staff.

Lois Fisher

"You are a good looking bunch —especially since you're sober," observed a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee at the morning open A.A. meeting.

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: In the twelve months since the 48th General Service Conference, the Grapevine Board has met nine times to conduct the business of the A.A. Grapevine, Incorporated. Three of these meetings were Planning Committee meetings, during which board members and staff focused in-depth on specific significant matters facing the A.A. Grapevine, such as circulation, the 1999 budget, and La Viña. The board also initiated a conference call with the Conference Grapevine Committee in March, in order to get acquainted and facilitate the flow of communication between these two bodies. In July, the board had the pleasure of hosting the editor of *Plenitud*, our Mexican magazine counterpart, and one of the trustees who serves on the Board of Directors of *Plenitud*. The board also met in a special session with the chairperson of the General Service Board to discuss a letter from Grapevine management regarding the relationship between the A.A. Grapevine, A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Service Board. Grapevine Board members and staff have participated in a number of A.A. service events throughout the Fellowship in both English and Spanish and have tried to utilize these events to gain a better understanding of how we can most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship as a whole.

Finance — 1998 Results: The Grapevine ended 1998 with a loss of \$45,207. This was greater than the budgeted loss of \$10,170, but less than the actual loss in 1997 of \$79,749. Some of the reasons for the greater-than-budgeted loss were lower than budgeted circulation income and sales of the two new tapes and the annual wall calendar and pocket planner; \$10,000 of unanticipated costs related to the office reconfiguration; higher than budgeted expenses for meetings and conferences; and higher than budgeted direct costs for related items.

Magazine circulation for 1998 was budgeted at 122,000 copies per month; however, the actual circulation for the year was 117,292 copies per month. On this circulation, the Grapevine realized \$1,728,082. Gross profit on the magazine was \$27,569 below budget, but \$69,773 better than the actual gross profit on the magazine for 1997. Gross profit on related items was \$44,281 less than budget and slightly below the actual gross profit for 1997.

On the cost side, editorial costs were virtually on budget and just slightly higher than 1997. Circulation and business expenses were under budget by \$41,051. General and administrative costs were over budget by \$11,323. Combined, total costs and expenses of \$1,454,676 were \$29,378 below budget.

On a positive note, while we budgeted for a loss of \$78,352 for La Viña, the actual loss for the year was only \$66,182, which is \$12,170 less than budget and \$35,952 less than the actual loss for 1997. Management has kept costs below budget in nearly every expense category for La Viña, which has allowed the magazine to maintain a positive gross profit even with less than budgeted circulation income.

1998 Budget: The board approved a budget for 1999 that projects a loss of \$29,698 for the year. One of the principal elements of this budget is a 16% increase in postal charges based on new postal rates that went into effect January 10, 1999. The U.S. Post Office dramatically raised rates

on second class periodical mail (the category which impacts our mailing list), and some industry experts predict that small non-profit mailers like the Grapevine might be hit with anywhere from 8% to 25% rate increases. The budget also includes new shipping and handling charges for related-item orders (for orders up to \$19.99, add \$.95; for orders from \$20 to \$50, add \$1.95), and a price increase of \$1.00 on all Grapevine audiocassette tapes which will go into effect in April 1999. In addition, at the request of management, the board decided not to produce a new set of audiocassette tapes in 1999.

For La Viña, the budgeted loss for 1999 is \$69,602. This is \$2,155 less than the projected loss for 1999 forwarded by the Grapevine Corporate Board to the trustees' Finance Committee in July 1998 as part of a revised set of three-year projections, and is just slightly greater than the actual loss in 1998.

Board Structure: The board welcomed Betty Stevens to the Grapevine Corporate Board in April 1998 as the Southeast regional trustee. In January 1999, the board put forward the name of Gregory Tobin to serve as general service trustee, replacing Chuck Crist, who resigned from the General Service Board in November 1998. Chuck had served on the Grapevine Board as a nontrustee director from 1993 to 1996 and had been a general service trustee since April 1996. He served two one-year terms as chairperson of the Grapevine Board, with one term in place of Raul Marin, the Southwest regional trustee who passed away last year. Greg Tobin has served on the Grapevine's Editorial Advisory Board for four years, and was selected as a nontrustee director in April 1996. The board also forwarded the name of Marne Hill, Eastern Canada regional trustee, to replace Carl Budd upon rotation in April 1999.

Editorial Features: Over the last year, the Grapevine has published a broad range of material, including articles on the Traditions, the Steps, A.A. Around the World, and a number of special features. Three interviews were published, one with a World Service Meeting delegate from New Zealand, one with the manager of the General Service Office in Colombia, and one with Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Elaine Johnson, Ph.D. The Grapevine also published special sections on A.A. in Prison, Working with Wet Drunks, and A.A. on the Road, as well as a collection of responses from readers to an article about a member who had chosen not to attend meetings anymore. Plans are currently underway for the Grapevine's special Millennium Issue, scheduled for publication in January 2000; the deadline for receipt of material is June 1999. Throughout the year material has been requested from both young people and oldtimers, and

a special call for articles on the topic of "Sex and Sobriety" was made in the November issue.

The November issue also presented reprints from past issues and focused on the question of alcoholism as a threefold disease affecting body, mind, and spirit. The controversy over using

the Lord's Prayer in meetings surfaced again over the past year, and an archival letter from Bill W. regarding the Lord's Prayer was printed in the February issue. The

Grapevine began collecting material from each of the eight





U.S./Canada service regions for presentation over the next few years, and the first installment of this plan was printed in the March issue, which highlighted A.A. in the West Central Region. The April issue carried a special feature on A.A. in Australia and also presented a section of articles on A.A.'s singleness of purpose, with one of the articles being a reprint from a Narcotics Anonymous World Service Bulletin which discussed how that Fellowship deals with this critical issue. Also in the April issue was a readership survey which should supply some good information on how readers are exposed to the magazine, how they use it, and how it might improve.

In La Viña, while many of the special features from the Grapevine were translated and published, there were a number of original features presented in Spanish only, such as a report on an oldtimers meeting in Medellín, Colombia; a collection of articles on how A.A. got started in Latin America; an article with suggestions for starting Big Book study meetings; an ongoing collection of stories by women in A.A.; and a report on the social repercussions of alcoholism which was presented at a symposium hosted by the General Service Board of Mexico. In addition, a handbook for La Viña representatives and a translation of the Grapevine's Traditions Checklist were made available in Spanish. In July 1998, an Editorial Advisory Board was formed for La Viña, patterned after the Grapevine's advisory board. The La Viña Editorial Advisory Board has met three times since July, with at least four meetings to be scheduled over the next year. The board is made up of Spanish-speaking volunteer A.A. members with professional expertise in the areas of translation, publishing, and communications. The board serves in an advisory capacity to the executive editor and the editor of Spanish Resources and considers matters related to the editorial content, graphics, and distribution of La Viña.

New Items: In June, Volume 3 of *Best of the Grapevine* was published, followed in September by publication of two audiocassette tapes: "Youth Enjoying Sobriety" and "Old-Timers Corner." These items were produced at the suggestion of the 1996 Conference Grapevine Committee.

International Publishing: A number of requests to reprint Grapevine materials were received throughout the year, and permission was granted to the German General Service Office to translate and publish Volume 1 of *Best of the Grapevine*. The General Service Board of Italy inquired about permission to translate *The Language of the Heart* as did the General Service Board of Guatemala. Another request was received from an A.A. member who is working with two missionaries in Malawi, Africa

to carry the A.A. message there. His request was for permission to translate an article from the April 1998 Grapevine into Chi-Chewa or Chi-Tumbuka, the language of the villages of Malawi. The article is titled "Something Revolutionary" and is about a young man's recovery in Nairobi, Kenya. The board has also received a request from *La Vigne*, the A.A. magazine of French-speaking Canada, for permission to translate and publish a number of Grapevine audiocassette tapes. This request will be considered by the board later in the year.

In June 1998, the Grapevine's executive editor sent a letter to the editors of A.A. magazines around the world requesting any material they might like to contribute for the Grapevine's International edition in January of 1999, and offering to help establish a communications network between these A.A. magazines so that information and experience could be shared and exchanged. Four of the magazines responded with material which was published in the January issue and another magazine, which had been out of publication for a number of years, responded with questions about how it might get started once again. Some of the Spanish-speaking A.A. magazines around the world have also solicited the Grapevine for information and this has provided management with a wonderful opportunity to share its experience, strength and hope internationally.

Canadian Circulation and Pricing: Starting in April 1998, the Grapevine Board indicated that one of its priorities for the year would be to address the problem of declining circulation and sales in Canada. To this end, management reduced the discount level for Canadian related-item orders and began to study the question of magazine pricing. A survey and special renewal offer was sent out to former subscribers in Canada and based on the information collected, the board voted to approve a new pricing plan for Canada, which allows for one consolidated price combining postage, handling, and G.S.T. The new consolidated price in U.S. funds for Canadian subscribers will be \$19 for one year; \$36 for two years; and \$52 for three years. The Grapevine will also accept payment in Canadian funds (at the U.S. equivalent), and will simplify the bulk pricing scheme to encourage group subscriptions.

French Publications: In February 1999, the Grapevine's license with the French Publications Service expired to publish the French-language editions of *The Language of the Heart*, *The Best of Bill*, and *The Home Group*. All rights reverted to the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and we will now work with A.A.W.S. and the newly-formed S.M.A.A. Corporation regarding the sale and distribution of these items.

Grapevine Web site: The Grapevine Web site has been up and running since March 1998, and so far has shown promising signs as a means of communication between the Grapevine and the Fellowship. Based on statistics provided by the internet server, in December 1998 the web site was accessed 20,411 times. Between August and January there were 103,471 hits—an average of 559 hits per day. Visitors to the web site came from over 71 different countries, with the highest concentration from Canada, the United States, Australia, England, Finland, Iceland, Poland, Mexico and New Zealand. The most-frequently accessed web site pages were the Special Item of the Month, the Highlights from Upcoming Issues, the information on the Serenity Prayer and the Preamble, the Order/Subscription page, and the Calendar of Events. The La Viña pages were also accessed 895 times over the same six-month period, averaging five hits a day.

Grapevine Office: To fill the position left vacant by the early retirement of Bob Scherer in November 1997, in June Bob Slotterback was promoted to the position of controller, responsible for Grapevine's financial planning and controls, budgeting and cash management, accounting and financial reporting. Bob has been at the Grapevine since 1991 and was serving as the assistant controller.

Also in June, the final conversion to a new circulation program on the AS-400 computer for both the Grapevine and La Viña took place (with the assistance of the A.A.W.S. Information Services manager, Lillianna Murphy). This was the culmination of a long-standing project and will allow for more flexibility and greater control of all circulation records.

Over the summer, management arranged for a viewing for all Grapevine employees of the new Conference-approved video, "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure." Overall, comments were positive, and since so many of the Grapevine employees are nonalcoholics and unfamiliar with the service structure, there was considerable interest in the material shot outside the office which showed an A.A. meeting and an area assembly.

In January, the office reconfiguration was completed and employees began to utilize the additional office space which was created. Throughout the year, management has been holding monthly employee meetings and as part of this effort, two staff surveys have been circulated to all employees. A number of changes in office procedures have come about as a result, and Grapevine management is in the process of reorganizing the circulation and bookkeeping departments. The goal is to create one unified order department which will be responsible for the processing of all orders, both subscriptions and related items, and an accounting/audit department which will be responsible for all accounting and fiscal reporting. This reorganization is an effort to improve the office's ability to process all orders promptly and efficiently and provide a better level of customer service to the Fellowship.

Service Activity: The Grapevine has participated in five Regional Forums in the last year: the Western Canada Forum in Winnipeg, Manitoba; the Pacific Forum in Sacramento, California; a West Central Special Forum in Helena and Miles City, Montana; the Eastern Canada Forum in St. John's, Newfoundland; and the Southeast Forum in Daytona Beach, Florida. The Grapevine also participated in the 13th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar in San Mateo, California along with representatives from the General Service Office and A.A.W.S.

Other Board Business: In June, the board voted to forward financial projections for bimonthly publication of La Viña to the trustees' Finance Committee; communicated with an area in Canada regarding their request for audiocassettes in French; declined to pursue a request to make Grapevine archival material available on CD-ROM. In July, the board discussed the report of an ad-hoc board subcommittee and decided that there was no current need to schedule a formal board retreat. In October, the board forwarded a number of items to the 1999 Conference Grapevine Committee for their evaluation at the 49th General Service Conference; declined a suggestion that the board reconsider its 1995 decision to discontinue the "Mini-Grapevine." In January, the board welcomed 1999 Conference Grapevine Committee chairperson Sallye Hernandez, from Area 8, San Diego/Imperial, along with a number of other delegate chairs, and reviewed the 1998 year-end numbers and 1999 budgets for Grapevine and La Viña. The board also reviewed the recent effort by an area in the Northeast Region which resulted in a large number of subscriptions to the Grapevine and La Viña which will be designated for correctional and treatment facilities throughout the area. In addition, over \$3,500 worth of back issues of the two magazines were ordered for distribution to over 40 correctional facilities. This effort was adopted by the entire area assembly and provided a meaningful way of using excess area funds to carry the message.

Carl Budd, chairperson

Staff report: In June 1999, the A.A. Grapevine will celebrate 55 years of continuous publication. The Grapevine is entirely self-supporting through the sale of the magazine and related materials. Its primary mission is to publish "the international monthly journal of Alcoholics Anonymous," a magazine that shares the experience, strength and hope of a wide variety of A.A. members in the U.S. and Canada and around the world, and expresses current thinking in the Fellowship on matters affecting recovery, unity, and



service. In addition, the Grapevine publishes anthologies and audiocassette tapes based directly on the magazine. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is an autonomous corporation whose executive editor has oversight responsibility as chief executive and who reports directly to the Grapevine Corporate Board. There are four major areas of operations: editorial, circulation, accounting/bookkeeping, and shipping.

The editorial department, managed by the executive editor, consists of a senior editor, Spanish resources editor, executive secretary, editorial assistant, and part-time art director. The department produces the monthly Grapevine magazine, the bimonthly Spanish-language magazine *La Viña*, all related materials (anthologies, audiocassette tapes, etc.), flyers and order forms, and related GvR materials, pamphlets and workbooks about the Grapevine, and the annual wall calendar and pocket planner. Virtually all materials are designed in-house, using the Grapevine's desktop publishing capability. The department also answers all editorial queries and processes several hundred manuscript submissions every month. The year 1998 saw the publication of *The Best of the Grapevine III* and the production of a set of audiocassette tapes, "Youth Enjoying Sobriety" and "Old-Timers Corner."

A nonalcoholic controller manages accounting, bookkeeping, and financial functions. The bookkeeping department opens and distributes all incoming mail. Manuscripts, letters to the editor, calendar of events items, reprint requests, and matters requiring the editors' attention go to the editorial department. Both cash and credit card orders, for subscriptions and related materials, are sorted into categories for processing. The administrative unit of bookkeeping maintains employee payroll and administers employee benefit programs. The controller, as part of this unit, is responsible for the safeguarding of all corporate assets. He maintains control over all books of accounts, prepares statements of financial operations, and prepares the annual budgets.

The circulation department processes new and renewal orders for both the Grapevine and *La Viña* and provides customer service for subscribers. It is responsible for keeping subscription information up to date and producing the monthly and bimonthly mailing labels and renewal reminders for subscribers. In addition, the circulation director maintains and develops programs to increase readership and interest in our publications, and coordinates the GvR network throughout the Fellowship.

The shipping department arranges for inventory transfers to and from warehouse distribution centers in Kansas City, Kansas, and Oakville, Ontario, Canada. It also ships and packs smaller orders of books, tapes, magazines, and other materials from the office, including complimentary materials to GvRs.

Concerning *La Viña*: Although a few areas and states have no subscriptions at all, *La Viña*'s circulation is at approximately 8,000 copies, with ten percent of the subscriptions coming from outside the U.S. and Canada. Another ten percent comes from a single large order placed by a Hospital and Institutions Committee in Southern California. *La Viña* now attracts so much original Spanish-language material that the majority of the magazine is original material, not translated from the English-language magazine.

The Grapevine Web site continues to be a productive way for the magazine to reach new audiences. Created and maintained by the editorial department, in cooperation with a Web site designer/consultant, it offers highlights of the upcoming issue, encourages correspondence and manuscript submission (via hard copy or e-mail), gives news of related materials, and offers ordering and subscription information about both the Grapevine and *La Viña*. The Web site address is: www.aagrapevine.org

Cynthia Keyworth, senior editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1999	APRIL 1998	
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	1,122	1,176	— 54
Alaska	547	626	— 79
Arizona	1,711	1,732	— 21
Arkansas	664	641	23
California	12,209	11,496	713
Colorado	1,763	1,789	— 26
Connecticut	1,893	1,987	— 94
Delaware	431	464	— 33
District of Columbia	231	234	— 3
Florida	5,635	5,978	— 343
Georgia	2,583	2,625	— 42
Hawaii	521	539	— 18
Idaho	631	575	56
Illinois	4,393	4,565	— 172
Indiana	1,625	1,748	— 123
Iowa	1,348	1,381	— 33
Kansas	1,393	1,436	— 43
Kentucky	1,009	1,032	— 23
Louisiana	1,040	1,132	— 92
Maine	722	756	— 34
Maryland	1,537	1,630	— 93
Massachusetts	3,301	3,467	— 166
Michigan	3,604	3,656	— 52
Minnesota	2,712	2,831	— 119
Mississippi	699	720	— 21
Missouri	1,928	1,978	— 50
Montana	641	616	25
Nebraska	1,088	1,094	— 6
Nevada	724	685	39
New Hampshire	767	753	14
New Jersey	2,976	3,023	— 47
New Mexico	697	649	48
New York	6,974	7,345	— 371
North Carolina	2,621	2,711	— 90
North Dakota	437	427	10
Ohio	3,320	3,329	— 9
Oklahoma	1,267	1,327	— 60
Oregon	1,420	1,364	56
Pennsylvania	4,902	5,009	— 107
Rhode Island	453	454	— 1
South Carolina	1,154	1,247	— 93
South Dakota	402	446	— 44
Tennessee	1,465	1,475	— 10
Texas	4,943	5,085	— 142
Utah	622	610	12
Vermont	413	378	35
Virginia	2,396	2,486	— 90
Washington	3,171	3,251	— 80
West Virginia	471	455	16
Wisconsin	2,712	2,827	— 115
Wyoming	328	304	24
Puerto Rico	55	68	— 13
U.S. Possessions	22	82	— 60
Subtotal U.S.	101,693	103,694	— 2001
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	957	979	— 22
British Columbia/Ykn	1,057	1,289	— 232
Manitoba	382	437	— 55
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	354	346	8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	496	591	— 95
Ontario	3,083	3,288	— 205
Quebec	217	269	— 52
Saskatchewan	471	575	— 104
Subtotal Canada	7,017	7,774	— 757
FOREIGN	1,686	1,628	58
Grand Total*	110,396	113,096	— 2,700

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Literature Distributed - 1998

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	405,466
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	349,562
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	19,076
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	93,724
Daily Reflections	115,093
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	165,197
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	16,677
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	137,273
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	8,343
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	42,611
A.A. Comes of Age	10,336
As Bill Sees It	40,977
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	20,317
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	10,545
"Pass It On"	10,619
Total	1,445,816

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	31,032
Living Sober	141,905
Came to Believe	76,615
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	23,940
Total	273,492

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	9,312
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	26,637
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	35,441
A.A. for the Native North American	16,469
A.A. for the Woman	116,583
The A.A. Group	89,140
A.A. in Your Community	53,664
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	21,853
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	31,353
The A.A. Membership Survey	63,483
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	102,936
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	33,323
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	13,008
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	118,522
Circles of Love and Service	36,607
Bridging the Gap	27,728
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	23,396
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	19,540
Do You Think You're Different?	130,938
44 Questions	253,382
G.S.R.	44,559
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	15,751
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,590
How It Works	64,324
If You Are a Professional	34,523
Inside A.A.	44,520
Is A.A. for You?	348,138
Is A.A. for Me?	105,900
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	18,138
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	91,760
It Happened to Alice	55,968
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	55,176
The Jack Alexander Article	30,504
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	13,953

Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	90,603
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	64,538
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	41,388
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	7,971
A Newcomer Asks	290,434
Problems Other Than Alcohol	112,315
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	260,685
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,653
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	20,517
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	88,710
Twelve Tradition Flyer	7,353
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	56,656
This Is A.A.	273,337
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	19,849
Time to Start Living	65,699
Time to Start Living (large print)	6,978
Too Young?	97,823
Understanding Anonymity	62,686
What Happened to Joe	59,520
Young People and A.A.	129,315

Total 3,938,149

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	444,186
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	50,440
Wallet cards-Anonymity	41,620
Anonymity Display Card	2,994
Parchment-scrolls	3,032
Placards	324
C.P.C. Workbook	1,528
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,429
P.I. Workbook	1,840
Treatment Facilities Workbook	333
Treatment Facility Handbook	1,123
Big Book on computer disk	1,113
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	887
A.A. Guidelines	71,614
Group Handbook	2,515
Wire Racks	1,847
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	2,092
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	5,136
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	443
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,188
TV Public Service Announcement	552
Radio Public Service Announcements	346
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,005
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,819
Fact Files	2,563
Table Top Display 12 & 12	538

Total 645,100

Grand Total 6,302,557

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	22,501
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	5,305
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	3,842

Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,208
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,883
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,587
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	4,594
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	7,539
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	14,260
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	2,516
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	20,516
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	8,738
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,502
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	3,809
Total	109,800

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,608
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	29,592
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	25,047
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	52,449
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	6,465
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,432
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,584
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	5,010
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	4,404
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,255
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	13,243
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	9,391
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	10,350
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	4,197
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	9,924
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	11,653
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	6,339
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	6,357
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	3,547
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	14,125
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	1,973
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	8,618
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	4,261
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	11,797
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	6,620
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,287
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,345
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,347
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	

(The Clergy Asks)	1,773
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,171
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	10,633
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,654
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	2,648
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	9,817
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,430
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	1,845
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	10,130
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	3,933
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	8,710
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	2,923
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,593
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,143
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,124
Total	345,747

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,402
Parchments, Spanish	574
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	27,662
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	550
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	733
Total	37,921
Gran Total	493,468

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	4,123
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	2,656
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	1,667
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,284
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	1,655
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	1,004
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	506
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	1,973
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,638
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	758
Total	19,264

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,616
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,635
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,928
Total	7,179

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	11,926
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	2,160
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	15,010
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,228
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	478
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	1,089
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,047
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	301
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	444
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	1,802
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	814
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	275
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,004
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	635
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	454
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	449
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	2,085
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	1,838
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	564
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,486
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	218
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	538
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,016
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	176
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	254
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	940
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	303
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,872
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,005
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	126
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	510
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	942
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,383

Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	964
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,495
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,248
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	225
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,256
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	791
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	713
Sondage de 1992 sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	791
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,179
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	2,620
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	771
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	4,180
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,055
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	270
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,398
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	312
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	222
Total	71,242

Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total	2,229
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Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	57
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	52
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	1,647
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	76
Cassettes	65
Notre Methode (How It Works)	13,508
Manuel de Groupe	77
Manuel de l'Information Publique	16
Manuel des Centres de Detention	11
Manuel de la CMP	5
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio P.S.A.)	3
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	14,652
Slogans (serie de 5) (Five A.A. Slogans)	236
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	5
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	606
Total	31,016
Grand Total	130,930



Area Service Highlights

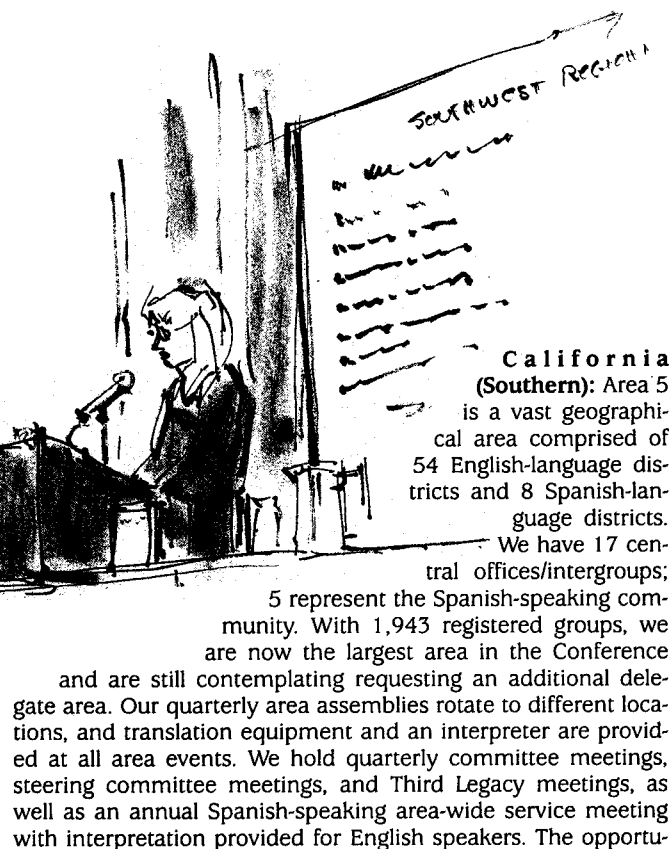
Alabama/NW Florida: Area 1 has 401 registered groups serving 23 districts; 17 districts are located in Alabama and six in the NW Florida Panhandle. We were privileged to host the 54th SE Conference in Mobile, in 1998—the first time in 25 years! Area assemblies meet quarterly with workshop topics based on the current Conference theme and Conference workshop topics. A couple of districts have developed a Web page, and others are pursuing with interest and concern—a careful approach has been suggested. Each year our assembly meets prior to Conference with special input to the delegate so that individuals as well as committees are informed and can express their concerns and opinions on agenda items to the delegate. Area 1 attempts to get more A.A. members committed to service by emphasizing our need to move forward in unity through humility while continuing to carry the A.A. message of recovery so that it will be available to the still-suffering alcoholic, as well as those yet to come. — *Janiece Rydell*

Arkansas: Area 4 serves 12 districts, with 248 groups presently registered. Our quarterly assemblies are held in the center of the state. The weekend begins with a learning session where past/present delegates share their experience regarding a Tradition and a Concept. We invite a guest for our Saturday night speaker meeting, usually from another state. Sunday includes all committee reports and the assembly's business meeting. The Convention Committee is preparing for the Arkansas State Convention, held each August in Mt. View, Arkansas. Our Archives is one of the best (so we are told); the Treatment Committee has printed "Bridging the Gap" pamphlets in bulk; each D.C.M. has received copies so that each group may participate in this program. Our Grapevine chair conducts a slide presentation and travels to many convention sites throughout the state. We continue our work with the Corrections, C.P.C. and P.I. committees. Our Group Relations and Convention Committees are chaired by past delegates; we're grateful for them and appreciate their continued interest and service to Area 4, Arkansas. — *Sandy Luetjen*

British Columbia/Yukon: We have 750 groups, 47 districts, and approximately 13,000 members. Our steering committee meets on a monthly basis, and four times a year with the D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. We have an active service membership and attendance at our quarterlies and assemblies ranges from 250 to 300. Our area archives and Grapevine display is invited to many of the roundups and rallies, and our C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Corrections committees are active helping districts create their

own committees in each of these vital areas. Our Web page has been running for 3 years and we are impressed with this powerful communication tool. It now includes approximately 1/3 of the districts with A.A. contacts, meeting lists and upcoming events. In lieu of our annual convention we are hosting the Pacific Northwest Conference in July this year. The year 2000 convention will be held in Revelstoke. The members in our area are maturing and discovering service work to be a very important part of their recovery. It is a privilege to serve this great area as their delegate to the General Service Conference. — *Grace Edwards*

California (Northern Coastal): Area 6 has approximately 64,000 recovering alcoholics, in approximately 2,000 groups, in our 22 districts and 175 subdistricts. The delegate or one of the seven other elected area officers visits each district meeting each month, driving 50,000 miles a year to do so. Four of these districts are linguistic, and we can translate, by computer, our printed material from English to Spanish. We use simultaneous translation equipment during our monthly area committee meeting and the four annual assemblies. Within our geographic boundaries, there are 21 intergroups and central offices; five serve the Spanish community. An autonomous Hospitals & Institutions committee, which began work in 1942 at San Quentin Prison, handles treatment and correctional facilities duties. CNCA has standing committees for P.I./C.P.C., Archives, Bridging the Gap and Finance; we offer district commitments for publishing our newsletter, *CNCA Comments*, and for making coffee for the area committee and subcommittee meetings. We struggle with the trendy—university organ transplant programs requiring proof of attendance at A.A. meetings—and how best to help our G.S.R.s. It is our purpose to share the joy of participation in general service with as many of the groups within our area as possible. — *Nancy Haynes*



California (Southern): Area 5 is a vast geographical area comprised of 54 English-language districts and 8 Spanish-language districts. We have 17 central offices/intergroups; 5 represent the Spanish-speaking community. With 1,943 registered groups, we are now the largest area in the Conference and are still contemplating requesting an additional delegate area. Our quarterly area assemblies rotate to different locations, and translation equipment and an interpreter are provided at all area events. We hold quarterly committee meetings, steering committee meetings, and Third Legacy meetings, as well as an annual Spanish-speaking area-wide service meeting with interpretation provided for English speakers. The opportu-



nities for service are many. No matter what the problem the solution seems to be communication, action and a faith in a power greater than ourselves. We look forward to hosting the Pacific Regional Forum in 2000. I owe A.A. my life and A.A. World Services a debt I cannot begin to repay. — *Marita Hagen*

Colorado: Recently Area 10 has added a Literature committee, on an experimental basis, to its already well-functioning standing committee roster. The committee structure includes Archives, C.P.C., Corrections, Grapevine, P.I., Treatment Facilities, three State Convention committees, our High Country Newsletter editor, and a record coordinator. The area hosts an estimated 15,000 members in some 630 groups. About 150 G.S.R.s, 60 or so D.C.M.s, committee chairpersons and area officers meet three times a year for assembly weekends. In addition to the area assemblies, the area also oversees the operation of our Annual State Convention, usually held over Labor Day weekend in various locations around the state. The members of Colorado A.A. also enjoy the opportunity to attend numerous regional conventions, workshops and festivals sponsored by local A.A. communities. Area 10 recently split one district to create a new one, that 34th. All districts are geographical sections of the area, with the exception of District 25, which is our Spanish district and covers the entire state. — *Don Miller*

Connecticut: Area 11 celebrates its 60th anniversary this May. The Greenwich Group, founded when A.A. had scarcely 100 members, brought recovery to Connecticut as the first Big Books were falling off the press. Today, with over 1,400 groups and 34,000 members, our area is still growing, comprised of one Hispanic and nine geographic districts. Our area and district committees meet every month. We have one pre-Conference and two regular assemblies. Our 13 service committees are very

active; our Schedules committee distributes meeting books free of charge to members, while our area Web site publishes up-to-date meeting and answering service information. P.I. holds monthly A.A. meetings on public radio while Corrections and Treatment expand "Bridging the Gap." Archives displays its ample collection for any A.A. gathering. This year Area 11 will host its 41st annual Convention, 25th Service Roundup, and 9th outdoor "Soberfest." Our Gay/Lesbian/Bisexual and Young Peoples Groups will also hold their annual conventions. There is a wonderful sense of unity among our area officers, all of whom have served together in various capacities for nine or more years. With love and gratitude in service. — *Jamie Rude*

District of Columbia: Area 13 is comprised of Washington, D.C., and two high-density Maryland suburbs: Montgomery and Prince Georges Counties. Although the area is small geographically, it supports over 2,000 meetings per week, day and night, from the halls of Congress to inner city neighborhoods. The General Service Assembly and the Washington Area Intergroup have a close working relationship, supporting and sharing several service committees. Our area committee meets monthly and conducts three assemblies a year, which are the nerve centers for service projects of our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. We conduct an annual mini-Conference, where area members discuss topics and agenda items of the annual Conference. Also the assembly sponsors an Annual Gratitude Breakfast. The area, being the nation's capital, holds numerous conferences and conventions at which our area C.P.C. and P.I. committees are asked to participate. We have a large Hispanic membership comprising three districts supporting D.C., Maryland and Virginia. During the past year the assembly and Hispanic community jointly purchased simultaneous translation equipment for area functions. We will be hosting NERAASA 2000. I am

grateful to serve my area and give back what was given to me in my journey of sobriety. — *Earl Knowles*

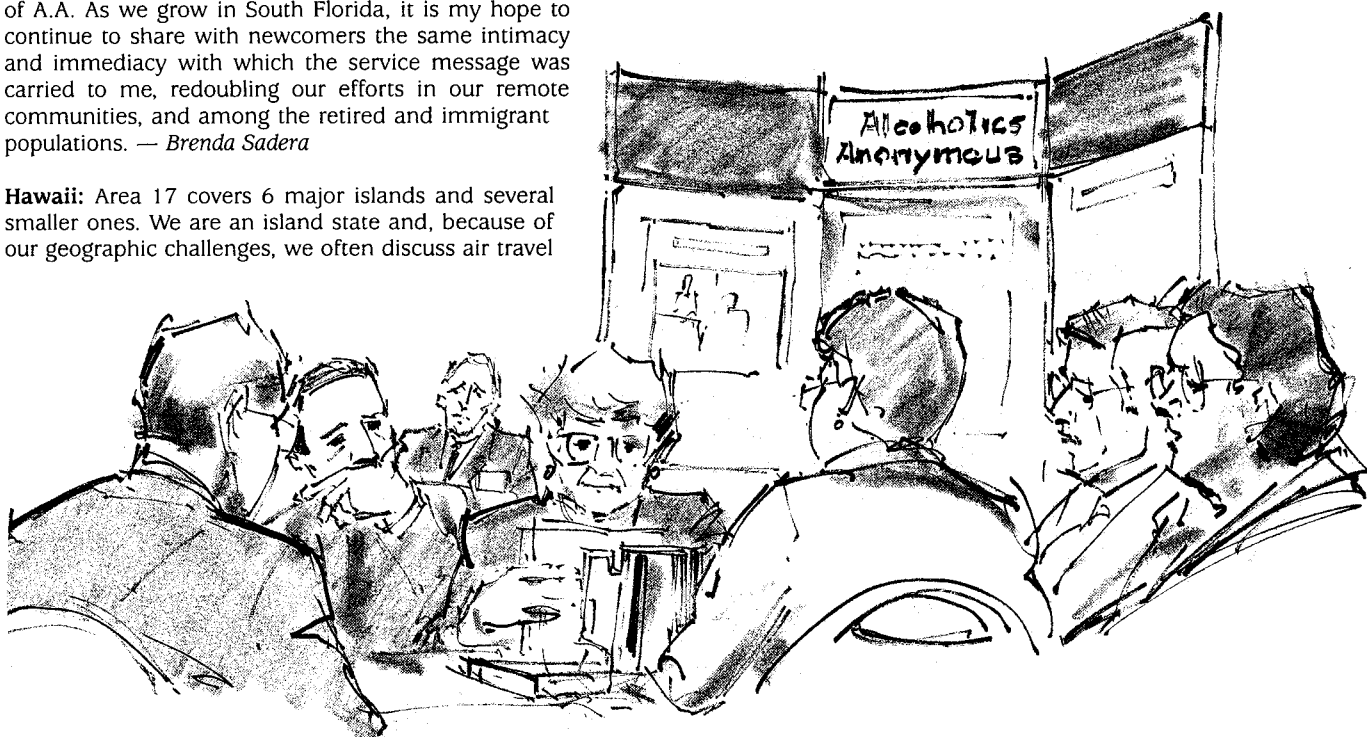
Florida (North): Area 14 has 35 D.C.M.s that represent 31 districts and 700 registered groups. We hold four assemblies a year. We hold a G.S.R. orientation session at each assembly and in January we have a D.C.M. orientation. D.C.M.s serve on an Administrative Committee for two years. They are randomly chosen and serve on either the Growth, Finance, or Site Committees. Our April assembly is our mini-Conference. Each corresponding North Florida Committee reviews the same agenda items as our delegate does at the Conference, and a group conscience is reached on each item. This method has increased the assembly's participation and interest in the delegate report after Conference. At our assemblies we have the "Ask the Officer's Forum." All G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s may ask questions of the committee chairs and the North Florida officers and delegate. We modeled this after the Regional Forums and it has really caught on as a good sharing session. Our Archives has grown and we are cataloging our inventory. We are constantly striving to increase interest and enthusiasm of our G.S.R.s, as well as workshops to provide all our districts with all the information they need to carry the message to the alcoholic who is still suffering in their local community. — *Kathy Peek*

Florida (South)/Bahamas/Virgin Islands: Area 15 has an estimated 2,300 groups of which 1,599 are registered with New York and 1,032 have G.S.R.s. We have 16 districts, having last year welcomed our Hispanic district which is thriving and in the process of purchasing its own interpreting equipment. An Accessabilities Committee has been added to our seven existing standing committees and they are studying ways to fund sign language for our business meetings. We hold quarterly business meetings in conjunction with a weekend of workshops, with close to 550 attendees. We have several heavily populated districts, as well as smaller districts that cover greater territory. Through our service committees I have participated in the work of A.A. As we grow in South Florida, it is my hope to continue to share with newcomers the same intimacy and immediacy with which the service message was carried to me, redoubling our efforts in our remote communities, and among the retired and immigrant populations. — *Brenda Sadera*

Hawaii: Area 17 covers 6 major islands and several smaller ones. We are an island state and, because of our geographic challenges, we often discuss air travel

costs, which led to a discussion to reduce the number of assemblies held each year. Yet, at this past January assembly we voted to continue having four assemblies a year. We've discussed the importance to reach alcoholics with special needs. We are in our second year of utilizing a Finance committee and things are going pretty smoothly as far as budget discussions go. We had our second Orientation Assembly in January, which was a wonderful success; people were fired up to do service and we educated the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s via round robin tables to the different standing committees. We are discussing getting an area Web site and displaying our newsletter the "Mynah Bird" on the Internet. Our neighbor islands are increasing their participation with our area assemblies and doing a good job in their standing committee work in their districts. This year PRAASA is being held in Kona, on the Island of Hawaii, and you would not believe the interest this spark has ignited in the Fellowship of the Hawaii Area. Overall we are doing well in Hawaii. — *Scott Castillo*

Illinois (Chicago): The Chicago general service area has the unique challenge of being both a general service area and a central office, all under the same service structure. Our service office serves over 3,800 groups in the area and answers hundreds of Twelfth Step related phone calls a month. We are in the process of evaluating our present district boundaries so that we may better serve the groups in our area. We are working on building a better relationship with the Spanish district and the Spanish intergroups. We have upgraded our computer hardware and software, which has allowed us to service our groups more effectively. The All Chicago Open, a three-speaker open meeting put on for the groups, is rich in Chicago A.A. tradition. It attracts over 12,000 people every year. Our Special Needs committee has worked very hard to reach out to the deaf community in A.A. and has helped to facilitate the placement of signers at meetings. The rest of our area's standing committees, P.I., Corrections, Hospitals and Treatment Facilities, C.P.C., and Grapevine, all work to insure that requests for assistance or help with the A.A. program are answered by a responsible



member of one of these committees who will carry A.A.'s message of love and service. We are delighted to be hosting the Illinois State Convention this year. — *Bill Noonan*

Illinois (Southern): We have spent a lot of time sorting out an area budget and a prudent reserve. While this has been unavoidable and necessary, it may have diverted some of our attention from personal contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. Visiting Treatment and Corrections Facilities should not be left to the few. Southern Illinois has a large prison population that I believe could be better served by more people than by just more books. I have attended prison meetings for over six years, and sometimes wonder why. A friend who is employed in Corrections and is a relative newcomer to A.A. helped cast some light on "why." She said "After all, most of these people are going to get out someday." Whether they embrace A.A. and come to us upon their release or just pick up a little something that may effect a change in their lives is part of why. The other part is that by reaching out, my own sobriety is enriched and guaranteed, one day at a time. Our area service structure is pretty solid, with good participation by past delegates and many other dedicated people, but our assembly attendance has not grown in spite of the fact that quite a few new groups have appeared. Attracting more service participation with the 1999 Conference theme of "Unity Through Humility" should be our goal. — *Dick Martin*

Indiana (Northern): Being just over 10 years old as a separate area structure, it is time to look at some of the changes that have occurred. We voted to put all of our 48 district numbers in the hat and draw them out and have those D.C.M.s and alternates to serve on our 10 standing committees. Our treatment committee opened the door to another meeting in a facility; the corrections committee attended the Bridge Gap Conference. Archives is bubbling with enthusiasm and looking forward to the next archives workshop. They are working on our area history and the preservation and conservation of materials. Preparations are being made to display large portions of them at our state convention in March 1999. I believe our area will change as we continue growing, by learning to communicate more closely with each other in our various districts, along with communicating with the various intergroups and central service offices. There is a seeming lack of sponsorship into service work and the need to improve along these lines. This will help in our primary purpose of carrying our message of recovery through the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions

and Twelve Concepts. All our efforts in Area 22 are based on the spiritual principle entwined in the triangular circle of recovery, service and unity. — *Bob Peden*

Iowa: Area 24 has 21 districts, approximately 650 groups and an active membership of 12,190. The area committee meets three times a year and has two, two-day assemblies annually. We also have a service workshop in March to allow groups and group representatives input on Conference agenda items. The alternate delegate has a vital role updating group information and area directory and chairing the G.S.R. sharing sessions at assembly meetings. Our P.I., C.P.C., GV, Literature, Newsletter, and Archives committees are very active and we have a permanent and traveling archives display. We are looking forward to hosting the West Central Regional Service Conference in the year 2000. Area 24 continues searching for better ways to carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholics. — *John Zinn*

Louisiana: Area 27 has approximately 500 registered groups spanning 30 districts. We host an annual State Convention and at least 12 other local area conventions, and many other A.A. events and functions. Our assembly meets quarterly and has eleven active committees, including the most recent addition of an area Web site committee. With attractive portable displays these committees constantly play an active role in carrying our message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Mirroring the Conference Committee structure, each of our D.C.M.s is assigned to serve on a committee. We have separate G.S.R. and D.C.M. Sharing Sessions to improve communication and unity between groups and districts. Our Orientation meeting is chaired on a rotating basis by our past delegates. Our alternate delegate traveled widely the last two years, chairing a workshop about Twelfth-Stepping the wet drunk. Our greatest concern is the challenge of attracting increased participation of the groups. The city of Lafayette will be host to the S.E. Conference in the year 2000, in conjunction with the Cajun Country Conference, and we hope to see you all there as we "laissez les bon temps rouler!" ("let the good times roll!"). — *Nikki DeFelice*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Area 30 has over 2,000 groups/meetings and about 1,700 are registered with G.S.O. These groups are served by 26 geographical district committees and by two nongeographical Spanish districts. Our area includes seven Conference Committees: P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections, Literature, Grapevine, and Archives. In addition, our area stand-



ing committees are area registrar, area newsletter, and service seminars. Our State Convention is a cooperative effort with Western Mass. G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s can attend five annual assemblies (one day each) in various locations. Meetings of the district, conference, and area committees are held monthly. Six central office/intergroups serve our groups, including one Spanish intergroup. A continuing goal and challenge is to inform A.A. members about our service activity, and to attract and involve them in our Twelfth-Step work. In this regard, some progress has been made in reaching our Spanish-speaking A.A. members. — *Bob Sweeney*



Michigan (Central): Area 32 covers the eastern half of Michigan's lower peninsula less the greater Detroit area. We have 14 districts and approximately 575 groups. Our area assembly meets monthly and rotates throughout our districts. Our Literature committee serves as a traveling sales outlet for Conference-approved literature as a convenience for our membership, especially in rural areas. In March each year, we hold a mock Conference in conjunction with Areas 33 and 34 in preparation for the General Service Conference in April. In August this year, we will host the 47th Michigan State Convention and the 21st East Central Regional Service Conference. In September the East Central Regional Forum will be in Ann Arbor. We meet quarterly with Areas 33 and 34 in support of statewide Corrections Facilities and Grapevine committees to better coordinate these service functions. My goal as delegate is to increase the awareness of unity and service in our quest to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic. I have felt that A.A. can become isolated and turn inward in its quest for recovery, causing it to ignore the Traditions and the longer term goals of the Fellowship. This increases the importance of unity and service to safeguard our Traditions, especially in our rural areas. — *Murray Cameron*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33 includes 24 districts spanning five counties. Assembly and committees meet monthly at a central location. We maintain office space that houses the archives, records, and equipment, in Detroit. Three intergroup offices, along with a fourth developing in a permanent location, and two northern districts maintain six hotline numbers, assuring the presence of A.A. throughout Michigan. Yearly we hold four G.S.R. schools, two area workshops, and an annual March Roundup held in conjunction with the Michigan State Conference every third year. The area meets with Western and Central Michigan quarterly and jointly sponsors a Statewide Mock Conference late in March, simulating the annual General Service Conference. It offers an educational venue for A.A.s to communicate their views on agenda items to Michigan's delegates. We have an area Web site, that will both serve the newcomer and facilitate committee work. Past delegates and officers give their experience and support. The diversity inherent in Area 33 has proved a special gift, enhancing our work with a love and respect deeply rooted in our common bond. — *Laura Hummel*

Minnesota (Southern): We have over 1,000 registered groups and 26 districts (22 are active). Our 11 committees meet four times a year before the area committee meeting. We have three

one-day assemblies and one two-day service conference yearly, and our officers meet monthly. Our alternate delegate serves as chair of the Structure committee, which is responsible for how we function and communicate. Our alternate area chair is chair of the Finance committee, custodians of our financial policy and the Seventh Tradition. Our service conference is devoted to the General Service Conference agenda items and topics with full participation from the Fellowship. The officers have

made a commitment to contact the committee chairs and D.C.M.s on a monthly basis to help with the lines of communication. Better communication is the goal of our service structure for the coming year. — *Bonnie McConnell*

Missouri (Eastern): Area 38 has 566 active groups, about half of which immediately surround the St. Louis metropolitan area, with the remainder in rural parts of the state. The area service structure parallels the Conference committees. All committee chairmen are appointed by the area chair with the concurrence of the area assembly. The area conducts three single-day and one two-day assemblies per year. In conjunction with the Western Area of Missouri, we hold an annual convention. The area and convention are well-funded and self-supporting. We have an area office staffed part-time by a secretary who has organized the area's records to interface with those of G.S.O. Highlights for the past year have included the return to active participation in the service structure of one of the area's most rural and previously inactive districts and the conducting of an area-wide Corrections workshop. The Corrections workshop was helped by the participation of the G.S.O. staff coordinator for corrections and was attended by many corrections professionals in the state. An area ad-hoc committee was formed to investigate an area Web site. — *Clayton Vandivort*

Missouri (Western): Each year Western Missouri joins with Eastern Missouri to co-host the State Convention. This year's theme reflects the Conference theme, "Moving Forward: Unity through Humility." In the interest of unity, the two districts in metropolitan Kansas City recently combined, thus, Western Missouri now has 15 active districts. Another joint venture is the annual Institutions Weekend, co-sponsored by the Correctional and Treatment Facilities committee, which brings professionals from those institutions together with A.A.s to share information and discuss how we can cooperate to better serve the suffering alcoholic. This event is also a fund raiser to purchase A.A. literature for use in Correctional and Treatment Facilities work. Preserving area proceedings and A.A. history is our area archivist, and our collection, in display form, is shared at area assemblies, conferences and conventions. We believe that by studying the past we can, indeed, move forward. — *Shirley Rapp*

Nevada: Area 42 includes all of Nevada and parts of California along the eastern slopes of the Sierra Nevada Mountains. The problem of distance between area meetings was resolved years ago by creating a northern and southern area assembly. These assemblies meet 4 to 6 times a year in their respective areas. They

work with local issues and then come together twice a year, as an area assembly. A number of benefits have come out of this dual assembly arrangement. At present, a wide diversity of rural participation exists. This arrangement also allows the alternate officers to have active positions of service in the opposite ends of the area, rotating every two years, and has also allowed closer ties to both standing committees and central offices. Progress also, in the Spanish-speaking groups resulted in the purchase of translation equipment. New challenges are before us: the Reno, Carson areas in the north and the Las Vegas area in the south have some of the most rapid population growth in the nation. Thus, managing the size of districts will be at the forefront in the near future. The challenge of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic through general service remains our goal in Area 42. — *Dick Hill*

New Jersey (Northern): Our area has approximately 1,200 groups, about 30,000 members, 36 districts and 32 D.C.M.s. The districts are divided into 6 sections, each with a section leader. We hold three assemblies a year and one mini-Conference in April, just before the Conference in New York. All of the standing committees are filled, they are also co-chaired by intergroup. P.I., Treatment, C.P.C., Literature and Grapevine all hold monthly meetings, Correctional Facilities holds bimonthly meetings. The Archives committee holds monthly meetings. The Grapevine and Literature committees sell literature at all assemblies, mini-conferences, Districts Days of Sharings. They also go to the monthly intergroup meeting and to the Bookers Exchange. Our Web site committee is most recent. Our G.S.R. Workshop chair and the D.C.M. Workshop chair hold seminars throughout the year, a greater help for the new person coming into service. The last weekend in September we have our State Convention; if you are in New Jersey at the time, please stop by. — *Keith Boyd*

New York (Central): Area 47 covers approximately 15,000 square miles and 19 counties, with 717 groups, two central offices, 18 correctional facility groups in 75 districts served by 43 D.C.M.s. We have 11 assemblies each year and a convention in May where the delegate reports on the Conference. Assemblies rotate throughout C.N.Y. and draw about 10% of the voting membership of groups. Nine committees and eight officers meet and report at the assemblies. This year we will put in a bid for the Northeast Regional Forum for 2000. Often the topic at district and area meetings is how to get more people involved in service. I got involved in service because my sponsor was, as was his sponsor. I was told that over 95% of those active in service stayed sober. I wasn't told, I was shown that it was an important part of my daily reprieve from alcoholism. I know C.N.Y. will continue to reach out to groups and members not yet sponsored in service to experience the rewards and let them know their voice in A.A. matters. — *Jack Howley*

New York (Southeast): Area 49 is a garden rich in diversities. People of many languages, religions and backgrounds meet and get sober here everyday. Each of SENY's 12 counties (plus a Spanish-speaking community) has Share-a-Days, Roundups, Unity Breakfasts and various service workshops. The area committee has ten yearly meetings, including five at rotating assemblies, plus a convention and County Service Participation workshops. Our Corrections committee receives mail from facilities over the entire state, since 65% of the prison population returns to the NY Metropolitan area. We encourage people with special needs to do service. One alcoholic who cannot read has memorized the Preamble and chairs a detox meeting at Harlem Hospital. One alcoholic who cannot see has her computer read her "The Link," our area newsletter. Many alcoholics who do not speak English

come to our assemblies and Big Meetings where we provide translation equipment. We have meetings at 2 AM, at Sunrise on the beach, for commuters, and special interest meetings. We have "We Agnostic" meetings and "Never Had a Legal Drink" meetings. Our message is told in many accents as well as in American Sign Language. Whether in our rural northern area, a fashionable beach resort, or in Manhattan—the message is clear . . . and for that I am grateful. — *Cookie Schamroth*

North Carolina: Our "Tar Heel" State has over 12,500 active members, 35 districts and 925 groups, including 60 groups in correctional facilities. Our area assembly convenes twice a year; our area committee four times per year. We have seven officer positions, having recently added a Registrar. In 1997, after several years of discussion, five standing committees were established. In January, office space in Raleigh was leased to house our state archives. Since 1991, our area archivist has been accumulating historical artifacts reflecting our state's A.A. heritage and transporting them to area events and celebrations. Now Area 51 has supplemented these "traveling archives" with a permanent archives display. In August we will host the "Granddaddy of Them All," the combined 55th Southeastern Conference and NC State Convention in Raleigh. We cordially invite all to join us in this celebration of our sobriety and unity. May God continue to bless you, this Conference and the program that saved my life—Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Bill Aldred*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Area 82 consists of 256 groups (in comparison to 273 in 1997), with approximately 3,800 active members, and covers a large geographical area approximately 1,700 miles long. We are separated by two bodies of water that can only be accessed by boat or plane. There are 16 districts, 10 in Nova Scotia, 5 in Newfoundland, and 1 in Labrador. Due to difficulty with travel cost and distance we hold one assembly in the fall which is rotated around four major cities. We also hold annual provincial service weekends in each province to hear reports from D.C.M.s, area officers, G.S.R.s, and the delegate's Conference report. Each province maintains an archives with its own archivist. There is an intergroup located in Newfoundland. Each district has active committees like P.I., C.P.C., H&I, T.F., C.F., and Bridging the Gap. We contribute financially approximately 43% to G.S.O. Thanks to the previous area committees we have been able to recognize the seriousness of the problem regarding remote communities. We thank G.S.O. for supporting the native translations and would like to see those efforts continue. — *Boyd Snook*

Ohio (Central/Southeast): Area 53 has a renewed enthusiasm and dedication for the future of the Fellowship. We have a new intergroup starting in the northern sections with district activity and workshops all over the area. Our assemblies are held quarterly in a central location. We hold two one-day mini-conferences and an annual convention. We have a D.C.M. meeting prior to the area committee meeting so they can share their successes and challenges together and help determine what to bring to the assembly agenda. Last year our Correctional Facility committee held their first annual weekend conference. With the help of other areas, especially North Carolina, it was wonderfully informative. We have a Group Services committee that helps new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s get the information they need. Part of our Group Services committee is a G.S.R. school, about three hours concentrating on the history of A.A. and of the general service structure and how important the G.S.R. is in making it all work. All standing committees have been filling needs within the area, from workshops to health fairs. I have the full support of the area



I serve, and the encouragement and enthusiasm given to me has been wonderfully invigorating. I am honored and blessed to be serving an area that seems to be growing with vigor and excitement. — *Rick Barr*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 comprises 1,200 groups with 25,000 members, 59 districts and 7 intergroups or answering services who we have invited to participate in our functions. We meet as an assembly 6 times and provide G.S.R. and D.C.M. training 3 times per year. We host a spring mini-conference, on the format of the Conference with actual Agenda items, G.S.O. staff persons and regional participants to better inform the area of what is happening in A.A. as a whole. We just moved this conference to one of our remote areas in hopes of generating more involvement. We have 10 standing committees and have recently added an Archives committee. We try to better communicate with our groups to better facilitate the two-way flow of information. Our Area Web site is one of our P.I. tools to extend the hand of A.A. to those who seek it. The year 2000 brings us the honor to host the Ohio State Convention and the opportunity to involve more districts and groups in service to A.A. — *Rob Sebastian*

Oklahoma: The 5,718 sober alcoholics of Area 57 meet in 358 groups of all sizes. Currently, about two-thirds of the groups contribute to the area, while 60% contribute to G.S.O. Oklahoma A.A. is characterized by energetic, forward thinking. Area 57 was the birthplace of the Birthday Plan, Bridge-the-Gap, and most recently, the trustee-at-large/U.S., Dean Rinehart. The geographic remoteness of some of Oklahoma's districts makes only a single annual assembly practical. "The Land of the Red Man" (the actual Native American meaning of the word "Oklahoma") is blessed with sufficient group contributions to support an area office with a paid secretary. Our Language Services committee focuses on the needs of non-English-speaking members, and the mainstream D.C.M.s who serve their groups. The area committee decided unanimously not to segment these groups into a separate Spanish-speaking district, but to cultivate unity by enabling them to remain a part of their current district through translation assistance. We enhanced the effectiveness of our longstanding Area-Sponsored Workshops by changing the focus and format to Sharing Sessions in which we educate new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s.

Oklahoma also is looking forward to hosting the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2000. — *Mitchell Savage*

Ontario (Eastern): Area 83 borders Toronto on the west and the Quebec border on the east. We also have two U.S. districts and a district divided by the US/Canada border. There are over 600 registered groups and over 15,000 members. Over 50% of these groups and members are in the metropolitan Toronto area, the site of the 2005 International Convention. We are a very active area, holding two service days and assemblies each year in Kingston, Ontario—which is also the site of the year 2000 Eastern Canada Regional Forum. The area committee meets three to four times per year. While we are in good shape financially, we are concerned about our groups' declining contributions to G.S.O. and are making every effort to correct this. We are also concerned about the declining Grapevine sales in Ontario and will continue our efforts to raise the subscription levels. We have found that it is helpful for the area to buy a number of annual subscriptions and resell them to districts on a monthly basis. This makes purchasing the Grapevine more affordable for many small groups. Eastern Ontario is concerned by what we see as the watering down of the initiative to provide meaningful service to the still-suffering alcoholics in the far north. The recent trend of trying to be inclusive to all people in remote situations, while honorable in its intent, will, in my area's opinion, only produce a one-size solution that fits no one. — *Barry Watson*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 is doing as well as can be expected. The area committee members meet four times a year. We hold one area assembly yearly where all D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s and special services come together to address the concerns of the area and all the districts. We send out notices to encourage all A.A. members to come to these meetings and find out for themselves the satisfaction of doing service work. Like all areas we have our share of problems, such as getting people involved in service work, doing Twelfth Step calls and the ever popular Seventh Tradition. Area members support all of the conferences and anniversaries that we hold, as well as round ups and group anniversaries. As delegate I will do the best I can to get more members involved in service to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Rolly Boyer*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 has 8 districts serving 92 groups with approximately 1,600 members. The size of the area—260,000 square miles—presents an ongoing challenge. The majority of the population lives in the southern third of this huge expanse in communities accessible by highway. The remainder of the population is scattered in isolated northern communities accessible only by winter roads or by air travel. The challenge to the committee is two-fold; first, to reach out to the suffering alcoholic and, second, to maintain effective communication among the registered A.A. groups. Through our active C.P.C. and P.I. committees, we have had several pieces of A.A. literature translated into Ojibwe, which we are distributing to those remote communities. We have two assemblies annually: the Fall assembly held in the central district, and the Spring assembly, which rotates among the other seven districts. Our Self-support committee works to better inform the Fellowship about their part in making service happen in the area. — *Murray McIntosh*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): We have 47 districts with over 1,400 groups (at least half located within 10 intergroups) and 34,000 members. The area committee, consisting of six officers and 47 D.C.M.s, meets quarterly. Each D.C.M. is assigned to one of seven standing subcommittees. Each district has a business meeting once a month and at least one workshop per year. The area has three mini-assemblies each year to hear the delegate's report on the Conference. Workshops fill out a full 9 to 4 day. "What is the Area?" is another full-day event, hosting a full-day of sharing with all intergroups. The sharing day in 1998 was aimed at better cooperation between intergroups and general service in meeting institution commitments which otherwise would go unfulfilled. The result was that our message of help to the suffering alcoholic is being better carried. Over 1,000 A.A.s gather at our Convention/Assembly in November. We have but one aim: to foster unity so we might all better achieve our primary purpose: to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Alcoholics Anonymous is here today for us. Only through unity will A.A. be here tomorrow for the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Gary Colvin*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 has 45 districts and 767 groups in 26 counties. We have quarterly committee meetings and two assemblies each year, three during election year. Our most important service function is our annual "Get Away Weekend" in late March, followed by the Pre-Conference Assembly, at which we discuss upcoming agenda items. We also have 6 to 8 days of sharing throughout the area on service-oriented topics, which has been well received. Our greatest growth has been improving the use, size and effectiveness of our nine standing committees; each area officer is a liaison to one of these committees. We continue to involve our past delegates as a good source of information. We have been blessed with many fine members who have been willing to give whatever is required to continue to move forward, with humility and to make Area 60 the excellent service area it is today. — *Arlene Houston*

Quebec (Northeast): Area 89 consists of 365 groups, 22 districts, a six-member executive committee and about 6,600 members. We have 10 committees which correspond to the Conference committees. There are two general assemblies and four area committee assemblies a year; an executive committee meets once a month. We have an office in Quebec City with one employee. For the past two years all members and committees have been working for Unity. For several years, we've had problems with individual personalities, committees, money and more; so, at general assemblies and area committee assemblies there was a lot of ten-

sion. In October 1996, a new executive committee was elected, basing their work on the 1997 Conference theme "Spirituality, Our Foundation." Letters were sent by the area chairperson to G.S.R.s, explaining problems and suggesting solutions. Now, every day brings progress and responsibility, and our assemblies meet in maturity, love and serenity. I'm happy to be with you, representing my area at this Conference. — *Arthur Hobbs*

Quebec (Southeast): Quebec is divided into four large areas. Area 88 stretches from Magog to the Magdalen Islands, and covers the South shore of the St. Lawrence River to the U.S. border. We have 19 districts, comprising 220 groups that hold 251 meetings a week. A large number of our members speak French and we have only one English meeting. We hold four statutory area assemblies each year and one large general annual assembly at which we hold our elections. Each district has a P.I. coordinator and a La Vigne representative. In addition, each district holds one or several assemblies to discuss the themes of the Conference Workshop. We also hold two dinners to show our gratitude to A.A. at which the delegate presents a summary report on the Conference. Districts can also ask the area committee to hold information sessions on the structures and traditions of the Fellowship. As our area is very large, the area committee meets in various districts to carry the message throughout our territory. — *Jean-Rock Tremblay*

Texas (Northeast): Area 65 has 450 groups, 30 districts, and four Spanish-speaking groups. We have intergroups that meet in Texarkana, Dallas, Tyler, Fort Worth, and Waco. Dallas also has an Intergroup Hispana. We have four assemblies a year. The winter and summer ones are rotated around the rural districts. The spring and fall assemblies are held at a central location, usually the Dallas/Forth Worth area. We also have a yearly "Bridge the Gap" conference. The Correctional Facilities committee and NETA sponsor this conference. All of Area 65's service committees are very active. We take our sobriety very seriously and our service with responsibility. I am very grateful to be a member of Area 65 of Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Luis Pineda*

Texas (Southeast): Area 67 has approximately 500 groups, served by 15 districts, with over 2,000 meetings weekly. The C.F., P.I., T.F., C.P.C., Archives, Grapevine and Finance committees are working hard to meet the needs of the Fellowship and local communities. We hold four assemblies a year, with the January assembly held in conjunction with our annual convention. The theme of the 37th convention, in Galveston this year, was "It Works—It Really Does." It was attended by the largest gathering ever—2,151. This year we are pleased to hold our first Correctional Facilities Conference in Houston. Houston is also the host city for the 42nd International Conference of Young People in A.A. Every November we celebrate an Area Gratitude Dinner. Each district provides for some function of the event and we were especially pleased to have our Spanish districts, 65 and 66, serve as host and to prepare the main course of fajitas. It is our vision and our hope, by sharing our love and gratitude, that both the new and old members find the rewards and blessings of service. — *Mike Divin*

Utah: Area 69 consists of approximately 270 groups in the state of Utah and Wendover, Nevada, with an estimated 5,000 members. The Utah Area has 11 districts, ten of which are currently active. We look forward to hosting the Pacific Region A.A. Service Assembly (PRAASA) in the year 2000 in Ogden. We are also excited about continuing outreach to the remote communities in our area, whether geographically or culturally remote. We will be

participating in the Special Forum in the four corners area of the Navajo Nation this October. We hold three assemblies, two workshops and three Area Committee meetings a year. Our officers and standing committees participate in district workshops and other A.A. gatherings, and our standing committees carry the message into schools, at community and professional gatherings (including the Univ. of Utah School on Addiction and Alcoholism), through the media, and in correctional and treatment facilities. Each delegate seems to have a special focus during their term as delegate. Mine is remembering that we serve all of A.A.—not just those who are currently involved in the general service structure. — *Mickey Hardesty*

Virginia: At our 1997 Fall Assembly, assisted by our regional trustee Betty S., we held an area inventory. It went well, and results were evaluated and reviewed by our 1998 Spring Assembly. We learned much and have grown in unity and strength. We now have 42 districts and approximately 1,550 registered groups. We welcomed four new districts in the last two years and still more are considering splitting, having over 50 registered groups in each. We now have an Area Web site on the Internet. In order to insure we stay within the A.A. Traditions, the assembly approved comprehensive Guidelines for our Web site and its maintenance. We have great recovery and carrying of the message in Virginia; some of our districts have organized efforts to bring meetings to homeless people. However, many of our members and trusted servants still seem to have considerable room to grow in terms of understanding and acting "a part of" the bigger picture—that is, supporting and joining in Regional Forums and other events. But, there is no problem we can't solve with communication, action, and faith in a power greater than ourselves. It is my pleasure to work at being a part of that solution. It's a labor of love. — *Gene Lesser*

Washington (Western): Four years have passed since the Conference seated Area 92, effectively creating two new Areas. Since the Western Washington Area retained three-quarters of the registered groups in Area 72, it did not feel like a new area right away. It felt as if we had just streamlined and focused our efforts to a more concentrated population. Through biannual inventories, we decided to take a look at the way we communicate our Legacy of Service to the Fellowship. Our area committee has opened a dialog where members are free to express their criticisms and suggestions for improving the way we do business. We have a strong core of officers and the D.C.M.s seem well prepared and enthusiastic. With a 7.8% increase to over 1,100, the groups have creatively devised solutions and implemented changes for managing their growth. On the whole, renegotiating district boundaries has served their needs well. We have 40 active districts with one Spanish-language district. We are an integral part of the Pacific Region and have a close working relationship with our Northwest neighbors. Our area continues its commitment to being fully involved with

the rest of A.A. in our mission to help the still-suffering alcoholic discover that there is a solution. — *Bob Fox*

West Virginia: Area 73 consists of 17 districts and has almost 300 groups, and approximately 3,400 members. There are two area assemblies a year and an annual convention each summer. We rely on standing committees to develop information and recommendations on issues brought to the assembly for action. This assures that our assemblies can make a fully informed group conscience. Our annual convention is for fellowship and sharing. Both assemblies and conventions are rotated to various cities throughout the state. Since West Virginia is predominately a rural state with scattered population centers, it provides a challenge in carrying the message to the alcoholic who is seeking help. Active districts and our use of a state-wide 1-800 answering service have gone far to meet this challenge. We are looking forward to hosting the Southeastern Regional Forum in 2000 in Huntington. — *Joe Deneault*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has 35 districts with nearly 950 groups that approximately 19,000 alcoholics call home. We conduct six meetings per year, and many of our districts host mini-conferences, service workshops and other A.A. functions. Five central offices carry the message. For the past three years we have hosted a Corrections Conference that is autonomous from the area. Our membership also supports two special collections that help serve our members in corrections facilities. The Rainbow Can Fund buys A.A. literature, while Count on Us provides Grapevine subscriptions for almost all of the corrections facilities, from county jails to prisons. We have added a Special Needs committee and also began a Third Legacy workshop. We are hard at work with our friends in Area 74 to hold an annual Unity Conference beginning in 2001. Our archives are housed at the Milwaukee Central Office. One of our great assets is the many people who have served the Fellowship for many years and remain active today. We have terrific support from past delegates who teach us about service. I am honored to serve as delegate for an area that stays

so focused on recovery, unity and service in a rapidly changing Fellowship. — *Ken Gusner*



Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 50th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in early September to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES

- The committee reviewed the proposed draft of a Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Archives Committee and accepted it with suggested amendments.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. It was the sense of the committee that, as service material, the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.
- The committee reviewed the text added to six C.P.C. pamphlets by the 1997 General Service Conference under the title "Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other Than Alcohol" and took no action because they could not reach substantial unanimity.
- The committee reviewed a drawing of a proposed new panel for the current C.P.C. Exhibit to replace the "Our Beginnings" panel and supported the spirit of the panel change.
- Following a thorough review of the C.P.C. Kit, the committee made a minor change. The committee encouraged local C.P.C. committees to utilize both the shared experience of others involved in C.P.C. work and the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed a draft of a one-page informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals and agreed that, with minor editorial changes, the letter be distributed biannually to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada.
- The committee considered additions/revisions to the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and suggested that the Publications Department prepare a draft of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities that will include:
 - 1) New graphics that do more to depict hope
 - 2) An easier-to-read format
 - 3) "Clyde's" story
 - 4) New stories depicting A.A. members with long-term sobriety while incarcerated, in addition to all current stories.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously recognizes that the acceptance of discounts or subsidies in the form of cash causes discomfort to some members of our Fellowship. The committee suggests that any future negotiations regarding International Convention discounts or subsidies be carried out with this in mind.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.
- After broad discussion on Self-Support, we unanimously encourage the use of our existing communication tools, such as the video "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure." The committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they be used.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in 2001 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a soft-cover anthology of letters selected from those published in the magazine from 1944 to the present.
- The committee liked the idea of an audio form of the monthly magazine produced by the Grapevine, and asked the Grapevine staff to determine the level of interest in the Fellowship and bring back a report to the Conference Committee on the Grapevine in the year 2000.
- The committee discussed the request to establish a committee to review and approve all articles prior to publication in the Grapevine, and determined that the current process for the selection of articles works well.
- The committee would like to encourage areas to purchase Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions and back issues for direct placement in treatment facilities and correctional facilities.
- Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the need for it expressed by the Hispanic community, and considering its spiritual benefits and benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested that delegates get districts involved, especially the host district where a Forum is held; encourage new people to go to Forums and to submit topics of interest for presentations and workshops; distribute Forum flyers and place Forum information in area, district, central office and intergroup newsletters. Suggest that Forums have more flexibility and open scheduling of the agenda; questions on the Forum floor need more direct answers. Special Forums are working well and have brought areas and districts together. The committee looks forward to a great year ahead with four Regional and two Special Forums planned in Altoona, Pennsylvania; San Juan, Puerto Rico; Sheridan, Wyoming; Ann Arbor, Michigan; Window Rock, Arizona; and Lubbock, Texas.
- The committee suggested that area/state/provincial convention committees be lovingly requested to consider not planning conventions six weeks before or after the 2000 International Convention, since attendance at local events during this time might be adversely affected. As local committees are planning

events up to three years prior to the event, it is suggested that the committee discuss this request at least three years prior to the 2005 International Convention.

- The committee discussed proposed revisions to current Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection and requested that G.S.O. management and the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare revised Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection based on experience from the 2005 site

selection and that these revised Guidelines and Procedures be presented for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement an inventory on International Conventions similar to the 1999 Regional Forums inventory and forward an Inventory Report for discussion to the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee strongly suggested that no index be included in any Fourth Edition Big Book.
- The committee discussed with appreciation the proposal for an A.A. history book and agreed that there were ample existing resources on A.A. history and that there was no compelling need to develop this project.
- Expressing substantial concerns about unity and inclusivity in the A.A. Fellowship, the committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee, through the General Service Office, distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees be composed of nine voting members without regard for representation from every region and agreed that it is reasonable to have nine voting members on secondary committees with an attempt to have a balanced regional representation, with the exception of the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums which should continue to be composed of eight delegates (one from each region) because of the importance of having every region represented when the committee is involved with site selection for an International Convention.
- The committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees meet jointly with the corresponding trustees' committees and then meet separately to discuss agenda items and make recommendations reached by majority vote (if any) and saw no reason to change the current practice of meeting jointly with the corresponding trustees' committee with the



understanding that, although trustee committee members are present, only members of the Conference Committees vote on recommendations to the Conference as a whole.

- Although the committee recognized the importance of bridging the gap between treatment and correctional facilities and the A.A. group, the committee saw no need for a Conference Bridging the Gap Committee at this time. The committee expressed confidence that the trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment and Correctional Facilities will do everything possible to enhance interest in this activity at the area and district level. It was also noted that the needs of Bridging the Gap Committees are being met by the Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities assignments at G.S.O.

- The committee discussed possible future needs of the Conference in terms of combining or reassigning committee functions and agreed that this may need closer attention in the years to come.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Public Information Committee's report on the A.A. Fact File and approved all of the suggested minor editorial revisions.
- The committee discussed anonymity at the public level on the Internet and suggested that area delegates explain at the local level that "electronic media" is implicit in the last phrase of the Eleventh Tradition and that areas be encouraged to discuss anonymity at the public level of the Internet. The committee further suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review P.I. literature to add "Internet" or "electronic media" where collective experience refers to press, radio, films and TV, and requested that the trustees' P.I. Committee report back to the 2000 Conference P.I. Committee.
- The committee discussed the 1998 and current report on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity. The committee applauded the effectiveness of the A.A. Web site as an adequate and valuable public information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the Public Information pamphlet "Where Do I Go From Here?" be included in the contents of the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered suggestions for changes to the revised manuscript of *The A.A. Service Manual* offered by Conference members after April 1, and decided that since they came in after a deadline set for the committee's review, they should go through the committee process by being offered for the agenda of the 2000 Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to add a footnote to Warranty Five, page 72, *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1998-99 edition, stating that Alcoholics Anonymous will continue to oppose unauthorized use of its registered trademarks. The committee unanimously agreed the footnote should not be added, agreeing with the 1997 Report and Charter Committee that it was not necessary to footnote the Warranty because the right of decision in such matters rests with the A.A. World Services Board on behalf of the General Service Board, U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed a proposal that G.S.O. print all listed groups in its directories unless a group chooses not to be included. It was decided not to suggest the change because it was felt the present policy of requiring a phone number in directory listings agrees with a 1977 Conference Advisory Action which states, "Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information sheet."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the condensed summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message into Psychiatric/Mental Health Facilities or State Hospitals" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed both the condensed and unedited summary of responses to the June 1998 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into non-correctional youth facilities. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message Into Non-Correctional Youth Facilities" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts. As a result of their discussions, the committee emphasized the importance of continued attention to this most valuable Twelfth-Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Treatment Facilities Handbook:
 - 1) The committee discussed the title of the 1998 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee's list of "Suggested Goals for Treatment Facilities Committees." The committee suggested that this section be retitled "Some Suggested Activities for Treatment Facilities Committees."
 - 2) The committee reviewed the revised text in the section entitled "Fellowships Similar to A.A." in the Treatment Facilities Handbook and welcomed the simplified version.
- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Handbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. The committee unanimously agreed that as service material, the Kit and Handbook may be updated as often as our shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Handbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed adding the following statement to the vacancy announcement letters for appointed committee member, Class A trustee, regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada:

"In seeking applicants for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

The committee was unanimous that the statement was reflective of A.A. principles but felt uncomfortable with the word "diversity." The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee review the statement again to determine if any such statement is necessary, or if it could be improved, and report back to the Conference Committee on Trustees in April 2000.

- The committee reviewed the role of appointed committee members and recognized they are a great resource to trustees' committees, providing a richness of experience and expertise to the committees on which they serve. The committee felt that appointed committee members should continue to be members of A.A. and thanked currently-serving appointed committee members for their service to the Fellowship.
- The committee expressed appreciation to the chairman of the General Service Board for communicating that five of seven Class A trustees will be rotating off the board in the years 2000-2001, and understands that the chairman may feel the need to exercise his option to extend the term of one or more Class A trustees in order to maintain continuity on the board.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

Floor Action #2:

- That the 49th General Service Conference direct the trustees' Literature Committee to evaluate the Conference Literature Committee's "strong suggestion" to distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship. In this evaluation, the trustees' Literature Committee should weigh out the benefits of such a questionnaire and determine if such a questionnaire would in fact, give us a group conscience. They should report back to the Conference Literature Committee. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #3:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., return the \$250,000 cash incentive received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #4:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., refrain from accepting the \$100,000 cash incentive from the city of Minneapolis for the 2000 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Mickey Hardesty's (Utah) area gave him a going away present of a Mickey Mouse hand puppet—to use in response to roll call and to remind him of Rule 62: Don't take yourself too seriously.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 1998 (with comparative totals for 1997)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 1998	Consolidated 1997
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
ASSETS							
Cash	\$ 399,736	\$ 376,330		\$ 659,283	\$ 90,066	\$ 1,525,415	\$ 1,882,547
Accounts and interest receivable		120,208		333,138	76,939	530,285	420,129
Intercompany balances	(501,235)	(1,562,949)		549,781	1,514,403		
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.				1,252,020	227,593	1,479,613	1,479,361
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.				174,509	47,810	222,319	268,750
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1999/2004 (Cost: 1998 - \$8,237,981; 1997 - \$7,729,479)		8,507,334				8,507,334	7,889,413
Property and Equipment							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 1998 - \$2,534,941; 1997 - \$2,280,528)			\$ 1,034,253			1,034,253	808,252
Deferred charges	218,962			42,648	76,940	338,550	321,244
Prepaid pension cost (Note 3)		568,481				568,481	354,754
Other assets				20,251		20,251	20,251
Total Assets	117,463	8,009,404	1,034,253	3,031,630	2,033,751	14,226,501	13,444,701
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	\$ 58,748			\$ 940,681	\$ 130,381	\$ 1,129,810	\$ 816,516
Accrued royalties				54,232		54,232	154,421
Deferred income							
Orders and subscriptions	1,702			47,287	1,514,639	1,563,628	1,537,930
Accrued postretirement health benefit obligation (Note 5)		2,506,768				2,506,768	2,177,767
Total Liabilities	60,450	2,506,768		1,042,200	1,645,020	5,254,438	4,686,634
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	5,502,636	1,034,253	1,989,430	388,731	8,972,063	8,758,067
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	117,463	8,009,404	1,034,253	3,031,630	2,033,751	14,226,501	13,444,701

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Exhibit B

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 1998 (with comparative totals for 1997)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		Consolidated 1998	Consolidated 1997
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund		English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 9,207,034	\$ 2,283,369	\$ 57,593	\$ 11,547,996	\$ 11,482,075
Less: Discounts				294,799	38,121		332,920	363,376
Net Sales				8,912,235	2,245,248	57,593	11,215,076	11,118,699
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(2,997,710)	(436,161)	(35,170)	(3,469,041)	(3,552,244)
Royalties on books				(589,035)			(589,035)	(751,780)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(805,541)	(491,503)	(15,559)	(1,312,603)	(1,322,887)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,519,949	1,317,584	6,864	5,844,397	5,491,788
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 4,038,921						4,038,921	3,854,627
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	1,335	\$ 555,440		2,213	91,883		650,871	571,321
Total Income	4,040,256	555,440		4,522,162	1,409,467	6,864	10,534,189	9,917,736
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	3,692,126			1,322,641	940,193	73,048	6,028,008	5,736,216
Supporting services	2,175,585	26,741	\$ 254,413	1,232,432	514,481		4,203,652	4,281,684
Total Expenses	5,867,711	26,741	254,413	2,555,073	1,454,674	73,048	10,231,660	10,017,900
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,827,455)	528,699	(254,413)	1,967,089	(45,207)	(66,184)	302,529	(100,164)
INTERCOMPANY DONATIONS AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS	1,827,455	(478,352)	480,414	(1,907,869)	12,168	66,184		
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR		50,347	226,001	59,220	(33,039)		302,529	(100,164)
PRIOR PERIOD ADJUSTMENT (Note 3)		(88,533)					(88,533)	
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	5,540,822	808,252	1,930,210	421,770		8,758,067	8,858,231
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	5,502,636	1,034,253	1,989,430	388,731		8,972,063	8,758,067

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 1998 (with comparative totals for 1997)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	1998 Total	1997 Total
Salaries	\$ 580,802	\$ 676,456	\$ 122,264	\$ 1,041	\$ 87,430	\$ 816,521	\$ 467,708	\$ 45,435	\$ 1,830,842	\$ 4,628,499	\$ 4,540,165
Payroll taxes	41,494	50,915	8,751		5,728	60,854	36,353	3,915	137,733	345,743	339,171
Health and group insurance	112,570	90,044	12,881		9,632	122,338	76,481	7,342	365,391	796,679	799,425
Retirement expense - funding	40,318	48,634	8,260		5,522	58,187	24,029	700	126,365	312,015	255,751
Other program printing	227,433	33,888	48,310	8,104	4,428	1,500			193	323,856	337,676
Mailing labor	127,585	8,382			7,072	13			(1)	143,051	147,644
Postage and express	218,306	56,729	22,206	2,628	16,098	5,978	25,246		27,532	374,723	380,940
Writers fees	57,457	83,240	6,920	2,030	1,225	7,798			419	159,089	129,397
Foreign literature assistance		83,839								83,839	64,887
Selling expenses						58,012	145,400	7,397		210,809	182,656
Professional fees									254,416	254,416	181,980
Contracted services	4,496	55,430	3,680	14,474	2,278	16,849	3,526		62,474	163,207	154,687
Occupancy	87,585	83,296	6,693		3,947	114,517	67,290		312,072	675,400	637,145
Telephone	27,638	19,830	2,882		2,739	24,400	24,016		52,812	154,317	141,128
Equipment maintenance	3,433	519				1,309			61,423	66,684	63,794
Furniture and equipment	3,531	13,618				1,393		3,773	24,716	47,031	87,057
Stationery and office supplies	50,928	2,996	8,928	2,252	4,124	5,100	35,072		64,513	173,913	192,483
Office service and expense	6,228	10,678	13,411	2,410	2,605	11,486	35,072	2,442	181,424	265,756	235,842
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,853	23,449	331,461	152,617	39,873	16,386		814	386,963	953,416	787,574
Bad debts								1,230	33,211	34,441	17,068
Delegate fees			(106,265)	(110,113)						(216,378)	(83,299)
Total Operating Expenses	1,591,657	1,341,943	490,382	75,443	192,701	1,322,641	940,193	73,048	3,922,498	9,950,506	9,593,171
Severance benefits									-	-	271,214
Postretirement health benefits									329,001	329,001	253,855
Depreciation									254,413	254,413	254,414
Retirement expense adjustment (Note 3)									(302,260)	(302,260)	(354,754)
Total Expenses	1,591,657	1,341,943	490,382	75,443	192,701	1,322,641	940,193	73,048	4,203,652	10,231,660	10,017,900
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,059,088	892,928	326,300	50,200	128,223	1,232,432	514,481	-	(4,203,652)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,650,745	2,234,871	816,682	125,643	320,924	2,555,073	1,454,674	73,048	-	10,231,660	10,017,900
Services	\$2,650,745	\$2,234,871	\$816,682	\$125,643	\$320,924					\$6,148,865	\$6,097,554
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,555,073	-	-	-	\$2,555,073	2,403,888
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,454,674	\$73,048	-	1,527,722	1,516,458
										10,231,660	10,017,900
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 1997	\$2,675,970	\$2,245,617	\$802,598	\$3,685	\$369,684	\$2,403,888	\$1,417,069	\$99,389	-	\$10,017,900	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 1998
(with comparative totals for 1997)

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>1998</u>	<u>1997</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 302,529	\$ (100,164)
Prior period adjustment to prepaid pension cost	(88,533)	-
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(115,878)	(63,744)
Amortization of bond premiums	5,776	4,125
Depreciation	254,413	254,414
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(110,156)	(47,066)
Inventories	46,179	85,030
Deferred charges and other assets	(17,306)	(48,412)
Accounts and accruals payable	213,105	279,787
Deferred income	25,698	43,113
Prepaid pension cost	(213,727)	(354,754)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	329,001	253,855
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u> <u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>631,101</u>	<u>306,184</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Office construction project	(480,414)	
Proceeds from sales of investments	1,500,000	2,250,000
Purchases of investments	(2,007,819)	(2,754,649)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u> <u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(988,233)</u>	<u>(504,649)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in cash	(357,132)	(198,465)
Cash, beginning of year	<u>1,882,547</u>	<u>2,081,012</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>1,525,415</u></u>	<u><u>1,882,547</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 1, 1999

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1998 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the consolidated financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 1998 and the consolidated changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1998**

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND—This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities

be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscribers reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND—This fund was established in 1990 to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The GENERAL FUND—This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

The consolidated financial statements include certain prior year summarized comparative information. Such information does not include sufficient detail to constitute a presentation in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles. Accordingly, such information should be read in conjunction with the Organization's financial statements for the year ended December 31, 1997, from which the summarized information was derived.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1998 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of Leases			
475 Riverside Drive		\$2,105,871	\$ 171,100	\$1,154,929
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	83,313	606,287
Computer—hardware	5 Years	502,054		502,054
—software	5 Years	271,671		271,671
		<u>3,569,194</u>	<u>254,413</u>	<u>2,534,941</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 1998 and 1997 is comprised of the following:

	1998	1997
Interest	\$538,970	\$511,065
Realized gains on redemptions	6,459	3,220
Change in unrealized gains	109,419	60,524
Investment expenses	(3,977)	(3,488)
	<u>650,871</u>	<u>571,321</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services." Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the *Box 4-5-9* newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French-speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and other miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statements of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65 % of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50 %.

Prior to 1997, pension expense had been consistently reported as the contributions made to actuarially fund plan benefits. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective in 1987, Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 87 ("SFAS 87"), introduced the concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirement. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan is considered to be over-funded or under-funded. It was clear from the actuarial data that there was no unfunded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Also, at that time, the actuaries stated that the difference in expense between the actuarial funding requirement and SFAS 87 periodic pension cost would not be material. Therefore, since management believed that the actual cash expenditure to fund the pension was the more relevant measure of retirement costs, no changes were made to the previously established accounting and reporting practices for pension expense through the end of 1996.

By 1997, however, as a result of substantial investment returns earned on the assets of the Retirement Plan in recent years, the assets of the Plan had grown faster than the obligation to provide for pension benefits. As a result, there was now a substantial difference between the actuarial funding requirement and net periodic pension cost calculated under SFAS 87. Accordingly, SFAS 87 was adopted on January 1, 1997.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are still recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 has been recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 1998:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$12,044,967
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>10,070,262</u>
Funded status	<u>1,974,705</u>
Proposed pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 568,481</u>

The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized prepaid pension cost asset is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	7.5%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.5%
Benefit cost	\$ (27,939)
Employers contribution	274,321
Benefits paid	570,844
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 274,321
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	(302,260)
	<u>(27,939)</u>

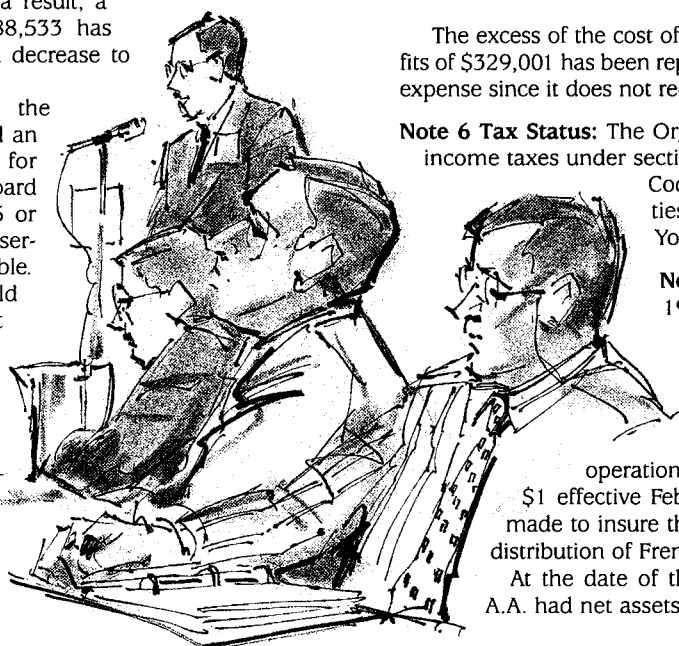
Plan assets at December 31, 1998 were comprised as follows:

Short term cash and receivables	\$ 169,061
Common and preferred stock	7,112,902
Government bonds	2,848,426
Corporate and other bonds	1,861,328
Other investments	53,250
	<u>12,044,967</u>

During 1998, it was determined that an actuarial error had occurred in the calculation of the net periodic pension cost for 1997, resulting in the omission of the benefit obligations attributable to certain employees. As a result, a prior period adjustment of \$88,533 has been shown on Exhibit B as a decrease to beginning net assets.

Effective March 31, 1996, the General Service Board approved an early retirement "window" for A.A.W.S. and General Service Board employees. Employees age 55 or older with combined age and service of 64 or more are eligible. Participating employees would receive a higher pension benefit by adding five years of age up to age 65, and a temporary Social Security supplement up to age 62. Severance pay was also provided based on years of service, and was borne by the General Service Board.

The program was voluntary. The expiration date of the window was September 30, 1997.



Severance benefits under this program of \$178,967 were incurred in 1997. In addition, \$92,247 of severance costs were incurred by the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. in 1997, so that \$271,214 has been reported on Exhibit C.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 1998, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1998 is \$5,690,430.

The rent expense for the years ended December 31, 1998 and 1997, was as follows:

	1998	1997
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$654,900</u>	<u>\$607,200</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$165,700	\$153,700
General Service Board	391,000	362,400
A.A. Grapevine	98,200	91,100
	<u>654,900</u>	<u>607,200</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 7.5% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 1998:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>\$2,506,768</u>
Benefit cost	\$ 444,172
Benefits paid	115,171

The excess of the cost of benefits over the payments for benefits of \$329,001 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense since it does not require the current outlay of cash.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Note 7 Subsequent Event: In January 1999, A.A. World Services formed a controlled Canadian nonprofit corporation, Services Mondiaux Des Alcooliques Anonymes, Inc., "S.M.A.A.," for the purpose of acquiring the assets, liabilities and operations of Publications Francaises A.A. for \$1 effective February 1, 1999. The acquisition was made to insure the continuation of the publishing and distribution of French A.A. literature in Canada.

At the date of the purchase, Publications Francaises A.A. had net assets of approximately \$199,000.

Budget Highlights

1999 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 1999 sales budget of \$8,823,800 is approximately 4% less than the 1998 actual results. The budget reflects the continuing trend of declining unit sales. Book & Booklet unit sales are estimated 6% lower than 1998. Net sales after discounts allowed are projected at \$8,553,900, approximately \$358,000 less than 1998.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted \$203,000 less than 1998's actual results, primarily a result of lower sales volume. Royalties, budgeted at \$155,100, are estimated \$434,000 less than 1998, a direct result of the ended obligation of payments to the Stepping Stones Foundation.

An increase of approximately 6% has been budgeted in the shipping and warehousing costs anticipating increase in postage and freight.

Gross profit from literature is budgeted at \$4,750,500, approximately \$230,600 greater than 1998, primarily a result of the decline in royalty payments which more than offsets the decline in sales.

Contributions for 1999 have been budgeted at \$4,100,000, approximately a 1.5% increase over 1998.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$8,854,500, 3.4% higher than 1998.

Total Operating Expenses for 1999 have been budgeted at \$8,680,450, approximately 3% higher than 1998.

An excess of revenue over expenses of \$174,100 is budgeted. This compares with a \$139,600 net income for 1998, a \$245,000 loss for 1997, a \$1,264,000 loss for 1996, and a \$1,147,000 loss for 1995. The three years of losses, followed by moderated profits, has accomplished the goal of reducing the Reserve Fund balance to a 9-month level.

1999 Grapevine Budget

The 1999 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation for 1999 of 117,000 copies, even with the 1998 117,300 average.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,738,300 is expected, even with 1998. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$599,200, approximately \$82,000 higher than 1998 as a result of additional cassette tape, calendar and pocket planner sales.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,382,263 is 61.8% of budgeted income as compared to \$1,317,584 or 58.7% in 1998, 58.1% in 1997 and 52.3% achieved in 1996.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 1999 are budgeted at \$1,503,757, approximately \$50,000 more than the 1998 actuals of \$1,454,700.

Net Income: For 1999 net loss is budgeted at \$29,700 after interest earned as compared with a net loss of \$45,207 in 1998.

1999 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture.

For 1999 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$5,216, compared with a \$6,864 gross profit for 1998 and a \$2,750 loss for 1997. Circulation for 1999 is estimated at 7,500 approximately equal with the 7,724 1998 average. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$74,818 for 1999, compared with \$73,046 in 1998. The 1999 budget projects a net loss of \$69,602, compared with a \$66,182 loss in 1998.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, and \$66,182 in 1998.

The General Service Office 1999 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	1998 Actual	1999 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$9,207,034	\$8,823,825
Discounts allowed	294,799	269,925
<u>Net Sales</u>	8,912,235	8,553,900
 Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	2,997,709	2,794,763
Royalties	589,035	155,098
<u>Gross Margin</u>	5,325,491	5,604,039
 DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	805,542	853,500
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	4,519,949	4,750,539
Contributions Received	4,038,920	4,100,000
Interest Income	3,548	4,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	8,562,417	8,854,539
 OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,842,497	4,055,000
Payroll taxes	283,555	297,000
Insurance	660,780	725,100
Retirement expense	273,414	260,000
Other program printing	323,855	380,000
Mailing, labor, etc	143,483	156,125
Postage & express	349,045	352,000
Writers' fees	159,088	50,000
Other literature assistance	83,839	109,000
Selling expenses	58,012	81,450
Professional fees	229,765	181,500
Contracted services	155,684	113,100
Occupancy	579,276	533,950
Telephone	130,300	136,750
Equipment maintenance	66,684	66,000
Furniture & equipment	31,495	80,000
Stationery & office expense	132,470	160,050
Office service & expense	221,872	233,425
Travel, meals, & accommodations	684,878	700,000
Bad debts	12,791	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	8,422,783	8,680,450
 Income (loss) for period	139,634	174,089

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1999 BUDGET

			LA VIÑA	
	1998 Actual	1999 Budget	1998 Actual	1999 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>117,292</u>	<u>117,000</u>	<u>7,724</u>	<u>7,500</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE				
Subscription income	\$1,703,737	\$1,721,374	\$57,593	\$55,394
Single copies and back issues	<u>24,345</u>	<u>16,972</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total magazine income	1,728,082	1,738,346	57,593	55,394
Total direct costs	<u>678,065</u>	<u>715,748</u>	<u>50,729</u>	<u>50,178</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE	<u>1,050,017</u>	<u>1,022,598</u>	<u>6,864</u>	<u>5,216</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	517,166	599,243		
Total direct costs	<u>249,599</u>	<u>239,578</u>		
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS	<u>267,567</u>	<u>359,665</u>		
TOTAL GROSS PROFIT	<u>1,317,584</u>	<u>1,382,263</u>		
COSTS AND EXPENSES				
EDITORIAL COSTS				
Salaries, including temporary help	175,801	204,653	30,919	32,137
Payroll taxes and benefits	41,674	58,120	8,000	8,776
Occupancy costs	60,070	60,530	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	25,224	15,582	1,992	1,970
Product development	<u>3,526</u>	<u>2,000</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total Editorial	<u>306,295</u>	<u>340,885</u>	<u>40,911</u>	<u>42,883</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS				
Salaries, including temporary help	564,766	571,782	14,516	14,785
Payroll taxes and benefits	183,056	201,983	3,464	4,624
Occupancy costs	60,070	60,530	0	0
Office supplies and expense	44,920	41,536	0	0
Subscriber services	13,750	5,160	0	0
Selling expense — regular	111,972	103,000	7,397	9,174
— GvR program	19,678	40,000	0	0
Postage	<u>25,246</u>	<u>22,674</u>	<u>450</u>	<u>0</u>
Total Circulation and Business	<u>1,023,458</u>	<u>1,046,665</u>	<u>25,827</u>	<u>28,583</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE				
Consultant fees	3,996	4,000	0	0
Insurance	4,939	4,960	492	240
Professional fees	24,650	24,426	0	0
Meetings and conferences	51,347	50,638	813	2,500
Furniture and equipment	11,764	7,000	3,773	312
Canadian exchange and other	7,238	9,500	0	0
Bank service charges	563	683	0	0
Bad debts	<u>20,426</u>	<u>15,000</u>	<u>1,230</u>	<u>300</u>
Total General and Administrative	<u>124,923</u>	<u>116,207</u>	<u>6,308</u>	<u>3,352</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,454,676</u>	<u>1,503,757</u>	<u>73,046</u>	<u>74,818</u>
Add: Interest earned	<u>91,885</u>	<u>91,796</u>		
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>(45,207)</u>	<u>(29,698)</u>	<u>(66,182)</u>	<u>(69,602)</u>

() denotes red figures

1998 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1	Ala./N.W.Fla.	395	207	52.4%	27,814.68	8,223	\$3.38
2	Alaska	204	90	44.1	9,275.82	3,682	2.51
3	Arizona	784	365	46.5	69,773.08	16,863	4.13
4	Arkansas	241	127	52.6	10,321.18	4,217	2.44
	California						
5	Southern	1,908	730	38.2	114,899.57	59,281	1.93
6	N. Coastal	1,941	1,074	55.3	198,381.84	62,441	3.17
7	N. Interior	705	351	49.7	45,793.93	20,014	2.28
8	San Diego/Imp.	867	369	42.5	56,394.94	26,790	2.10
9	Mid-South	1,818	711	39.1	101,257.00	58,557	1.72
10	Colorado	621	333	53.6	52,341.36	14,456	3.62
11	Connecticut	1,428	540	37.8	63,682.02	34,957	1.82
12	Delaware	198	122	61.6	21,750.41	3,098	7.02
13	D.C.	453	205	45.2	35,939.35	14,500	2.47
	Florida						
14	North	642	357	55.6	63,220.41	14,791	4.27
15	South/Bahamas/ V.I.	1,505	793	52.6	136,542.60	31,996	4.26
16	Georgia	695	441	63.4	68,317.51	16,534	4.13
17	Hawaii	288	166	57.6	25,613.79	5,630	4.54
18	Idaho	197	90	45.6	14,656.23	3,213	4.56
	Illinois						
19	Chicago	1,175	303	25.7	52,455.71	28,023	1.87
20	North	1,055	408	38.6	43,353.38	21,796	1.98
21	South	456	182	39.9	24,413.26	7,638	3.19
	Indiana						
22	North	672	265	39.4	33,387.21	9,985	3.34
23	South	543	243	44.7	30,472.34	10,496	2.90
24	Iowa	643	299	46.5	33,631.24	12,782	2.63
25	Kansas	371	157	42.3	25,641.11	9,137	2.80
26	Kentucky	628	331	52.7	56,949.17	10,286	5.53
27	Louisiana	505	183	36.2	24,044.16	10,564	2.27
28	Maine	468	153	32.6	13,347.22	8,007	1.66
29	Maryland	926	382	41.2	63,975.69	14,843	4.31
	Massachusetts						
30	East	1,511	564	37.3	93,128.56	51,404	1.81
31	West	255	126	49.4	17,736.66	5,436	3.26
	Michigan						
32	Central	542	214	39.4	33,151.59	12,167	2.72
33	Southeast	691	275	39.7	49,853.03	17,413	2.86
34	West	475	213	44.8	27,937.01	9,091	3.07
	Minnesota						
35	North	543	243	44.7	19,190.87	8,231	2.33
36	South	997	394	39.5	53,283.79	21,953	2.42
37	Mississippi	233	117	50.2	14,988.44	4,366	3.43
	Missouri						
38	East	534	265	49.6	39,611.49	9,008	4.39
39	West	214	112	52.3	11,697.04	6,531	1.79
40	Montana	285	123	43.1	18,379.12	4,400	4.17
41	Nebraska	682	320	46.9	46,406.53	14,963	3.10
42	Nevada	439	178	40.5	21,663.72	9,438	2.29
43	New Hampshire	554	200	36.1	21,153.96	9,163	2.30
	New Jersey						
44	North	1,298	476	36.6	62,193.92	32,696	1.90
45	South	488	234	47.9	41,511.49	9,042	4.59
46	New Mexico	322	157	48.7	19,873.70	5,834	3.40
	New York						
47	Central	713	254	35.6	36,434.92	11,650	3.12
48	H./M./B.	770	273	35.4	24,949.25	11,911	2.09
49	Southeast	1,759	794	45.1	165,268.11	57,044	2.89
50	West	306	105	34.3	12,253.43	5,810	2.10
51	N. Carolina	886	479	54.0	82,237.65	14,300	5.75
52	North Dakota	154	65	42.2	8,051.98	3,066	2.62
	Ohio						
53	Cent. & S.E.	638	190	29.7	22,230.93	9,257	2.40
54	Northeast	1,271	267	21.0	27,943.69	22,509	1.24
55	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	279	109	39.0	11,808.91	3,911	3.01
56	S.W. Ohio	523	222	42.4	31,136.85	11,145	2.79
57	Oklahoma	385	233	60.5	31,660.13	6,583	4.80
58	Oregon	760	372	48.9	50,842.76	14,417	3.52

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
59	Pennsylvania	1,430	690	48.2	116,339.30	33,762	3.44
60	East	768	362	47.1	39,110.66	10,974	3.56
61	West	249	116	46.5	13,820.93	5,443	2.53
62	Rhode Island	304	198	65.1	32,253.26	6,520	4.94
63	South Carolina	159	64	40.2	5,030.49	3,838	1.31
64	South Dakota	489	212	43.3	34,177.19	11,168	3.06
	Tennessee						
	Texas						
65	Northeast	437	198	45.3	54,099.97	17,637	3.06
66	Northwest	239	83	34.7	15,181.86	6,259	2.42
67	Southeast	517	241	46.6	40,151.59	15,923	2.52
68	Southwest	485	227	46.8	35,630.33	11,848	3.00
69	Utah	254	146	57.4	25,102.98	5,156	4.86
70	Vermont	225	106	47.1	11,458.13	4,340	2.64
71	Virginia	1,164	640	54.9	90,543.97	22,744	3.98
72	Washington West	1,108	531	47.9	90,980.64	24,453	3.72
73	West Virginia	292	125	42.8	9,633.58	3,340	2.88
	Wisconsin						
74	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	603	272	45.1	24,549.99	9,901	2.47
75	South	956	396	41.4	43,264.01	18,651	2.31
76	Wyoming	108	54	50.0	5,928.57	1,909	3.10
77	Puerto Rico	138	71	51.4	5,791.63	1,690	3.42
78	Alberta/N.W.T.	571	226	39.5	27,735.08	8,502	3.26
79	B.C./Yukon	752	399	53.0	47,146.98	14,115	3.34
80	Manitoba	150	59	39.3	5,672.74	3,982	1.42
81	N.B./P.E.I.	201	83	41.2	6,299.61	3,493	1.80
82	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	269	110	40.8	7,717.26	3,644	2.11
	Ontario						
83	East	598	222	37.1	30,346.32	14,979	2.02
84	Northeast	172	64	37.2	7,990.60	2,411	3.31
85	Northwest	92	16	17.3	1,430.51	1,587	0.90
86	West	518	215	41.5	28,549.63	10,235	2.78
	Quebec ¹						
87	Southwest	593	400	67.5	15,840.58	15,447	1.03
88	Southeast	225	158	70.1	2,994.90	3,530	0.85
89	Northeast	366	293	80.0	6,608.00	7,312	0.91
90	Northwest	431	366	85.0	19,108.72	8,594	2.22
91	Saskatchewan	319	109	34.1	8,171.84	3,955	2.06
92	Washington East	419	172	41.0	16,960.17	5,832	2.90
	Total U.S./ Canada	56,440	25,175	44.6	\$3,539,847.76	1,268,713	2.79
	Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				192,938.97		
	Specials				277,924.21		
	Total for U.S. & Canada				4,010,710.94		

FOREIGN AND OTHER						
A.A. On Line					825.65	
Birds of a Feather					1,030.00	
Correctional facility groups					460.00	
Foreign					25,324.23	
Internationalists					0.00	
Loners					410.00	
Internationalists Groups					100.00	
International Dr's in A.A.					0.00	
World Hello					60.00	
Grand Total					4,038,920.82	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1998-1997						
(in U.S. dollars)						
	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1998	56,440	25,175	44.6%	\$3,539,847.76 ²	1,268,713	\$2.79
U.S. & Canada						
1997	56,274	25,038	44.5%	\$3,399,042.15 ²	1,268,578	\$2.68
Increase (Decrease)	166	137	0.1%	\$140,805.61	135	\$0.11

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

² Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as special, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1999 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Mickey Hardesty
Jack Howley
¹ Dave Madison
Bob Peden
² Linda Heckathorn Roberts
Jim Skees
Jim Tallman
Jean-Rock Tremblay

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Rick Barr
Keith Boyd
¹ Sue Felgenauer
² John Gehrmann
Arthur Hobbs
Sandy Luetjen
Marshall Lynn
Marcia Walker

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Correctional Facilities

Rolly Boyer
² Darla Branton
Ken Brueggemann
Murray Cameron
Bob Fox
Ar Houston
Rick Swaney
¹ Peggy Trapp

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Finance

Gary Colvin
¹ Wayne Coull
Joe Deneault
Grace Edwards
² Roger Lambert
Bonnie McConnell
Nick Murray
Jerry Pelan

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Cesar Borri
Kenny Gusner
Nat Hemenway
² B.J. Kristiansen
¹ Sallye Martinez
Luis Pineda
Brenda Sadara
Barry Watson

Secretary: Cynthia Keyworth

Literature

Bill Aldred
Susie Ardolf
¹ Ginger Bell
Dick Hill
Jerry Honeycutt
Dick Martin
² Jeff Osuch
Cookie Schamroth
Jim West

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Policy/Admissions

Scott Castillo
Charlie Contro
Loyd Gerstner
² Carl Oseen
Carol Rohloff
Janiece Rydell
Mitch Savage
¹ Ron Schudel
Boyd Snook

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Public Information

Eric Donaldson
² Tom Kraemer
Monique Noel
Bill Noonan
Kathy Peek
Jamie Rude
¹ Mark Simonson
Clayton Vandivort
Robbie Walker

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Report and Charter

Vic Booth
² Billie Bozone
John Carroll
Nikki DeFelice
Mike Divin
Marita Hagen
¹ Ken Knowles
Rob Sebastian

Secretary: Richard Bush

Treatment Facilities

Leon DeLong
Earl Knowles
² Sandy Koerner
Robert Lalonde
Gene Lesser
¹ Karl Mehrhof
Shirley Rapp
John Zinn

Secretary: Bill Archer

Trustees

Nancy Haynes
Laura Hummel
Murray McIntosh
Don Miller
Elaine Owen
¹ Lisa Reich
Bob Sweeney
Gord Sytnick
² Phil Von Schaff

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

³ International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Bill Aldred
Scott Castillo
Eric Donaldson
Sue Felgenauer
Arthur Hobbs
Ar Houston
¹ Jeff Osuch
² Gord Sytnick

Co-secretaries: Valerie O'Neill
Susan Ulseth

³ Archives

Darla Branton
Ken Brueggeman
Grace Edwards
Marita Hagen
Elaine Owen
¹ Jerry Pelan
Jamie Rude
Mitch Savage
Jim West

Secretary: Judit Santon

2000 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Mickey Hardesty, Utah	Bob Peden, Northern Indiana
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Sandy Luetjen, Arkansas	Rick Barr, Central SE Ohio
Correctional Facilities	Murray Cameron, Central Michigan	Bob Fox, W. Washington
Finance	Gary Colvin, Eastern Pennsylvania	Grace Edwards, BC/Yukon
Grapevine	Barry Watson, E. Ontario	Luis Pineda, NE Texas
Literature	Bill Aldred, North Carolina	Dick Hill, Nevada
Policy/Admissions	Scott Castillo, Hawaii	Boyd Snook, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador
Public Information	Bill Noonan, Illinois, Chicago	Clayton Vandivort, Eastern Missouri
Report and Charter	Marita Hagan, Southern California	Rob Sebastian, Northeast Ohio
Treatment Facilities	Shirley Rapp, W. Missouri	Gene Lesser, Virginia
Committee on Trustees	Nancy Haynes, California, Northern Coastal	Don Miller, Colorado
³ International Conv./Regional Forum	Ar Houston, W. Pennsylvania	Arthur Hobbs, NE Quebec
³ Archives	Mitch Savage, Oklahoma	Jamie Rude, Connecticut

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment and not a primary committee assignment.

⁴The 1999 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 49th General Service Conference.

1999 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Tom Maguire, *chairperson*
Linda Chezern
Jim Clough
Ron Gauthier
Jan Polek
Betty Stevens
Judith Santon, *secretary*

Conference

MaryJane Roy, *chairperson*
Linda Chezern
Jim Clough
Marne Hill
Jan Polek
Dean Rinehart
Ray Stiver
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Dean Rinehart, *chairperson*
*Paul Cleary
*Calvin James
John Koster
*Martha Lewis
*Robert McCoy
Robert Miller, D.D.
Betty Stevens
*Patti Walters
George Vaillant, M.D.
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*
—C.P.C.
Bill Archer, *secretary*
—Treatment Facilities

Correctional Facilities

Linda Chezern, *chairperson*
Carl Budd
*Mark Gornik
*Bruce Henry
MaryJane Roy
*Sharon Stone
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Art Knight, *chairperson*
Carl Budd
Ron Gauthier
Michel Girard
Jackie Johnston
Richard Roughton
Greg Tobin
Dennis Manders,
senior advisor
Kevin Sunkel, C.P.A.,
independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Michel Girard, *chairperson*
Marnie Hill
Dean Rinehart
Peter Roach
Ray Stiver
George Vaillant, M.D.
Richard Bush, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Peter Roach,
chairperson
David Every
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Garry McAuley
Robert Miller, D.D.
Greg Tobin
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*
—International Conventions
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*
—Regional Forums

Literature

Garry McAuley, *chairperson*
*Frank Berls
David Every
Marne Hill
Jackie Johnston
Richard Roughton
George Vaillant, M.D.
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Nominating

Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.,
chairperson
Michel Girard
Art Knight
Jack Ostrem
Peter Roach
MaryJane Roy
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

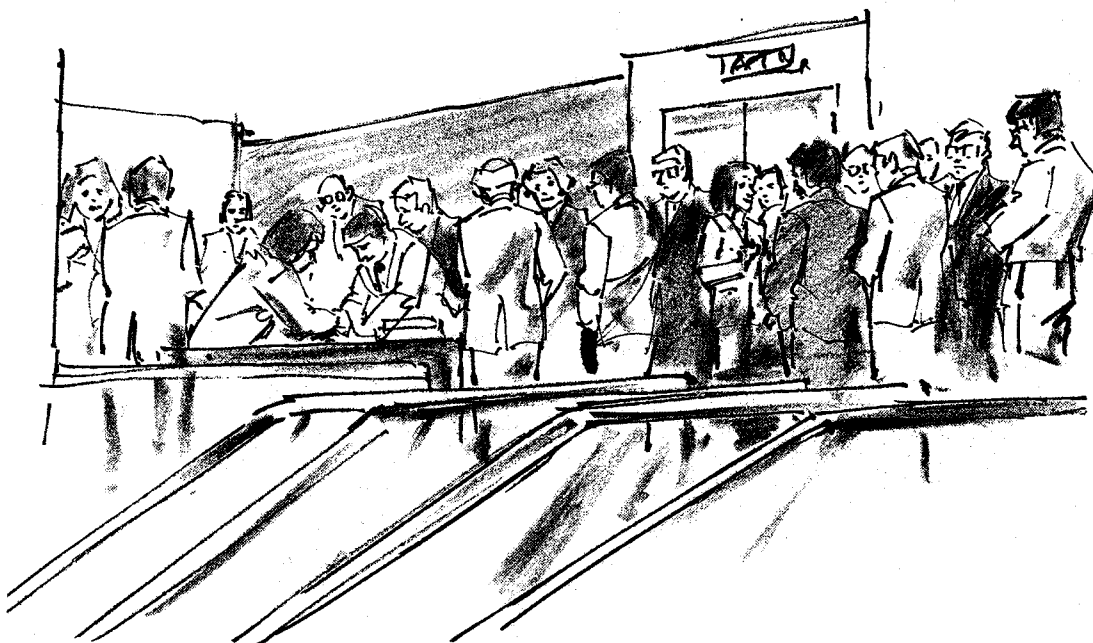
Public Information

Jack Ostrem,
chairperson
Jim Clough
*Tony Hurley
Art Knight
John Koster
*Lindajo Loftus
Tom Maguire
Robert Miller, D.D.
*Jim Puckett
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Tom Maguire, *chairperson*
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Gary Glynn
First vice-chairperson
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
Second vice-chairperson
Peter Roach
Secretary
MaryJane Roy
Treasurer
Art Knight
Assistant secretary
Lois Fisher
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 39

* Denotes appointed committee members

** Gary Glynn and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

1999 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1997 Conference. He has been a member of the board since 1993 and has served as treasurer of the General Service Board, as well as chair of the Finance & Budgetary Committee. A graduate of the University of Vermont and the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 25 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees.

Linda L. Chezem, J.D. (530 Denny Dr., Mooresville, IN 46158) was elected to the board in April 1997. A graduate of Indiana University School of Law, Linda is a former judge, Court of Appeals of Indiana. She started the first certified court alcohol and drug program in Indiana, and has conducted seminars and written articles on such subjects as DWI, family and addiction. Linda chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and also serves on the Archives and Conference Committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is professor of social work at Morgan State University, Baltimore, Maryland, and is a past director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, which is a component of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services. Elaine chairs the Nominating Committee and also serves on the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committee, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Arthur L. Knight, Jr. (560 Stockbridge Court, Lake Forest, IL 60045-2680) was elected to the board in 1995. Art's professional background is in the field of business, where he has held positions as president, director, and chief executive officer of manufacturing, distribution and financial services companies. He is a graduate of Dartmouth College and holds an M.B.A. from the University of New York, Buffalo. While Art is no longer involved in day-to-day business operations, he serves on a variety of business, professional and civic boards. He is treasurer of the General Service Board, chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and also serves on the Public Information and Nominating Committees.

Robert Oran Miller, D.D. (2104 Vestavia Lake Dr., Birmingham, AL 35216) was elected to the board in 1995. Elected ninth Bishop of the Diocese of Alabama in 1988, Bob has served as deacon and rector in several parishes in Alabama and held positions on various councils of the Episcopal church. He received an honorary Doctorate of Divinity from the University of the South, where he serves on the board of trustees. Bob serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities, International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

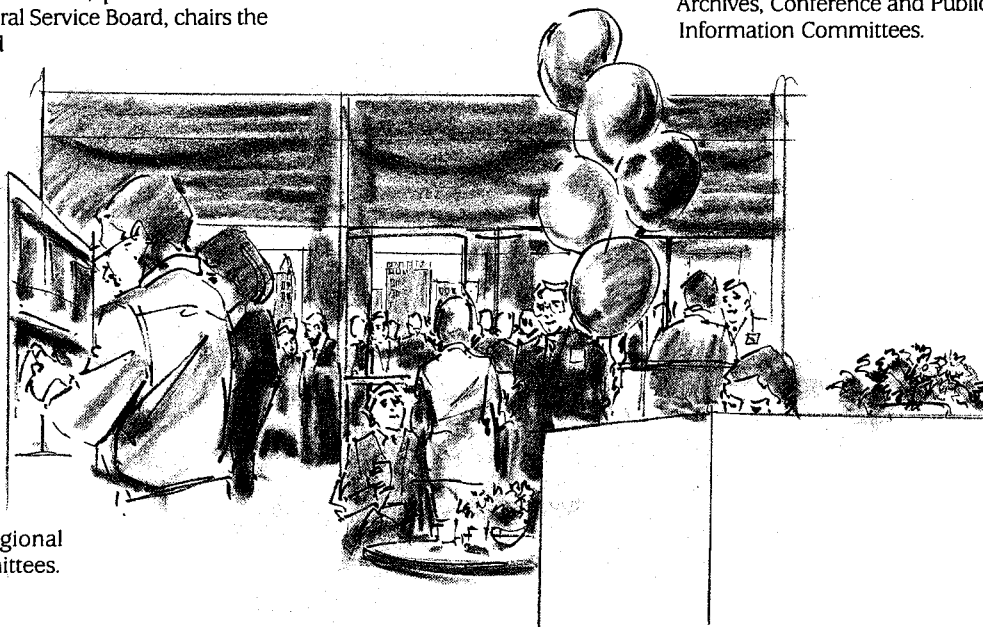
Peter Roach (1332 Edmison Dr., Peterborough, Ontario K9H 6V3, Canada) was elected to the board in 1994. Peter has been an elementary and secondary school teacher. When he retired in 1992, he had completed 18 years as director of education for Peterborough Separate School Board. Since his retirement he is involved extensively in the community by serving on the Hospital Board, United Way, the Ontario Superannuated Teachers' Board and on a standing committee of the Community College. He is also chair of the Pastoral Council for his parish. Peter chairs the International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and also serves on the International and Nominating Committees.

George E. Vaillant, M.D. (Brigham and Women's Hospital, 75 Francis St., Boston, MA 02115) was elected to the board in 1998. He is a graduate of Harvard Medical School and the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. George is professor, Dept. of Psychiatry, Harvard Medical School; senior physician, Brigham and Women's Hospital; and on the faculty of Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. He has lectured widely and is the author of many articles on alcoholism and addiction. George serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Literature and International Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Carl Budd (1405 Collins St., Rock Springs, WY 82901) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 30 delegate, Carl has remained active in his area, particularly in collecting material for the area archives. After many years in the oil and gas industry, he retired in 1995 from the Department of the Interior, after 14 years of service. Carl chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board and is a member of the Correctional Facilities and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Jim Clough (1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 42 delegate, Jim has been active in his area and has served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee. A retired naval architect and marine engineer he is currently co-owner of a company involved in the publishing, wholesaling, and retailing of art. Jim serves on the Archives, Conference and Public Information Committees.



¹ Rotating at the close of the 1999 Conference meeting.

Michel Girard (67, Aubert Blvd., Repentigny, Quebec, J6A 4N9, Canada), a Panel 42 delegate, was elected trustee-at-large/ Canada in May 1995. He has been active in service in his area and served on the boards of A.A. French Publications and *La Vigne*. Michel is now retired from a 30-year position with a telecommunications company. He chairs the International Committee and also serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Marne Hill (270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 3T3) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1998. A Panel 41 delegate she has held many service positions at the local and area level, including Area 85 archivist. Marne, whose background is in banking, is currently a financial planner. She serves on the Literature and Conference Committees.

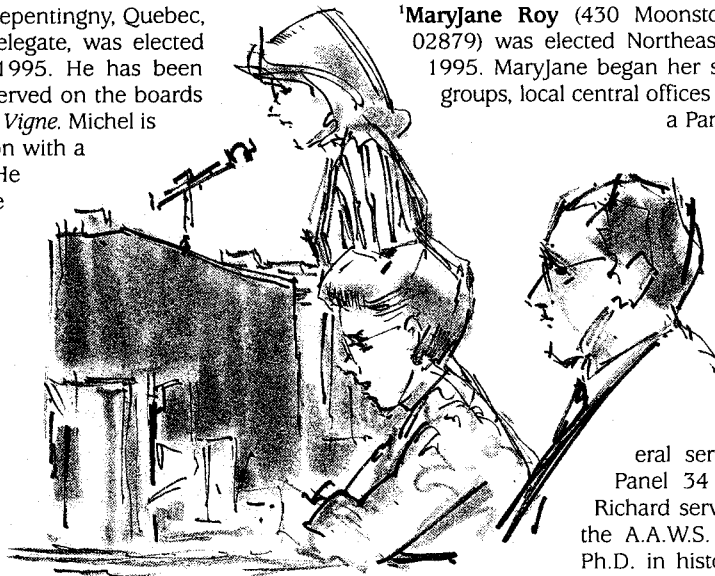
Jacqueline Johnston (1169 Nottingwood Circle, Westlake Village, CA 91361) was elected general service trustee in April 1998, after serving as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Jackie has been active for many years in area and district service work and was Panel 41 delegate from Southern California. Now retired, she worked as a C.P.A. for a national accounting firm in both New York and California, and as a teacher in Los Angeles. Jackie serves on the A.A.W.S. Board as well as the Literature and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Garry McAuley (6115 51st Ave., Stettler, Alberta T0C 2L2, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1996. A Panel 40 delegate, he was safety and environmental advisor for a processing plant of a petroleum company and retired in 1997. Garry is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board and chairs the Literature Committee. He is also a member of the International Conventions/ Regional Forums Committee.

Tom Maguire (941 Pineview Circle, Live Oak, FL 32060) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. Tom served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He is general manager for a national radio network, and has had a long career in television station management. He chairs the Archives Committee, serves on the Public Information Committee and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jack L. Ostrem (913 Grand Blvd., Joliet, IL 60436) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate, Jack has long been active in his area, especially in corrections service work. Now retired, his major occupation for many years was in warehouse management. Jack is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board, chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Nominating Committee.

Dean Rinehart (613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1997. As a Panel 37 delegate, he chaired the Grapevine Conference Committee, and has continued to be active in service work in the area and region. A practicing attorney, Dean is also engaged in cattle and farming activities. He chairs the Cooperation with the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities Committee, as well as serving on the Conference and International Committees.



MaryJane Roy (430 Moonstone Beach Rd., Wakefield, RI 02879) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in May 1995. MaryJane began her service work in young people's groups, local central offices and at the group level. She was a Panel 42 delegate, and chaired the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

MaryJane, a physician's assistant, is clinical director of a vascular lab. She chairs the Conference Committee and also serves on the Correctional Facilities and Nominating Committees.

Richard Roughton (70 W. Huron, Apt. 806, Chicago, IL 60610) was elected general service trustee in April 1997. A Panel 34 delegate from Rhode Island, Richard served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 1993-1997. He has a Ph.D. in history and is dean of Continuing Education at a college in the Chicago area.

Richard chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and also serves on the Literature and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Betty Stevens (1420 Nunamaker Dr., Columbia, SC 29210) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1997. A Panel 31 delegate, Betty has held various service positions in her area and was active in committee work for her local intergroup. Now retired, she has worked in EAP and as an alcoholism counselor. Betty serves on the Archives and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 1999 Conference

Alex D. J. Palmer (33439 Huggins Ave., Abbotsford, BC, V2S 2R8, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada, April 1999. A Panel 45 delegate from BC/Yukon, Alex has held many service positions in his area. He has been an accountant for several small businesses, and is currently executive director of a recovery house.

Beth Rabren (224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 1999. A Panel 39 delegate, where she chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees, she continues to be active in her area and region. Beth's professional background is in education, as teacher and administrator, and in treatment as an ADC III counselor and administrator.

Tony Taschner (16 Cindy Lane, Berlin, CT 06037) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 1999. Tony served as a Panel 45 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, and has held many service positions in his district and area. He is an assistant vice president in Data Management of a large financial service company.

Greg Tobin (64 Duffield Dr., South Orange, NJ 07079) was elected general service trustee in April 1999, after serving for three years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He has been active in various service committees in his home area and district. Greg has had a long career in the book-publishing industry and is currently editor-in-chief of a large publishing house.

A.A. World Services Directors

Richard Roughton, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Ron Gauthier, *nontrustee director*
 Jacqueline Johnston, *general service trustee*

John Koster, *nontrustee director*
 Garry McAuley, *regional trustee*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jack Ostrem, *regional trustee*
 Jan Polek, *nontrustee director*
 Lois Fisher, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Carl Budd, *chairperson regional trustee*
 David Every, *nontrustee director*
 Elaine Johnson, Ph.D., *Class A trustee*
 Thomas Maguire, *general service trustee*

Betty Stevens, *regional trustee*
 Ray Stiver, *nontrustee director*
 Greg Tobin, *nontrustee director*
 Ames Sweet, *Grapevine executive editor*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Bill Archer
 Adrienne Brown
 Richard Bush
 Lois Fisher
 Joanie Moncrief

Daniel Mooney
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Susan Ulseth

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet, *executive editor*
 MaryPat Hester, *circulation director*

Cynthia Keyworth, *senior editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Ellie Biscuti, *staff assistant*
 Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Daniel Brown, *designer/typesetter*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Ramona Cabrera, *staff assistant*
 Angel Calvillo, *translator*
 Joseph Dennon, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Elaina Johnson, *staff assistant*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Marsha Levine, *GV editorial staff assistant*
 Vanessa Luyando, *receptionist*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor, finance committee*
 Jaime Manrique, *GV Spanish-language editor*
 Lynda Maziarz, *staff assistant*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lillianna Murphy, *information services manager*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Miguel Rodriguez, *general office clerk*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Judit Santon, *archivist*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Robert Slotterback, *GV controller*
 Elaine Soroka, *special projects manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Stephen Turchyn, *data processing supervisor*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 49th Conference includes Panel 48 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 49 (first-year delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	49	Janiece Rydell Box 7456 Spanish Fort, AL 36577
Alaska	2	48	Ken Knowles Box 1934 Kodiak, AK 99615
Arizona	3	48	Karl Mehrhof 8841 W. Port Royale Lane Peoria, AZ 85381
Arkansas	4	49	Sandy Luetjen 301 E. Tahlequah Siloam Springs, AR 72761
California Southern	5	49	Marita Hagen 514 E. Elmwood Ave., #F Burbank, CA 91501-2589
Northern Coastal	6	49	Nancy Haynes Box 151 St. Helena, CA 94574
Northern Interior	7	48	John Gehrman 738 Anderson Rd. Davis, CA 95616-3513
San Diego/Imperial	8	48	Sallye Martinez 589 N. Johnson Ave., #127 El Cajon, CA 92020-3145
Mid-Southern	9	48	Nick Murray 3505 S. Olive St. Santa Ana, CA 92707
Colorado	10	49	Don Miller 213 S. Hoover Ave. Louisville, CO 80027
Connecticut	11	49	James (Jamie) Rude 141 W. Main St. Milford, CT 06460-3338
Delaware	12	48	David (Dave) Madison 1 Wellspring Dr. Bear, DE 19701
District of Columbia	13	49	Earl Knowles 2709 Keystone Lane Bowie, MD 20715
Florida North	14	49	Kathy Peek 6968 N.W. 57th Ave. Ocala, FL 34482
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	49	Brenda Sadera Box 3 Sanibel, FL 33957
Georgia	16	48	Jerry Honeycutt 4685 Kings Down Rd. Dunwoody, GA 30338
Hawaii	17	49	Scott Castillo 94-1139 Moololo St. Waipahu, HI 96797
Idaho	18	48	Carl Oseen 5275 W. Franklin Rd. Meridian, ID 83642

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Illinois				Montana	40	48	Eric Donaldson Box 5192 Bozeman, MT 59717
Chicago	19	49	William (Bill) Noonan 1911 West Estes Chicago, IL 60626	Nebraska	41	48	Kenneth (Ken) Brueggemann 6111 Belvedere Blvd. Omaha, NE 68111
Northern	20	48	Jerome (Jerry) Pelan 733 Park Ave. Sycamore, IL 60178-2417	Nevada	42	49	Richard (Dick) Hill 305 Surprise, Box 72 Searchlight, NV 89046
Southern	21	49	Dick Martin 1011 Perrysville Rd. Danville, IL 61832	New Hampshire	43	48	Wayne Coull 43 High St., #1 Laconia, NH 03246
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	49	Bob Peden 188 Brookside Manor Goshen, IN 46526	Northern	44	49	James (Keith) Boyd 21 Hemlock Rd. Rockaway, NJ 07866
Southern	23	48	Sue Felgenauer R.R. #1, Box 400, Hwy. 41 Rosedale, IN 47874	Southern	45	48	Robert (Robbie) Walker 1346 N. Orchard Rd. Vineland, NJ 08360
Iowa	24	49	John Zinn 109 E. Park St. Spencer, IA 51301	New Mexico	46	48	Jeffrey (Jeff) Osuch Box 1456 Peralta, NM 87042
Kansas	25	48	Carol Rohloff 1247 N. Emporia Wichita, KS 67214	New York			
Kentucky	26	48	Jim Skees Box 846 Elizabethtown, KY 42702-0846	Central	47	49	John (Jack) Howley 99 Etna Rd. Ithaca, NY 14850
Louisiana	27	49	Dominique (Nikki) DeFelice 2014 Pecan Ridge Ave. Baton Rouge, LA 70816	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	48	Charles (Charlie) T. Contro 3362 Co. Hwy. 11 Hartwick, NY 13348
Maine	28	48	Elaine Owen Box 153 Morrill, ME 04952	Southeast	49	49	Clarisse (Cookie) Schamroth 242 E. 19th St., #14F New York, NY 10003
Maryland	29	48	Peggy Trapp 3404 St. Paul St. Baltimore, MD 21218-2701	Western	50	48	Marcia Walker 5 Main St., #801 Tonawanda, NY 14150-2138
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	49	William (Bill) Aldred 101 Blackford Ct. Durham, NC 27712-9497
Eastern	30	49	Robert (Bob) Sweeney 83 High St. Quincy, MA 02169	North Dakota	52	48	Loyd Gerstner 2402 S. 18th St., #6 Fargo, ND 58103
Western	31	48	Billie Bozone 164 Red Gate Ln. Amherst, MA 01002-1845	Ohio			
Michigan				Central Southeast	53	49	Richard (Rick) Barr 4092 Berrybush Dr. Gahanna, OH 43230
Central	32	49	Robert (Murray) Cameron 2800 Ridge Rd. Ossineke, MI 49766	Northeast	54	49	Robert (Rob) Sebastian 261 Schrop Ave., #1 Akron, OH 44312-1204
Southeast	33	49	Laura Hummel 36895 Green St., #8 New Baltimore, MI 48047	NW Ohio/SE Mich.	55	48	Ronald (Ron) Schudel 302 Parker Ave. Toledo, OH 43605-1751
Western	34	48	Leon DeLong 542 Fairfield Ave. Battle Creek, MI 49015	Southwest	56	48	Richard (Rick) Swaney 11246 Shelby-Freyburg Rd. Wapakoneta, OH 45895-8448
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	49	Mitchell (Mitch) Savage 221 East 20th Tulsa, OK 74119
Northern	35	48	Susan (Susie) Ardolf 2992 County Rd., 137 Waite Park, MN 56387	Oregon	58	48	Mark Simonson 1402 12th Ave. Seaside, OR 97138
Southern	36	49	Bonnie McConnell Route 4, Box 40 Austin, MN 55912	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	48	Darla Branton 308 Lakeview Leland, MS 38756	Eastern	59	49	Gary Colvin Rear 837 Maple St. Scranton, PA 18505
Missouri				Western	60	49	Arlene (Ar) Houston 210 Mansfield Rd. Washington, PA 15301-8931
Eastern	38	49	William (Clayton) Vandivort Box 158 Sikeston, MO 63801				
Western	39	49	Shirley Rapp 4712 Roanoke Pkwy., #701 Kansas City, MO 64112				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	48	Sandra (Sandy) Koerner 21 Starr Dr., #202 Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	48	William (Marshall) Lynn 1812 Madison Rd. Columbia, SC 29204
South Dakota	63	48	Lisa Reich 1740 S. Fourth St. Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	48	Charles (Phil) Von Schaaf 7010 Genoa Dr. Chattanooga, TN 37421
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	49	Luis Pineda 4113 Woodbury Rd. Balch Springs, TX 75180
<i>Northwest</i>	66	48	Linda Heckathorn Roberts 312 Caliche St. Borger, TX 79007
<i>Southeast</i>	67	49	Mike Divin 1105 Glade College Station, TX 77840
<i>Southwest</i>	68	48	Roger Lambert 2713 Jorwoods Dr. Austin, TX 78745
Utah	69	49	Mickey Hardesty Box 154 Springville, UT 84663
Vermont	70	48	Nathaniel (Nat) Hemenway Box 6, 18 Brook Rd. Strafford, VT 05072
Virginia	71	49	Gene Lesser 7711 Fisher Dr. Falls Church, VA 22043
Washington <i>East</i>	92	48	Ginger Bell 634 Valley Westside Rd. Colville, WA 99114
<i>Western</i>	72	49	Robert (Bob) Fox 5142 S. Findlay St. Seattle, WA 98118-2559
West Virginia	73	49	Joseph (Joe) Deneault 1502 Grandview Dr. Charleston, WV 25302
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Penn. MI</i>	74	48	John Carroll 9166 River Rd. Berlin, WI 54923
<i>Southern</i>	75	49	Ken (Kenny) Gusner 800 N. Sherwood Dr. Beloit, WI 53511
Wyoming	76	48	Bjarne (B.J.) Kristiansen 1224 Park Dr. Sheridan, WY 82801
Puerto Rico	77	48	Cesar O. Borri Urb. El Verde/Calle Neptuno #83 Caguas, PR 00726

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	48	Jim Tallman 9611 86th Ave. Peace River, AB T8S 1G4
B.C./Yukon	79	49	Grace Edwards #307-1011 Fourth Ave. New Westminster, BC V3M 1T3
Manitoba	80	48	Gordon (Gord) Sytnick Box 3 Valley River, MB R0L 2B0
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	48	Jim West 795 Ontario St., Apt. 4 Saint John, NB E2M 3J2
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	49	Boyd Snook Box 4 Holyrood, NF A0A 2R0
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	49	Barry Watson 14 Low Meadowway Toronto, ON M2H 2V7
<i>Northeast</i>	84	49	Rolly Boyer 180 Ivarhoe Dr. North Bay, ON P1A 3B8
<i>Northwest</i>	85	49	Murray McIntosh 426 Cuyler St. Thunder Bay, ON P7A 1B2
<i>Western</i>	86	48	Victor (Vic) Booth 44 Simcoe St. Scotland, ON N0E 1R0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	48	Robert Lalonde 5398 Baldwin Montreal, PQ H1K 3B5
<i>Southeast</i>	88	49	Jean-Rock Tremblay 1123, Ave. St-Louis Plessisville, PQ G6L 2M4
<i>Northeast</i>	89	49	Arthur Hobbs 3132 Cadieu Jonquiere, PQ G7S 2C2
<i>Northwest</i>	90	48	Monique Noel 2 Chemin Mullen L'Annonciation, PQ J0T 1T0
Saskatchewan	91	48	Tom Kraemer Box 121 Vibank, SK S0G 4Y0

